



Partly sunny 85/70 • Tomorrow: A stray t-shower 91/74

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, AUGUST 29, 2026 • \$4

Ballroom claim is undercut by records

White House says project is ‘65% finished’ in filing to Supreme Court

BY SARAH BLASKEY,
JONATHAN O’CONNELL,
DAN DIAMOND
AND JARRETT LEY

The Trump administration told the Supreme Court two weeks ago that construction of a new White House East Wing was “65% finished,” part of its argument that the work was too far along for the court to halt.

But by the White House’s own standard for measuring the project’s progress, established in a confidential agreement with contractor Clark Construction that was reviewed by The Washington Post, work on the controversial project was far less complete.

The agreement, finalized before Clark began demolition last October, stipulates that payments to the contractor be proportional to the amount of work completed, and that work cannot begin until the government approves spending for it. Based on that, if 65 percent of the work has been done, then the government should already have paid 65 percent of the total cost of the project.

Publicly available appropriations data shows that as of the end of July, the White House budget office had approved \$144 million in spending from an account used to pay for the East Wing and other White House projects. Even if that entire amount were spent on the East Wing, it would come to only about 24 percent of the \$600 million estimated

SEE BALLROOM ON A8

Warsh: On inflation, bank has ‘work to do’

A majority of investors now expect a rate hike in September

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

JACKSON HOLE, WYO. — Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh said he was “impressed” with the economy’s overall strength but is concerned by signs that “underlying trends” in inflation have not improved.

Making his first appearance here as Fed chair, Warsh stopped well short of clearly signaling an interest-rate increase at the Fed’s next meeting. He also defended his controversial decision to provide only limited public comments about Fed thinking, which critics say has left markets confused about the central bank’s intentions.

But many investors viewed Warsh’s remarks as hawkish. Nearly 60 percent of traders now anticipate a Fed rate hike in mid-September, up from just over a third on Thursday, according to CME FedWatch, which tracks futures market activity.

Speaking in a rustic lodge beneath elk-antler chandeliers,

SEE INFLATION ON A5



DAN AGOSTINI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Majur Traytowu stands in front of a field of sugarcane in the village of Apido Paru.

A trans chief blazed a path. Addiction cost her the job.

Majur Traytowu is struggling to hold on to influence and authority amid a devastating alcohol epidemic ravaging her territory — and her own life

BY MARINA DIAS AND DAN AGOSTINI

TADARIMANA INDIGENOUS TERRITORY, BRAZIL — As the sun sets, Majur Traytowu stirs beef ribs in the heavy iron pot on the wood stove. The table holds a small portion of rice and beans — enough for her family’s only meal that day in Apido Paru, her Indigenous village here in central Brazil.

She tucks her chin-length dark hair behind

her ear, wipes her hands on her yellow shorts. “I’ll make sugarcane juice,” she announces. She grabs a machete and pulls her friend along.

Kiga Boe follows. They’ve known each other since they were children. It was Traytowu who helped Boe understand that she, like herself, didn’t recognize herself in the body into which she was born. Now, Traytowu is 35, Boe, 29. “Even before the transition,” Boe says, “Majur

SEE CHIEF ON A12

Americans have turned against plate cameras

More people oppose police use of the AI-powered technology than support it

BY DREW HARWELL,
DOUGLAS MACMILLAN,
AARON SCHAEFFER
AND KEVIN CROWE

When Justin Cowgur, a city council member in Centerton, Arkansas, was asked two years ago to vote on a contract to install Flock license-plate readers, he found it easy to say yes. The Republican wine seller believed the artificial intelligence-powered cameras — which record passing cars’ plates into a database that officers can search to investigate crime — could help ease the strain on their understaffed police force and keep his bedroom community safe.

But lately, he’s come to regret the deal, saying he no longer

trusts the company with the huge amount of data its roadside cameras collect. Earlier this month, after a parade of residents voiced concerns about their privacy and the system’s risk of abuse, he and other members voted unanimously to cancel the contract.

“Being a parent and having two girls, I wanted safety. But the way that the license plate readers have hit a lot of radars is very concerning,” Cowgur, 39, said in an interview. “People want to have privacy in some way, and you don’t want to feel like you’re being watched. ... Do we really know where our data is going?”

Cowgur’s change of heart reflects the national mood on one of the fastest-growing surveillance tools in American policing, according to surveys from the polling firm YouGov. More Americans now oppose law enforcement’s use of the technology than support it, a reversal from last year as a growing backlash raises concerns about its poten-

SEE FLOCK ON A6

Trump secures a vast U.S. stake in Venezuela’s oil

SAYS DEAL INVOLVES 65 BILLION BARRELS

Goal is to persuade energy companies to drill

BY EVAN HALPER,
KAREN DEYOUNG,
ANTHONY FAIOLA
AND SAMANTHA SCHMIDT

President Trump announced Friday night that the U.S. had secured a long-term stake in a vast share of Venezuela’s oil fields, a potentially costly and legally precarious proposal that aims to nudge reluctant energy companies to drill in the risky region.

The plan involves the United States taking more direct control over Venezuelan reserves as crime and steep logistical challenges discourage private investors.

Under it, according to federal officials, the U.S. has gained a controlling stake in nearly a quarter of Venezuela’s untapped oil reserves. It makes the Unit-

ed States the majority owner of a giant new joint venture oil company that will hold 100-year contracts at the Venezuelan oil fields.

The key Venezuelan partner in the deal is Alejandro Betancourt, a Venezuelan businessman who has been the subject of investigations in multiple countries into alleged money laundering and currently faces a Swiss warrant for his arrest.

“The United States of America has just entered into an Agreement with the Country of Venezuela on, THE BIGGEST OIL DEAL IN WORLD HISTORY!” Trump posted on social media Friday night. “At my direction, Secretary of State Marco Rubio, and Secretary of War Pete Hegseth, working closely with Highly Respected Interim President of Venezuela, Delcy Rodríguez, and, through a partnership with private business, have secured majority U.S. control of more than 65 BILLION BARRELS of proven Oil Reserves in Venezuela.”

Trump claimed the deal would
SEE VENEZUELA ON A14

Six months later, Trump is low on Iran options

Regime endures, Hormuz is largely closed, and U.S. weapons are depleted

BY MICHAEL BIRNBAUM

The day after President Donald Trump launched the war in Iran on Feb. 28, he said the fight could last four to five weeks. Six months later, there is little to suggest the end is near.

The Iran war has become a major challenge to Trump’s second term, hurting his standing with voters at home and eroding the U.S. position in the Middle East. And the president’s ability to shape the outcome appears to be severely constrained after Iranian leaders discovered that they could withstand intense bom-

bardment and slowly degrade the world’s most powerful military with a cheap combination of mines and drones.

Now Trump needs to reopen the Strait of Hormuz while operating within his own red lines: His fierce aversion to becoming a 21st-century Herbert Hoover, who presided over the Great Depression, limits the economic moves available to him. His decision, at least so far, to hold back from the riskiest and most extreme military moves against Iran similarly limits his war options.

“We are in an absolutely weaker position, and I don’t know that there’s any redemption for it,” said Suzanne Maloney, an expert on U.S.-Iran relations at the Brookings Institution. The war “is part of a larger set of dynamics that have been unleashed by this administration that have

SEE IRAN ON A14



ERIC LEE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

63rd anniversary of March on Washington

Thousands of people from across the country arrived at the Lincoln Memorial on Friday to pay tribute to progress made in the past — and voice fears those gains could be erased.

IN THE NEWS

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BY SCOTT CLEMENT

This week’s Pollwatcher answers a reader’s question about how polls select respondents and highlights how partisans in one state have flipped on a Democratic senator. But first...
Are people honest when taking polls? I often see claims that people regularly lie to pollsters, a claim that’s difficult to prove or disprove. Still, the idea that people are willing and able to report their actual opinions is a core assumption for public opinion polls to work.

There are examples of “social desirability” bias in surveys on certain topics: People overreport voting in elections and under-report drug use. The “Bradley Effect” theorized that White voters overreported support for Black candidates in 1980s elections, although this pattern didn’t repeat in either of Barack Obama’s presidential runs.
But what about standard opinion questions like “what is the most important issue facing the country?” Do people report which issues really matter to them?

The answer may be in our fingertips and eyeballs, according to a recent study published in Public Opinion Quarterly, a top journal. A trio of researchers at Université Laval in Quebec explained that when people experience strong emotions, they can also have physical reactions. Sweating is one indicator of emotional response, as is how much our pupils dilate when reacting to something we see.

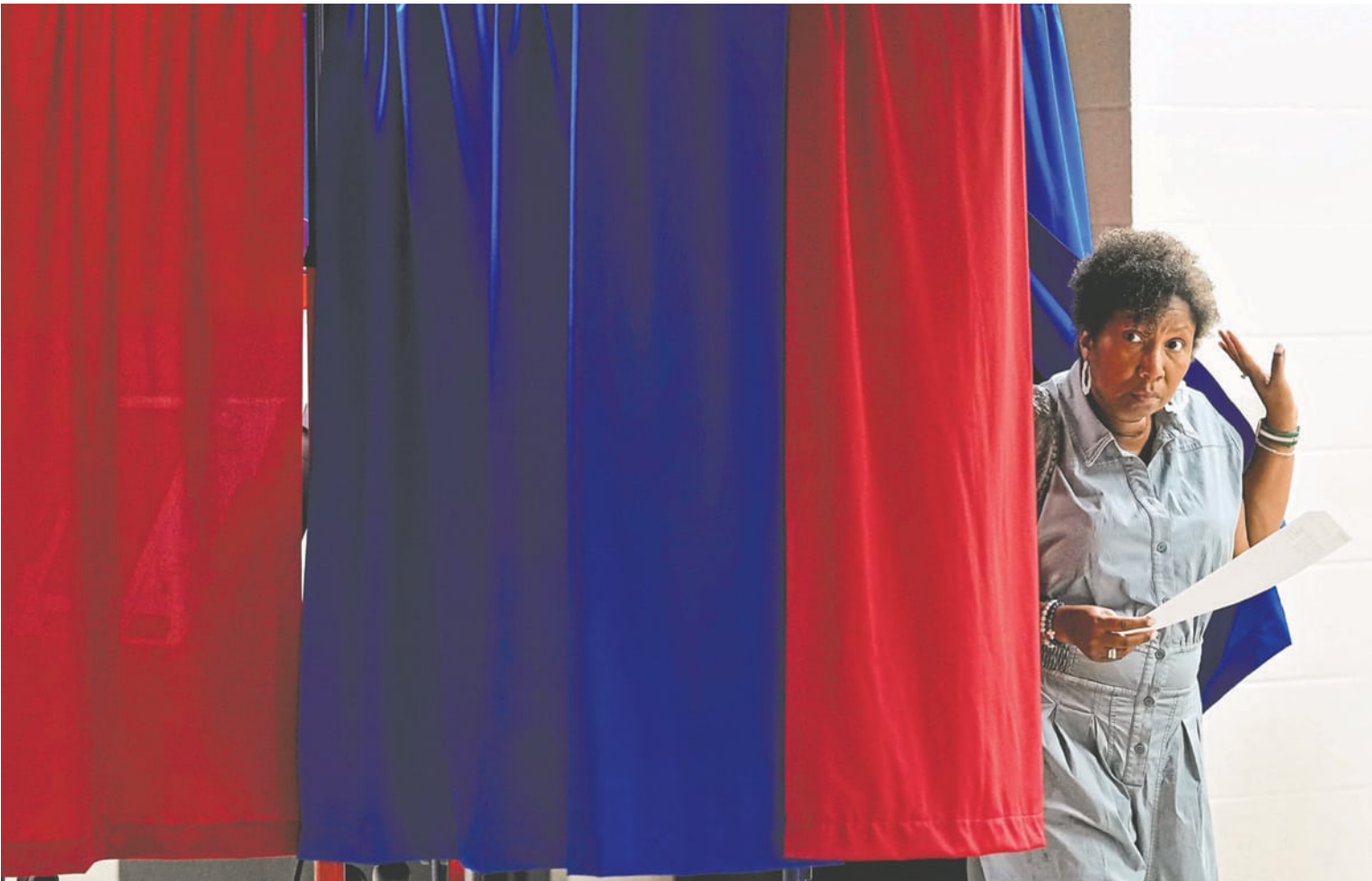
How they did it

In a dimly lit room, researchers showed 116 Quebec adults a variety of words associated with five issues, including the economy, environment, health, immigration and culture. As they answered short questions about each word, a sensor measured how quickly electricity flowed through their index and middle fingers — a proxy for sweat — while another sensor tracked changes in the diameter of their pupils. Participants also completed a typical survey asking about the importance of the same issues.

Co-author of the study Camille Tremblay-Antoine described the study’s core question in an email: “When we ask people questions and collect their answers, are those answers actually valid? Would we get the same results if those same people came into a laboratory and we measured their responses with a lie detector?”

‘The short answer is: yes.’

That’s the basic conclusion from Tremblay-Antoine. The study found strong positive correlations, about 0.7 out of a maximum of 1, between how important people rated issues and their both sweat rates and pupil sizes. The results were statistically significant despite the



GEORGE WALKER IV/AP

Shayla McCarter steps out of a booth at an early polling place in Nolensville, Tennessee, on July 24.

study’s relative small sample.
Not all survey questions performed equally, the study found. Questions that forced respondents to choose their most important issue were more closely tied to physical reactions than those that allowed respondents to rate multiple issues as important.

But overall, the results were encouraging, Tremblay-Antoine wrote. “When we ask people what matters to them or what they prefer, we can have real confidence that their answers reflect their genuine priorities. It may seem obvious, but it had never actually been tested this way.”

Top-issue polls face other challenges

While the novel Canadian study suggests people can tell pollsters which issues they feel passionately about, measuring and interpreting the public’s biggest concerns can be difficult.

Top-issue polls sometimes show differing results depending on which issues are listed. A May Quinncipiac University poll found 26 percent of voters chose “preserving democracy” as the nation’s most urgent issue, but a Gallup poll asking an open-ended question found 2 percent of adults naming elections or democracy as the country’s top problem. Open-ended questions rely mainly on issues at the top of voters’ minds, but can miss other issues that they have strong feelings about.
In addition, the connection to how people vote is shaky.

THE POLLWATCHER

We know you care about the environment because you’re sweating

Plus: How are poll respondents selected? And a poll finds Republicans like a Democratic senator.

When we ask people questions and collect their answers, are those answers actually valid? Would we get the same results if those same people came into a laboratory and we measured their responses with a lie detector?

One study by Thomas J. Leeper and Joshua Robison analyzed 48 issues across presidential elections from 1980 to 2008 to see whether voters who said an issue was important based their vote on those issues. The results were inconsistent: issue importance mattered in some cases, but in many other cases it did not.

Your questions!

Thanks to the more than 50 readers who sent in questions or ideas about polling! I look forward to writing about all of them in the coming months, but Cynthia’s query seems perfect to start with:
Q: I have often wondered

about the legitimacy of polls because I don’t know who or how people are selected to participate. So

1. How are people selected?
2. How can I participate?

A: There are two main sampling approaches. **Random or probability-based samples** start with a “sampling frame” that includes everyone in the target population, such as the U.S. Postal Service’s address file or a state’s list of registered voters. A poll contacts a random sample from that frame using one or more methods, such as by phone, text, email or phone. Actual samples are more complex to overcome the fact that the frame is usually missing contact information for many people, or that certain types of people are more likely to respond.

Non-probability or opt-in online samples are the second main way polls recruit respondents, using online ads that offer rewards or payment for taking surveys.

While some polls recruit respondents for a single interview, survey panels that recruit respondents for multiple surveys are increasingly common. Some panels recruit panel members using non-probability methods, while others use random sampling.

2. *How can I participate?*
While anyone can sign up to take online surveys through an opt-in survey company, there’s no way to volunteer for surveys conducted using random sampling. Survey methods have changed dramatically since the

early 2000s, with a massive growth in opt-in online surveys and decline in live-caller phone polls, as documented by the Pew Research Center.

In a future article, I’ll look at how different methods compare in accuracy.

Worth your attention

A Democratic senator more popular with Republicans — Pennsylvania Sen. John Fetterman is a Democrat, but you wouldn’t know it from a New York Times/Philadelphia Inquirer/Siena College poll released this week.

Just 22 percent of Democratic registered voters rated Fetterman favorably, while 73 percent of Republicans rated him favorably. Those results mark a turnabout since 2024, when 74 percent of Democrats had a positive view of Fetterman compared with 25 percent of Republicans.

The Times noted that Fetterman has frequently appeared in conservative news media criticizing his fellow Democrats as too liberal, “turning himself into something of a modern-day political wrestling heel.”

The latest poll was conducted Aug. 17-21 among a random sample of 760 Pennsylvania registered voters sampled from a statewide voter list, with live interviewers calling cellphones and landlines. The margin of sampling error was plus/minus-4.5 percentage points.

Send your questions, comments and ideas to scott.clement@washpost.com.

Judge issues new block on Trump’s sweeping limits on mail-in ballots

The legal fight over the controversial measure is expected to continue

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL

A federal judge in Massachusetts on Thursday once again blocked major pieces of the Trump administration’s plan to impose sweeping restrictions on mail-in voting for November’s elections, but the legal fight will continue.

U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani issued a temporary restraining order halting parts of the effort that would bar the U.S. Postal Service from delivering mail-in ballots to voters not on a list of citizens created by federal agencies. It also requires mail-in ballot envelopes to have barcodes to thwart fraud.

The Trump administration notified the court Friday that it planned to appeal Talwani’s ruling.

The judge’s move continues a week of intense legal action over

the controversial executive order on mail-in voting issued by President Donald Trump. It is the subject of multiple legal challenges.

Trump has claimed voting by noncitizens is rampant, while court records and independent studies have found it to be rare.

Talwani said it would be impossible for many states to issue new envelopes for voting by mail, since some are supposed to send out ballots as early as next week. She also said the Trump administration had presented no evidence that noncitizen voting is a major issue.

The League of Women Voters and other voting rights groups are challenging the administration’s initiative, saying the measure could inject chaos into pivotal races that will decide control of the House and Senate.

Talwani echoed those concerns.

“The USPS’s interest in correcting an unsubstantiated problem through likely unconstitutional means is dwarfed by the overwhelming risk of pervasive disenfranchisement of citizens who need access to mail ballots in order to vote,” Talwani wrote.



MATT SLOCUM/AP

A worker processes mail-in ballots at the Bucks County Board of Elections in Pennsylvania in 2020.

In a separate challenge to the executive order brought by 23 states and the District of Columbia, the Supreme Court on Monday found the plaintiffs’ lawsuit was premature because the U.S. Postal Service had yet to issue final rules for how the order would be carried out.

After those rules were finalized Wednesday, the states and D.C. filed a new lawsuit challenging the executive order.

The injunction Talwani issued Thursday marked the second time she has blocked the executive order in the case brought by the voting rights groups. She lifted the earlier injunction after finding the Supreme Court’s logic applied to that case as well, but allowed the plaintiffs to ask for a new block.

Ultimately, the issue could end up before the Supreme Court again, but even if the admin-

istration prevails, it’s unclear whether there is enough time to implement the changes before November.

Many states will begin sending out mail-in ballots by mid-September, and election administrators have said it would be exceedingly difficult to comply with the executive order in time for the fall contests since preparations have been going on for months.

THE NATION

Report finds flaws in hunt for college shooter who later killed again

The findings raise questions about whether the assailant at Brown University could have been identified before he went on to kill an MIT professor

BY TODD WALLACK

The search for the Brown University shooter who killed two students and wounded nine others last December was complicated by a fragmented system for collecting and sifting through tips, delayed access to video from university cameras and valuable time spent investigating the wrong person, according to a report released Friday.

The findings, contained in a review commissioned by the city of Providence, Rhode Island, raise questions about whether law enforcement could have identified the shooter earlier, before he went on to kill a Massachusetts Institute of Technology professor near Boston.

“There’s all kinds of things that we know now that we didn’t and couldn’t have known then,” Providence Mayor Brett Smiley said in an interview. “But the ability to access additional video feeds and then to get that information out into the public to help with an identification, any of those little things could have helped.”

The shooting at Brown kicked off a five-day search for the killer.

A man burst into a classroom at the Ivy League school shortly after 4 p.m. on Dec. 13 and opened fire on students studying for an economics final exam. Ella Cook, 19, and Mukhammad Aziz Umurzokov, 18, were killed. Two days later, the man fatally shot MIT professor Nuno Loureiro at his home in Brookline, Massachusetts.

Police at the time did not know who committed the shootings, if they were related or whether the killer might strike again.

Law enforcement officers eventually tracked down the suspect’s rental car — in part thanks to a tip from a Brown alumnus publicly identified only as “John” who shared what he saw on Reddit and later with police.

That breakthrough helped police identify the shooter as Claudio Manuel Neves Valente, 48, a former Brown student who decades ago probably attended classes in the same building where the shooting occurred.

Valente was a former physics student from Portugal who attended graduate school at Brown for three semesters before taking a leave of absence in 2001 and formally withdrawing in 2003. Before that, he and Loureiro studied in the same physics program in Lisbon.

Authorities used financial records to identify Valente’s storage unit in New Hampshire, where they ultimately found his body and videos confessing to both shootings. A medical examiner determined Valente had died by suicide about two days before he was found.

The FBI said Valente did not reveal a motive in the videos. He was unemployed at the time, and the FBI said Brown and the MIT professor probably represented his personal failures and perceived injustices.

The after-action report was commissioned by the city and written by the Police Executive Research Forum, a D.C.-based nonprofit that provides guidance to law enforcement.

Overall, the report praises the city’s response to the shooting. It noted that Providence police and fire units arrived at the scene five minutes after the first 911 call. And the nonprofit found that the investigation and operational response demonstrated a “disciplined and effective approach.”

But the report also identified challenges.

Providence detectives did not immediately have access to Brown’s cameras, because they were separate from the city’s and did not feed into the Providence Police Department’s Real-Time Crime Center. The report also said there were further delays obtaining Brown’s surveillance video because of unidentified “access-related issues” at the school’s Department of Public Safety.

Once detectives saw the video, they noticed the shooter stood out: Cameras captured him calmly walking away from the scene while others frantically fled.

The report also said Brown officials initially told Providence detectives that campus shuttle buses could not record video. That proved incorrect, delaying access to additional footage showing where the shooter was



BING GUAN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Photos of victims Mukhammad Aziz Umurzokov, left, and Ella Cook at a memorial near campus.



JESSICA RINALDI/BOSTON GLOBE/GETTY IMAGES

A police officer takes down crime scene tape the day after the shooting at Brown University in December.

headed.

Had Providence police in the crime center had real-time access to Brown’s cameras, “it is possible that the assailant could have been identified and tracked as he left campus,” the report said.

Brown spokesman Brian Clark said the school is “committed to the strong collaboration and coordination with Providence and other local agencies.”

After publication of this story, the university released its own

report Friday afternoon that said the school hopes to reach an agreement to join the city’s Real-Time Crime Center, allowing it to share video with Providence police in real time.

The city’s report also notes that investigators spent signifi-

cant resources investigating the wrong person after the shooting. The FBI had detained a 24-year-old Wisconsin man at a Hampton Inn southwest of Providence for hours before concluding he was not involved. That temporarily narrowed the focus of the investigation, the report found.

To prepare for future emergencies, the report lists 18 recommendations, some of which the city says it has already implemented or begun to do so. Those suggestions include creating a new system to manage tips after a major incident, integrating Brown’s cameras with Providence’s crime center, and building a better structure for investigations involving multiple agencies.

“This isn’t a victory lap,” said Smiley, the mayor. “I want the community to know that we’ve asked hard questions of ourselves and we’re going to be making changes.”

Smiley and the city’s report also noted that Valente took steps to avoid detection, including replacing his rental car’s Florida license plate with one stolen from Maine, complicating efforts to track him down.

Still, the report leaves questions, such as whether the shooting could have been averted.

Three students who were

injured in the shooting sued the university in state court in April, alleging the school bears partial responsibility.

The students’ lawsuits contend Brown had inadequate security for an urban campus — including key gaps in its camera coverage.

The filings also note a Brown custodian tried to alert campus security after spotting Valente hanging around the building roughly a dozen times in the weeks before the shooting, including peering into classrooms. They say Brown did not act on that information. The law firm representing the students declined to comment.

Brown said its own external review concluded it was “highly unlikely” it could have prevented the December shooting.

In addition, the university said it has already taken steps to improve its security on campus, including adding more than 700 cameras. It expects to have a total of roughly 2,000 cameras in place by the time the fall semester begins next month.

The city’s report did not cover what happened before the attacks or whether they could have been prevented. Smiley said that’s because the report was focused on the city’s response to the Brown shooting.

The mayor also said he thought the custodian’s report appeared to go nowhere because it was made to a private security contractor, rather than Brown or Providence police. Brown said its review found no evidence that the custodian relayed his concerns about the suspicious person resembling Valente to his supervisor or Brown’s public safety office.

Another question is whether John, the reportedly homeless Brown alumnus who helped identify the shooter, ever received the \$50,000 reward offered by the FBI for tips leading to the identification, arrest and conviction of the person responsible.

In December, Rhode Island Attorney General Peter Neronha said that John’s tip “blew this case right open,” and the Providence mayor urged the FBI to give him the reward, even though the suspect could not be convicted of the crimes because he was dead.

The FBI declined to say whether it paid out the reward money, citing its long-standing policy, and John did not respond to a message via Reddit.

Smiley said he hasn’t heard whether John ever received the reward.

“I don’t think I’ll ever know if he did,” Smiley said.



BEN PENNINGTON/BOSTON GLOBE/GETTY IMAGES

People gather for a vigil in Providence, Rhode Island, on Dec. 14.

Measles’ role in child’s death pits Shapiro vs. RFK Jr.

Pa. governor accuses health secretary of sowing confusion

BY RACHEL ROUBEIN, LENA H. SUN AND CAITLIN GILBERT

Minutes before a news conference announcing two measles-related deaths in Pennsylvania, Gov. Josh Shapiro (D) had a heated call with the Trump administration’s top health official. Before television cameras on Tuesday, the governor accused Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. of sowing confusion about vaccines and contributing to the return of a disease the United States eliminated more than a quarter-century ago. Shapiro said he told Kennedy that the state did not want additional help from the federal government.

The exchange has erupted into an extraordinary public feud and set off a partisan flurry of accusations over outbreaks of the highly contagious disease, which is easily prevented by a vaccine. Shapiro and Kennedy have traded lengthy barbs on social media, accusing each other of fearmongering.

Scrutiny of Shapiro’s announcement deepened Thursday, after a county coroner said that the pathologist who examined a newborn who tested positive for measles did not believe the virus played a role in the baby’s death. Shapiro’s administration offered no details about the two people who died beyond describing them as unvaccinated Lancaster County residents.

On Friday afternoon, Shapiro’s office said the governor stood “firmly” by his earlier comments.

“At no point was the Pennsylvania Department of Health told by the coroner that this was not a measles-associated death,” spokeswoman Rosie Lapowsky said in a statement.

Kennedy and his allies have accused Shapiro’s administration of prematurely declaring that the outbreak had turned deadly. Some infectious-disease experts normally critical of Kennedy said Shapiro and his team should have offered more information from the start.

Democrats and public health experts contend that Kennedy — the founder of a prominent anti-vaccine group — has downplayed outbreaks of measles, and that his rhetoric over the years has undermined vaccination that could prevent or control the outbreaks. Some have gone so far as to blame Kennedy for several measles-associated deaths during President Donald Trump’s second term.

“Americans are DYING from measles — a preventable disease — because Trump and RFK Jr. have decimated trust in vaccines,” Sen. Patty Murray (D-Washington) posted on X.

Kennedy has a lengthy history of disparaging vaccines, including at a 2021 appearance in undervaccinated Lancaster County, Pennsylvania, where state health officials reported the two deaths. In response to criticism about Kennedy’s history of anti-vaccine activism, the White House often notes that Kennedy, as health secretary, has said that vaccination is “the most effective way to prevent the spread of measles” and that parents should get their children vaccinated for measles. Some public health experts have said Kennedy has muddled that message by falsely claiming that the vaccines are not safety tested.

The back-and-forth over Pennsylvania’s measles outbreak offers an early glimpse of how vaccines, infectious diseases and trust in government could become defining issues in the next presidential campaign. Democrats positioning themselves for 2028 have been eager to show they are taking on the Trump administration, and many embrace vaccines as a bipartisan general-election issue and an opportunity to depict Republicans as out of touch with science.

Shapiro, a governor in a presidential swing state who is cruising to reelection in November, is widely expected to run for president. Kennedy, who ran for president as an independent in 2024, has batted down speculation he would launch another campaign.

“Secretary Kennedy has stoked confusion amongst parents and others — and the result has been less protection from measles and more cases,” Shapiro posted Wednesday on X.

Kennedy has used his personal and official government social media accounts to contend that Shapiro is using the moment for



Pennsylvania Gov. and presidential hopeful Josh Shapiro (D), center, speaks to the press after an event last month to mark 100 days until the midterms. With him are congressional candidate Bob Brooks, left, and House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries (D-New York).

political gain. He suggested that the deaths “may even have been altogether fabricated by one of the Governor’s hopeful staffers.”

“Governor Shapiro’s unseemly rush to Lancaster County to convene a national press conference and his giddy delight in announcing two measles deaths was a morose commentary on the contemporary political dialogue,” Kennedy wrote on social media Wednesday.

As of Thursday, left-wing political influencers were talking about measles about five times more often than right-wing figures, according to a Washington Post analysis of their social media posts, podcasts and newsletters. The frequency of the mentions this week by the left is the highest since early 2025 during the West Texas measles outbreak, which infected more than 700 people and contributed to the deaths of two unvaccinated children.

In response to questions from The Post, Democratic House candidates in competitive Pennsylvania districts rallied behind Shapiro in his feud with Kennedy. Shapiro has focused his midterm strategy on boosting their campaigns, and victories would shore up his political brand ahead of a White House run.

“Public health is going to be very important in the debate for who becomes the next president,” said Hawaii Gov. Josh Green (D), a family physician and fierce critic of Kennedy. He said he and Shapiro have discussed launching a national vaccination campaign.

Pennsylvania political strategists and other state Democrats cautioned against interpreting Shapiro’s comments about Kennedy as presidential positioning, arguing that any governor confronting a ballooning outbreak with hundreds of infections would be obligated to challenge federal messaging he or she believed was harming residents.

“He’s absolutely doing the responsible thing and calling it out, and not just letting RFK say what he wants to say,” said Susan Wild, a former Democratic congresswoman from Pennsylvania.

The Pennsylvania measles outbreak also shows the tricky politics of public health, which has become increasingly polarized since the coronavirus pandemic and the rise of anti-vaccine misinformation. Shapiro has come under fire for how his administration has communicated about the deaths with unusually sparse detail that was contradicted by some local officials.

Lancaster County Coroner Stephen Diamantoni said in an interview that officials discovered signs of a measles infection in a newborn who died of a spleen laceration hours after birth on Aug. 14.

But Diamantoni said the forensic pathologist who conducted the autopsy did not believe measles played a role in the death. The coroner said his office shared this information with the state health department hours before Shapiro’s announcement.

State health officials have said they classify deaths as “measles-associated” when the virus is present, even if the disease is not identified as the immediate cause of death.



A young patient gets a measles, mumps and rubella (MMR) vaccine this month in Coral Gables, Florida.

Several infectious-disease experts said the governor, along with his health department, should have initially released more information about the deaths, such as the age of those infected. Instead, others including anti-vaccine activists have filled the void.

“A vacuum in public health information never stays empty — it gets filled by whoever moves fastest and cares least about accuracy,” Amesh Adalja, an infectious-disease physician in the Pittsburgh area, said in a text message. “The state and Gov. Shapiro’s communication failures and opacity invited RFK Jr and his allies in by engraved invitation and they now control the narrative while an unchecked measles outbreak spreads throughout the state.”

Measles cases grow

Measles cases in Pennsylvania, which reached 460 cases on Friday, began climbing during the summer, prompting state officials to warn of potential exposures at local stores and to host

pop-up vaccination clinics. The U.S. would soon report the most measles cases in any year since 1991, outpacing last year’s total with months of 2026 left to go.

Most children recover after several days of fever, cough and an itchy rash, but the disease can also cause pneumonia, brain swelling, deafness and intellectual disability. Fatalities have become extraordinarily rare, with nearly 1 to 3 of every 1,000 children infected dying of respiratory and neurologic complications, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

On Tuesday, state health department officials said they had confirmed two measles-associated deaths of individuals who were not vaccinated. The deaths in Lancaster County were the first related to measles in Pennsylvania in 35 years, they said, and the first deaths reported this year in the U.S.

At the press conference, Shapiro and health officials repeatedly said they would not be providing additional information to protect patient privacy.

Diamantoni, a Republican family doctor first elected coroner in 2007, said one of those cases was a newborn who died in a birthing center after a delivery with a midwife. The case, which state officials later confirmed was one of the two they announced, is still under investigation and does not bear the hallmarks of a measles death, he said.

Measles can cause significant inflammation to the spleen, making it more fragile and susceptible to life-threatening rupture, the state health department said Thursday. Diamantoni, who was not at the autopsy, said the pathologist told him the spleen was not enlarged and not inflamed.

But some have cast doubt on how the coroner could be so definitive. Paul Offit, an infectious-diseases physician at the Children’s Hospital of Philadelphia, said that once a spleen is ruptured, it’s difficult to tell whether it was enlarged. “If you find a deflated balloon, can you really tell how large it was to

begin with?” said Offit, who has been in touch with state health officials about the case.

The differing accounts prompted a Republican Lancaster County commissioner to lambaste the state’s handling of the death announcement.

“You cannot drop a bombshell like this and then essentially say all the information around it is top secret,” Josh Parsons, the commissioner, said in a lengthy X post on Thursday. Parsons did not respond to requests for comment.

Public health agencies generally provide basic information about the victims of disease outbreaks, such as age, gender and whether they had underlying health conditions, but with varying degrees of detail.

“The only way to remedy the confusing communication about these tragic deaths is to provide adequate information that clarifies the medical circumstances of those individuals while respecting the families at this difficult time,” said Demetre Daskalakis, the former director of the CDC center that oversees immunization and respiratory viruses, including measles, who resigned a year ago to protest what he called Kennedy’s politicization of science.

Will Simons, a spokesman for Shapiro, defended the limited disclosures as protecting patient confidentiality while promoting public health through quick disclosure of deaths. He said safeguarding patients’ information helps public health officials maintain the trust of their communities.

On Friday, Shapiro said the health department has shared all the information that it’s permitted to under state law, and that “those two deaths were measles related.” He said his health department is in “regular communication with the CDC and other federal agencies.”

“What does not serve the public interest right now is getting into a back-and-forth with people online who are spewing irresponsible conspiracy theories,” Shapiro said at a news conference announcing new funding for repairs to a local police department and municipal building.

A spokeswoman for Kennedy responded to questions by pointing to a CDC post on social media that said the agency was ready to help Pennsylvania respond to the outbreak. The CDC said Kennedy was trying to “clarify conflicting information” about the reported deaths and faulted the governor’s office for not providing information and declining offers of assistance. Pennsylvania officials disputed this account.

“Accuracy is critical to reliable national data, transparency, and public trust,” the CDC said on X.

Declining vaccination rates

Pennsylvania’s outbreak has unfolded as childhood measles vaccination rates have fallen statewide.

The share of kindergartners vaccinated against measles in Pennsylvania fell from 96.4 percent in 2019 to 93.2 percent in 2025, and vaccination rates have plummeted across much of the country since before the pandemic.

In Lancaster County, that drop was much steeper, with the rate falling from nearly 95 percent — the level experts consider necessary to prevent an infection from triggering an outbreak — to about 87 percent in the 2025-2026 school year. Over this same period, families seeking philosophical and religious exemptions from vaccine requirements doubled to 4.7 percent and 5.9 percent, respectively.

Lancaster is also home to the nation’s largest Amish community, which had a vaccination rate around 25 percent several years ago, according to state data. State officials have not said whether the outbreak is concentrated in Amish people.

Major Democratic rapid-response accounts like FactPost and Headquarters, as well as Democratic politicians, circulated a video clip of Kennedy downplaying measles during an appearance in Lancaster County in 2021.

“I am a measles survivor,” Kennedy, then the head of an anti-vaccine group, said to laughs from the crowd. “We had to stay home and watch TV the whole week with all of my brothers and sisters.”

He claimed, as he often had, that the cure for measles was chicken soup and vitamin A. And he warned some in the audience that government officials would do everything in their power to make them vaccinated.

Laura Beveridge contributed to this report.



Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. speaks during a meeting on vaccines this month alongside President Donald Trump and Heidi Overton, deputy director of the White House Domestic Policy Council.

Arrests of immigrants with no criminal record soar

ICE officers are shifting their targets and tactics to increase detentions

BY DAVID NAKAMURA AND EMMANUEL MARTINEZ

U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement is detaining more immigrants who do not have a criminal record than at any other point since President Donald Trump returned to the White House last year, according to newly released government data.

Trump officials have consistently stated that their goal is to keep Americans safe by targeting enforcement against “the worst of the worst” — undocumented immigrants who have committed violent crimes or repeated offenses. The new data, however, shows that more than half of all the people ICE arrested in July did not have a criminal record, the highest single-month total since January 2025.

The shift toward targeting more people with civil immigration violations but no criminal charges has helped ICE achieve record numbers of overall arrests. In all, federal authorities detained more than 49,000 migrants in July, the highest total during Trump’s second administration, according to a Washington Post analysis of government data. The ICE arrest data was made public by the Deportation Data Project, an outside group that obtained the material through a Freedom of Information Act lawsuit.

Immigration lawyers and analysts said the numbers reflect the Department of Homeland Security’s evolving approach as officials rush to fulfill Trump’s goals for the mass deportation campaign and more people lose protections shielding them from removal. The administration has canceled temporary protected status for hundreds of thousands of immigrants who fled dangerous countries and also arrested people with pending asylum claims and green-card applications who were not previously a target for enforcement.

“There is pressure on ICE to arrest more people and that leads them to stop trying to go after the worst of the worst and arrest the person who is easiest to locate on any given day,” said Julia Gelatt, an analyst at the Migration Policy Institute. “When Americans think of who they’d like to see ICE focus on, they think bad guys — murders and



ERIN HOOLEY/AP

More than half of the immigrants detained last month by federal immigration officers did not have a criminal record.

others serious criminals. They do not think about people who broke immigration laws and are otherwise law-abiding.”

In an email response to questions from The Post, a DHS spokesperson said the information used for this story has “not been reviewed, audited or given context” and said it is being used to “peddle a false narrative.” The spokesperson claimed that nearly 70 percent of the people ICE has arrested have criminal convictions or pending criminal charges, a figure the agency has cited repeatedly since last year.

“Every single one of these individuals committed a crime when they came into this country illegally,” the spokesperson said.

In fact, many of those detained entered the country legally, for example, on a visa that has since expired. Those individuals are generally facing civil immigration violations, not criminal charges, and they have increasingly become a focus of enforcement operations.

ICE has steadily ramped up detentions since arrests dropped below 30,000 in February amid

“There is pressure on ICE to arrest more people and that leads them to stop trying to go after the worst of the worst and arrest the person who is easiest to locate on any given day.”

Julia Gelatt, an analyst at the Migration Policy Institute

public outrage over the killings the previous month of two American citizens, Renée Good and Alex Pretti, by immigration officers in Minneapolis.

Since then, the number of people being detained has risen each month, climbing to more than 42,500 in June and increasing again in July, the federal data shows.

The jump coincides with a major expansion of DHS’s enforcement capabilities made possible after Congress last year approved more than \$170 billion in additional funding. The administration has hired thousands of additional ICE and Border Patrol officers, purchased

new surveillance technology and added more immigrant detention facilities.

The administration has also been expanding where and how it makes arrests. New partnerships with scores of local law enforcement agencies, many in conservative areas of the country, have allowed ICE to deputize officers and assist them in making immigration arrests.

“The spikes are happening at airports and everywhere they can,” said Margy O’Herron, an expert on national security and immigration law at the Brennan Center for Justice. “They are canceling visas for people who apply for asylum, folks who had some

protection from deportation before — people who the government knows who they are and knows where they live.”

ICE has arrested more than half a million people since Trump returned to office, and nearly 40 percent do not have a criminal record. As of Aug. 6, ICE had detained more people without a criminal record this year than in all of 2025. The administration has also already exceeded the number of people ICE detained during all of President Joe Biden’s presidency, as well as Trump’s first term and President Barack Obama’s last.

Art Arthur, a fellow at the Center for Immigration Studies, which advocates for stricter immigration controls, said the added resources at DHS have led to more arrests. He noted that Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin has increased efforts to persuade undocumented immigrants to voluntarily leave the country, including through cash stipends of \$2,600.

Immigrants would not be willing to take that offer if there was no legitimate threat of being

arrested and deported, Arthur said.

“You’re not going to get non-criminal aliens who have been here three years to leave unless there is a threat of enforcement,” he said.

The killings of Good and Pretti in Minneapolis led to a sharp drop in public support for Trump’s deportation agenda. The backlash contributed to the president’s decision to install Mullin as Homeland Security secretary. He replaced Kristi L. Noem, whose leadership was marked by a spate of officer-involved shootings and large-scale ICE and Border Patrol raids in U.S. cities.

Mullin has pursued what he characterized as a quieter approach that is focused less on showy displays of force.

The White House has pressed DHS to arrest at least 2,000 migrants a day, a target ICE achieved on four days over the summer. On July 13, an ICE officer fatally shot Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero, a 25-year-old Colombian immigrant, during a traffic stop in Biddeford, Maine.

ICE has maintained a high pace of arrests since then, averaging nearly 1,500 detentions a day, the data shows.

Democrats have assailed the administration’s approach, saying federal officers have terrorized immigrant communities, including children and the elderly. Maryland Gov. Wes Moore (D) said Tuesday that “a mere fraction” of more than 1,300 people detained by ICE in the past two weeks have criminal records.

Moore said his state would work with the federal government to apprehend violent offenders. But he said the broad targeting of immigrants has undermined the economy and frayed trust between immigrant communities and law enforcement.

“It does not make us safer,” Moore said in a statement.

In six states, arrests of immigrants without criminal records have more than doubled thus far in 2026 compared to all of last year. The largest jump has come in Maine, where ICE arrested 125 people in 2025 and already has detained about 330 this year. Arrests in Alabama, Wyoming, Idaho, Mississippi and Missouri also more than doubled.

Arrests decreased in more than 20 states, with the largest decline coming in the District of Columbia. ICE surged operations in the nation’s capital last year and, all told, arrested 1,200 people without criminal records in 2025. This year, ICE has thus far arrested 72 such immigrants in the city.

Traders anticipate interest rate hike by Fed as Warsh plays it close to the vest

INFLATION FROM AI

Warsh, 56, hailed developments in artificial intelligence as a “hinge point in history” that offered the “potential for substantially higher growth.” But that long-term promise is eclipsed for now by the need to vanquish inflation, he said.

“The Fed’s predominant focus right now should be on prices,” Warsh said. “We must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective, clearly and at sufficient speed. Otherwise, we have work to do.”

Warsh endorsed the Fed’s traditional inflation goal of an annual 2 percent rise in prices, according to the personal consumption expenditures index (PCE), calling it “a firm fixed target.”

Over the past six months, almost half of the individual product prices that the Fed tracks have increased at an annual rate of more than 3 percent. That share is down from the pandemic high point but “is still quite elevated,” Warsh said.

The central bank chief also responded to critics who questioned his inflation-fighting plan by saying the Fed’s control over short-term interest rates remained “the predominant tool” to achieve its goals. His embrace of rate-setting and the PCE index appeared aimed at clarifying remarks he made at his news conference in July, which suggested alternatives deserved consideration.

But Warsh doubled down on his controversial strategy of refusing to provide “forward guidance” about future Fed moves. “A quieter Fed,” he said, will be better able to steer the economy to stable prices and full employment.

“Transparency in communications about future policy decisions is not a virtue unto itself. Communications must be in

service to the Fed’s paramount responsibility: getting monetary policy right,” Warsh said.

In the run-up to Friday’s speech, investors were eager for any hint of Warsh’s thinking on when and if the Fed might raise short-term interest rates. His continued haziness on that point seemed to frustrate some in the audience.

Michael Strain, a former Fed economist, said Warsh had made similar comments in July while opposing an interest-rate increase. While his remarks Friday suggested that the Fed would eventually raise rates if inflation did not subside, Warsh offered no hint of the likely timing or what additional evidence he required before acting, said Strain, who is now with the American Enterprise Institute, a center-right think tank.

“Markets are looking for clarity,” Strain said. “You don’t know the timing that he has in mind about when the Fed should respond to the combination of a full employment economy with inflation stuck above target.”

Adam Posen, president of the Peterson Institute for International Economics, said Warsh was suggesting that “the best thing to do is to make up your mind at the last minute in a nontransparent way which has no consistent record” of success.

The yield on the two-year Treasury note, which is most sensitive to Fed rate increases, rose to 4.31 percent as Warsh was speaking, compared to 4.23 percent before he began. Stock markets were largely flat.

Warsh’s remarks were among the most highly anticipated by any Fed chair at the central bank’s annual late-summer conference, which is hosted by the Federal Reserve Bank of Kansas City and draws global central bankers, economists and journalists to Wyoming’s spectacular Grand Tetons.



NATALIE BEHRING/GETTY IMAGES

Federal chair Kevin Warsh in Wyoming on Friday. He doubled down on refusing to provide “forward guidance” on future Fed moves.

Since taking over from his predecessor, Jerome H. Powell, Warsh has been unsparing in his criticism of the Fed for failing to control inflation, which has been elevated for more than five years, since the covid pandemic. In a nod perhaps to the populist president who appointed him to his job, Warsh said “hardworking Americans,” not “financial highfliers,” are suffering the most from the Fed’s failure to bring inflation under control.

The chair faces a daunting landscape. He leads a divided Fed with at least three members of its rate-setting committee on record supporting an increase in

interest rates to slow rising prices. Long-term bond yields have ticked higher this month amid concerns over the nation’s \$40 trillion gross public debt. And Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has intervened in financial markets in a way that some analysts say could conflict with Warsh’s goals.

While managing those immediate concerns, Warsh seeks to pilot the economy through an era of epic change. The rules-based global order constructed at the end of World War II is breaking down as the United States and other nations seek greater self-sufficiency. And a

disruptive new technology, artificial intelligence, is reshaping markets and economies at a rapid clip.

After his tight-lipped news conference late last month, analysts at investment banks including JPMorgan said Warsh’s refusal to elaborate on how he planned to fight inflation raised doubts about whether he was willing to raise short-term borrowing costs to do so. Those concerns were amplified by President Donald Trump’s vocal insistence that rates should move down, not up, under the new Fed chair.

But Warsh said he is deter-

mined to force investors to make their own decisions independent of expectations about moves by the nation’s central bank. Although forward guidance was “essential” during the 2008 financial crisis, he said Friday, “I believe the practice has overstayed its welcome.”

Financial markets have shown little concern about Warsh’s public reticence. Inflation expectations are little changed since the day he was sworn in as Fed chair. Volatility in stock and bond trading also has remained within normal ranges, according to standard market measures.

Recent economic data suggesting an improved outlook for the economy may explain part of the recent uptick in bond yields. While the economy grew at an unremarkable annual rate of 1.5 percent in the second quarter, underlying measures of activity were far stronger, according to a Commerce Department update this week.

Final sales to private domestic purchasers, which some economists consider a better gauge of the economy’s condition, rose by an updated 4.2 percent compared with an initial estimate of 3.9 percent, the Commerce Department said. Both consumer spending and business investment are keeping the economy aloft.

A separate report showed that inflation remained elevated in July, with the Fed’s preferred gauge up 3.7 percent from the same month one year ago. That pace was unchanged from June, but it remained well above the Fed’s 2 percent target.

At its last meeting in July, the Fed policymaking committee left short-term interest rates unchanged. But three voting members of the Federal Open Market Committee dissented from the 9-person majority that favored keeping rates in the current 3.5 percent to 3.75 percent range.

Trump denied in hush money case

President’s latest bid to erase his conviction is rejected by a federal judge

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK

A federal judge on Friday rejected President Donald Trump’s latest bid to erase his hush money conviction, ruling he had waited too long to try to move the case to federal court where his lawyers have argued he would enjoy broader immunities from prosecution.

U.S. District Judge Alvin K. Hellerstein said that if Trump’s legal team wanted to pursue that option, they should have done so shortly after the May 2024 guilty verdict in New York state court.

They waited nearly two months while first petitioning the New York state judge overseeing the case to throw out the conviction based on the 2024 Supreme Court ruling that granted presidents broad protections from prosecution for official actions they took while in office.

But even if Trump had made that push in a timely fashion, there was no legal basis for removal, Hellerstein concluded.

“The grounds for ... removal cited by Defendant, Donald J. Trump, are neither new nor legally sufficient,” the judge wrote.

“He has failed to show good cause and diligence.”

A spokesperson for Trump’s legal team, in a statement, called Hellerstein’s decision “baseless and lawless.” Within hours, the president’s attorneys filed notice they would appeal.

“The Supreme Court’s historic decision on Immunity, the Federal and New York State Constitutions, and other established legal precedent mandate that the Witch Hunt perpetrated by the Manhattan DA be removed to federal court, and immediately overturned and dismissed,” the spokesperson’s statement read.

A New York jury convicted Trump on 34 felony counts of falsifying business records to conceal a hush money payment to adult-film actress Stormy Daniels, whose allegations of an affair with Trump threatened to upend his 2016 presidential campaign.

He was sentenced, shortly before the start of his second term, to an unconditional discharge, sparing him prison time but leaving his conviction in place. Trump has denied Daniels’s



MANUEL BALCE CENETA/AP

President Donald Trump was convicted in 2024 of falsifying business records to conceal a payment to adult-film actress Stormy Daniels.

claims and that he committed any crimes.

Hellerstein, an appointee of President Bill Clinton, has twice denied similar bids from Trump to move the case to federal courts — first after he was indicted; then again after his conviction.

The judge’s decision Friday came after a federal appeals court sent the question back to Hellerstein last year, saying the judge needed to more carefully consider whether some of the evidence used in Trump’s trial would have been deemed inadmissible under the Supreme

Court’s immunity ruling.

In his decision Friday, Hellerstein was unequivocal on that point.

“There is no way that discussions regarding hush money payments to cover up the President’s relations with Stormy Daniels could be an official act,”

he wrote. “An affair, or a cover-up of an affair, is not within the ‘outer perimeter’ of the President’s official responsibilities.”

In addition to the matter before Hellerstein, the president has also asked a New York state appellate court to overturn the conviction.

Americans have turned against law enforcement’s use of AI-powered cameras

FLOCK FROM AI

tial for invasive monitoring and police misuse.

The cameras have been widely promoted as a crime-fighting breakthrough by private companies such as Flock, which since 2017 has installed more than 120,000 of them nationwide. But in a YouGov survey shared exclusively with The Washington Post, Americans said the systems wouldn’t make them feel any safer and they were reluctant to have the cameras installed near their homes.

Those findings follow a spike in online criticism of Flock by prominent right- and left-wing accounts, which exploded in early summer around the same time that some Republicans derided the technology as part of a “mass surveillance network,” according to a Post analysis of podcast appearances, speeches and social media posts.

Since then, right-wing accounts have posted about Flock cameras more than three times as often as left-wing ones, the analysis found. Sen. Josh Hawley (R-Missouri), chairman of the Senate Judiciary subcommittee on crime and counterterrorism, posted dozens of times about launching a federal investigation into the technology’s use. Rep. Chip Roy (R-Texas) posted last month on X, “Mass Surveillance + Government + AI is a very, very bad combo for freedom.”

The companies and their defenders say the cameras help stop kidnappings, find fugitives and investigate violent attacks. Nearly 40 percent of the nation’s roughly 18,000 law enforcement agencies have contracts with Flock, said the company, which claims that its systems help officers investigate 1 million crimes per year.

The tools have also raised concern because they record the movements of innocent people and can be transformed into personal spy devices. The Post reported this month that at least 69 police officials have been accused, charged with or convicted of misusing license-plate readers for unauthorized purposes, including to stalk their girlfriends or ex-wives.

Though Democrats and Republicans differed on some questions of personal privacy and police power, the YouGov survey found broad bipartisan consensus for the idea that police should need a warrant before accessing license-plate data, with about three-quarters of Democrats and roughly 6 in 10 independents and Republicans agreeing.

Officers do not currently need a warrant to search most license-plate-reader systems, which can include months of location records for cars, even those thousands of miles away. Proponents of the systems say a warrant requirement would hamstring the systems’ effectiveness during emergencies.

A Flock spokesman disputed some of YouGov’s questions, saying the firm had not explained



RON WILKINS/JOURNAL & COURIER/USA TODAY NETWORK

Demonstrators this month protested the use of Flock surveillance cameras in Lafayette, Indiana. Flock has faced widespread criticism.



BRIAN SNYDER/REUTERS

A Flock camera. Flock has installed more than 120,000 of them nationwide since 2017.

the technology in a neutral way, and said other polls had found broader support for license-plate readers when their investigative benefits were more clearly stated.

“We know from our data and from customers we hear from every day that there is wide support for ALPR technology,” the spokesman said in a statement.

Flock chief executive Garrett Langley has publicly defended its system in interviews, saying the company has implemented

safeguards to combat abuse and that the tool is vital to protecting Americans’ security and peace of mind.

“When people talk about just one of these, privacy or safety, they’re prioritizing the wrong thing,” he told Fox News last week. “What we have to prioritize as a country is compromise.”

The Post also shared the survey’s findings with some of the country’s other major sellers of license-plate readers, including Axon, Motorola Solutions and

Leonardo. The companies did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Automated license-plate readers, known as ALPRs, have scanned major roadways from tollbooths and police cruisers for more than two decades. But Flock’s pursuit of small-town contracts and its low-cost subscription model have fueled a recent boom in installations for the shoebox-size cameras and made them increasingly prominent on Americans’ daily commutes.

The systems saw broad support as recently as last year, but protests and recent reporting on misuse cases have coincided with a reversal of public sentiment. A YouGov survey this week of approximately 20,000 U.S. adults found that 46 percent said they oppose the technology being used in their communities, compared with 38 percent support.

When asked the same question last year, 33 percent voiced opposition and 45 percent voiced support. The change was largely driven by a spike in opposition among Democrats and independents, with only a slight uptick in Republicans’ disapproval, the survey said.

In a separate YouGov survey of about 1,000 U.S. adults shared with The Post, Americans were roughly split on their support for the license-plate readers being installed in their communities but narrowly opposed the cameras being installed on the streets where they lived.

Many said they were not sold on the companies’ promises of stopping crime. About 43 percent said the systems would make them feel “neither safer nor less safe,” while 27 percent said they felt safer. Thirty-eight percent said they didn’t believe the cameras reduced nearby crime, compared with 30 percent who did.

Just over half said protecting people’s privacy was more important than giving law enforcement more tools to address crime. And more than 4 in 10

said they were concerned about government surveillance and police misconduct in their communities, ranking them as more serious problems than illegal immigration. About 70 percent said government surveillance had “increased a lot” over the past 25 years, with around half saying the monitoring was “too much.”

Americans broadly disagreed with the industry’s business model, with 4 in 10 saying license-plate reader companies should not be allowed to charge police agencies for data access. Majorities said police should be allowed to use the cameras to track down stolen cars, find missing people or investigate violent crime, but many also said police should be banned from using the systems to track political protesters, non-U.S. citizens with temporary legal status, or pregnant women in abortion-restricted states.

While two-thirds of Americans said they believed officers often or sometimes used the cameras to solve crimes, more than 4 in 10 said they believed the cameras were also used to stalk or harass private citizens, or to build criminal cases against innocent people.

The YouGov surveys were conducted among U.S. adults through the firm’s opt-in online panel, which was weighted to match population demographics, partisanship and the 2024 presidential vote.

The findings could galvanize a growing pushback in Congress across the political divide from senators such as Ron Wyden (D-Oregon), who has said Flock abuse is “not only likely but inevitable,” and representatives such as Andrew Clyde, a Republican from Flock’s corporate home state of Georgia, who said last month on X that “Flock cameras belong in Communist China, not the United States of America.”

Political candidates have also started to make camera misuse a part of their platform. Angie Nixon, a Democrat in the Florida House who is running for U.S. Senate, said in a TV interview this week, “I don’t want to defund the police, I want to defund Flock cameras so that bad cops don’t have the ability to stalk their ex-girlfriends.”

Cowgur, the council member in Centerton, said the neighbors he has talked to in his corner of the Bentonville suburbs have increasingly said they don’t like the idea of information about their drives being recorded and stored in an online database. He added that he did not believe the cameras had helped solve a significant number of local crimes. The Centerton police did not respond to requests for comment.

When the city adopted the cameras, leaders thought “this was a way to really protect and serve the city,” he said. “Do you want somebody looking in your backyard 24 hours a day, or do you want to have a little bit of a wall of privacy, you know?”

Scott Clement contributed to this report.



Neal Tomita, 79, plays the harmonica during a virtual class for people with Parkinson's disease and their care partners. Speech and voice changes are common in people with Parkinson's disease.

A musical approach to treating Parkinson's disease

Harmonica lessons could be helping patients regain their voices

BY MEERI KIM

About a decade ago, Neal Tomita started to lose his voice. He has Parkinson's, and voice and speech problems are a common issue, affecting up to 90 percent of people as the neurological disease advances.

His once-lively speech began to fade into a quiet mumble, and people struggled to understand him. He increasingly retreated into silence and became socially withdrawn, even from his wife.

"Neal and I used to have fabulous conversations about everything, and suddenly we didn't. It got really lonely," said Cheryl Lippman, who has been married to Tomita for 27 years. "Plus, I'm hard of hearing and wear hearing aids. It's this cosmic joke: He speaks soft, and I can't hear."

Speech and voice changes are common in people with Parkinson's disease because the same neurological factors that cause tremors and stiffness in the body also affect muscles in the face, mouth and throat. To strengthen his voice, Tomita started going to speech therapy every month and completed speech treatment programs designed specifically for Parkinson's.

About two years ago, Tomita and Lippman together picked up an unexpected hobby that they say has helped him speak louder, communicate more confidently and reconnect with others: playing the harmonica.

"I never imagined that a simple harmonica could make such a meaningful difference in my life," said Tomita, who has no musical background. "It has helped me find my voice again."

Tomita and Lippman, both 79 and longtime residents of Oahu, Hawaii, are participants in the Harmonica Parkinson's Project, a program that teaches people with the progressive movement disorder how to play the harmonica with the goal of maintaining or improving speech.

The project is the brainchild of Kevin Lockette, a physical therapist based in Honolulu, who leads both in-person sessions and free virtual classes twice a month for anyone with Parkinson's and their care partners. No musical background is required.



Tomita and his wife, Cheryl Lippmann, at their home in Honolulu.

"I've been working with Parkinson's for 30 years, but I've been playing harmonica for probably 40 years," said Lockette, co-owner of Ohana Pacific Rehab and vice president of the Hawai'i Parkinson Association. "People with Parkinson's often have problems with phonation, pitch, articulation and saliva management — and ironically, those are the things that you work on when you're playing the harmonica."

The idea of using music — and even the harmonica — to help people with Parkinson's isn't new. Music therapy, which can include activities such as singing, dancing and drumming, has been linked to improvements in movement symptoms, speech, cognitive issues and mental health for people with the condition.

Singing is thought to increase vocal strength and the ability to articulate words, and humming exercises may relax tense vocal folds. Music therapists and musicians have taught harmonica to groups of people with Parkinson's for years in an effort to increase respiratory function,

lung capacity and loudness.

In the early 1990s — well before the days of Zoom — two Virginia musicians gave lessons and hundreds of free harmonicas to Parkinson's support groups across North America. And MusicWorx, a music therapy company based in San Diego, offers a 12-week harmonica class for people with Parkinson's and their care partners.

In May, Lockette and his colleagues presented the results of a pilot study at the World Parkinson Congress exploring harmonica lessons as a treatment for speech difficulties related to Parkinson's. In the study, researchers randomized 22 people with Parkinson's — including Tomita — into two groups: One joined in-person harmonica



Kevin Lockette leads a Harmonica Parkinson's Project class.

lessons twice a week for three months, and the other received traditional speech therapy.

A speech therapist and neurologist tested participants before and after the intervention to look for improvements in speech and other characteristics.

Although a small sample, the harmonica group showed greater improvements in factors such as speech intelligibility and average vocal intensity than the control group.

While a larger clinical trial is needed to prove whether there's a benefit, the study successfully demonstrated the feasibility — and joy — of group harmonica classes for Parkinson's.

"For the first time in a long while, I saw Neal smile with con-

fidence as he played alongside others who truly understood what he was going through," said Lippman, one of four care partners who joined the lessons during the study. "It has not only improved Neal's speech, but it has also enriched both of our lives."

In traditional speech therapy for Parkinson's, the therapist helps patients focus on speaking louder and with purposeful effort by using daily exercises that include holding musical notes and repeating phrases. Neurologist Michael Okun, who was not involved in the research, believes that playing the harmonica in addition to speech therapy may have benefits for people with Parkinson's.

"Those musicians have to coordinate both their facial muscles and tongue movements, and that coordination can be good for diseases like Parkinson's," said Okun, explaining that it also might help prevent aspiration pneumonia, a lung infection caused by inhaling food or liquid.

Parkinson's has become the fastest-growing neurological

disorder in the world, with the number of people living with the disease more than doubling in the past 25 years. By 2050, an estimated 25.2 million people are projected to be living with the condition worldwide.

While speech impairments are common, the vast majority of people with Parkinson's do not receive speech therapy because of an overshadowing focus on movement-related issues, such as tremors, stiffness and slowness. And traditional speech exercises can be challenging for some to maintain on a daily basis.

"There are multiple guidelines out there saying that physical therapy, occupational therapy, and speech and swallow therapy are critical and should be used in Parkinson's disease," said Okun, executive director of the Norman Fixel Institute for Neurological Diseases and medical adviser for the Parkinson's Foundation. "Only a small percentage of people actually utilize it."

Many people with Parkinson's and their loved ones say that communication challenges brought on by the disease is one of the hardest parts of living with it.

When Tomita was diagnosed with Parkinson's at 55, he and Lippman tried everything to combat his symptoms and delay the progression of the disease. Exercise is known to help slow those symptoms, and as an avid cyclist, he continued to ride around Oahu for many years, even completing the epic 100-mile Honolulu Century Ride. Over the years, the couple participated in boxing, Pilates, yoga, tai chi, aikido and water aerobics. Aside from staying active, he was prescribed medication and later underwent surgery for deep brain stimulation, which initially helped improve many of his movement symptoms.

When his voice started fading, Lippman took him to a speech-language pathologist for therapy sessions, and Tomita began daily exercises at home to maintain speech improvements.

Together, the couple continues to take part in virtual harmonica lessons. Lockette also posts free on-demand video lessons on the Harmonica Parkinson's Project's YouTube channel.

"The lessons are open to anyone that has Parkinson's and their caregivers — and actually, if other people want to join in, I don't tell anybody no," Lockette said. "Just make sure you have a harmonica in the key of C, and you're all good."

"I never imagined that a simple harmonica could make such a meaningful difference in my life. It has helped me find my voice again."

Neal Tomita, who started to lose his voice about a decade ago

Schools, cities face cost of decades-old abuse claims

Long-delayed justice comes with a financial reckoning

BY HANNAH KNOWLES

LOS ANGELES — For victims of child sex abuse, a 2019 California law expanding the time frame to sue brought long-delayed accountability.

For local governments paying the bills for employees’ decades-old crimes, the litigation unleashed a financial nightmare. Settlements broke records. Insurance costs for school districts spiked. One city declared “fiscal distress” after paying more than \$229 million over an ex-police dispatcher — more than a quarter of its annual budget.

Now, seven years after the law passed, California officials are wrestling with an uncomfortable question: Has the cost been too high?

“I fully support accountability ... but I also believe it has to be reasonable,” said Diana Rigby, the superintendent for a small school district in Carpinteria, California, that was sued over a principal convicted of molesting boys in the 1980s.

The school district sold property and borrowed money to settle its cases for \$5.75 million, she said. “And that’s costing me for the next 10 years.”

School associations and other groups have been pressing California legislators to place more restrictions on the right to sue. Lawmakers reached a last-minute deal on the issue this week, with days to go before they adjourn for the year. The amended bill would include anti-fraud measures and require more evidence in some cases, but it would not cap damages or change the statute of limitations. The changes fell short of what many local officials wanted.

“California stands with survivors, whose voices have shaped this process every step of the way, and the Legislature is taking action to defend and preserve survivors’ path to justice — that is not negotiable,” said California State Assembly Speaker Robert Rivas (D).

Victim advocates say they deserve justice, however delayed.

“The solution is not to cut the victims off,” said Patrick McNicholas, a lead lawyer on a \$4 billion settlement last year with Los Angeles County. Officials and attorneys say it is the largest child sex abuse settlement in U.S. history.

The 2019 law, he said, “has



PATRICK T. FALLON/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Officials and attorneys say a Los Angeles County \$4 billion settlement last year is the largest child sex abuse settlement in U.S. history.

done a tremendous amount of good.”

Many states expanded child sex abuse victims’ ability to sue in recent years, after the #MeToo movement stirred public outrage and raised new awareness of the reasons survivors might struggle to come forward. Some states, such as Maryland and Vermont, got rid of the statute of limitations entirely. Others created temporary windows for people victimized at any time to bring a lawsuit.

California previously allowed child sex abuse victims to sue up until the age of 26. The 2019 law changed that cutoff to 40 years old — or within five years of the date the victim discovers that sexual assault caused psychological injury. It also made it easier to sue local governments, officials say.

That paved the way for Jimmy Vigil, 46, to sue Los Angeles County. As a teenager in juvenile detention, Vigil said, he was

Many states expanded child sex abuse victims’ ability to sue in recent years, after the #MeToo movement stirred public outrage.

physically and sexually abused by staff.

When he resisted a doctor’s inappropriate touching, he said, he ended up in solitary confinement. When he tried to report a probation staffer for sexual abuse, he was threatened and told, “you need to pick your battles wisely,” he recounted.

Decades later, after the 2019 law passed, he learned he had a chance to sue. Other victims had similar accounts that helped corroborate his own.

He’s glad to see some accountability, he said — “the only form of justice” available to many. But he also understands some local officials’ concerns about the costs.

“Especially if it’s taking away from schools districts — if it’s taking away from programs like this,” he added, nodding at his work for a mental health program at a nonprofit contracted by Ventura County.

Concerns about fraud have complicated the issue further. This summer, the Los Angeles County district attorney sought unsuccessfully to halt payments in the county’s \$4 billion settlement, suggesting that as many as 4 out of 5 claims could be fraudulent.

Victim lawyers dismissed that number, and the Los Angeles County counsel’s office said plaintiffs go through a robust vetting process before getting paid.

The county still faces 5,400 claims not covered by its settlements, officials said.

“The legislative relief the County is seeking in Sacramento is anti-fraud, not anti-survivor and is intended to curb fraudulent and abusive attorney practices enabled by [the 2019 law],” Los Angeles County CEO Joseph M. Nicchitta said in a statement. “Without changes to the law, the threat to our social safety net remains unlimited.”

Local officials and their allies lobbied state legislators to cap damages in lawsuits against public entities and raise the evidentiary requirements for claims, among other changes.

On the other side of the debate are advocates like John Manly, a lawyer for victims who ran ads denouncing a previous effort to curb the lawsuits as a

“Predator Shield Law.”

“Within 48 hours of the ads going up ... the bill was dropped,” said Manly, who represented victims in a major settlement over sex abuse by former Team USA gymnastics doctor Larry Nassar.

As the lawsuits pile up, insurance costs have spiked even in districts without big settlements, officials say. At a recent news conference, a leader with the Huntington Beach City School District said per-student costs for liability and property insurance — combined with extra insurance costs spurred by the lawsuits — have roughly quadrupled to \$314 since 2019.

“It means less money is available to hire and pay teachers,” said Gary Stine, the assistant superintendent of administrative services. “It means increased class sizes, delayed projects ... It means that we’re not able to add additional counseling support that is being requested by our community.”

Ballroom completion claim in filings is contradicted by budget, other records

BALLROOM FROM A1

construction cost that Clark provided the White House in March. The Post has previously reported that cost estimate.

In the same mid-August court filing in which the administration claimed 65 percent of the project was done, it said that it had already spent “around \$200 million.”

If the government had spent \$200 million on the East Wing project, the work would be just 33 percent complete, based on the \$600 million budget estimate.

“You really want to understand why there’s such a big gap there,” said Carl Elefante, a retired D.C.-area architect and former president of the American Institute of Architects. In response to The Post’s findings, he called the government’s claim about the completion percentage “doubtful.”

The 65 percent claim was made in a sworn declaration by Joshua Fisher, the director for White House Management and Administration, who is overseeing the construction project. In the declaration, Fisher did not explain how the percentage was calculated but said, “Work has progressed too far to go back to the drawing board.”

His assertion came as the administration asked the Supreme Court to allow work on the ballroom to continue after lower courts ruled that the project was probably illegal without congressional approval and that construction must stop. The administration argued in part that stopping work while courts considered the merits of the case brought by the National Trust for Historic Preservation would cause “chaos in service of nothing” because the project had already progressed “beyond the point of judicial intervention.”

The White House did not



JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

Marine One flies over the construction site for the White House ballroom on Aug. 21. The White House says it is 65 percent complete.

answer The Post’s questions about the 65 percent figure and instead provided a statement from spokesman Davis Ingle. “President Trump continues to implement long-overdue and necessary renovations to beautify the People’s House as we approach our great Nation’s 250th anniversary of independence,” the statement said. “Thanks to the Builder-in-Chief, the White House will be properly glorified and remain in excellent condi-

tion for generations to come.”

The Justice Department, which represents the administration in court, did not immediately respond to a request for comment. Fisher did not respond to a request for comment. Clark referred questions to the White House.

Clark’s contract says the company will be paid monthly based on the percentage of total work that has been done. This is common in the industry, according

to eight construction experts consulted by The Post who said that dollars spent is the standard method for measuring completion of large-scale construction projects.

Even if progress was measured according to Trump’s repeated claim that the ballroom will cost \$400 million, paid for by private donors, it would be considered only halfway complete.

In public statements, the

president has sometimes drawn a distinction between funding for the ballroom and security improvements tied to it, which the administration has acknowledged will be paid for by the Secret Service and the military. Clark’s March budget estimate indicated that half the total \$600 million cost was to be paid for with tax dollars.

In its request to the Supreme Court to allow construction to proceed, the administration

appeared to draw a similar distinction between the overall project, which includes a secure underground bunker, and the ballroom, writing: “The Project is on time and under budget, and the ballroom is funded with approximately \$400 million in private donations ... zero taxpayer dollars are needed or required.”

Measured by the expected duration of the work, the project is about 30 percent complete, according to the administration’s timeline.

Fisher said in his declaration that construction began in late October 2025 and is expected to be complete in August 2028. That puts the work 10 months into a 34-month construction schedule.

The president is still tinkering with the overall plans for the East Wing, according to three people who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to describe internal discussions.

Some of those changes involve the ballroom’s exterior. Renderings that the administration shared with the Supreme Court this month included the addition of a new feature that Trump picked out — golden seals on the exterior of the ballroom — and the restoration of another feature, a staircase, that had been included in prior plans before being abandoned.

One of the people with knowledge of the project said construction was not nearly 65 percent complete. “I’m not sure they’re 65 percent complete with *designing* the ballroom,” the person said, mocking the administration’s claims. “The ballroom continues to undergo significant changes to the base design, even while construction is ongoing.”

Justin Jouvenal contributed to this report.

Wyo. vote monitors accused of ‘aggressive’ actions

GOP governor seeks probe, says observers exceeded their authority

BY LAURA MECKLER AND JEREMY ROEBUCK

The governor of Wyoming voiced concern this week about “aggressive” and “irregular” conduct by election monitors sent by the Justice Department during the state’s primary election.

A local elections official also voiced profound concerns about the monitors’ behavior, which she said went beyond their purview, including a request to examine voting machines. President Donald Trump and some of his allies have fixated on these machines, asserting without evidence that they are unreliable, but examining them is not part of the monitors’ duties.

The Justice Department sent two attorneys to Laramie County, the state’s most populous, as part of its “monitoring initiative.”

The agency has long sent federal monitors to observe elections, but Wyoming Gov. Mark Gordon (R) said their behavior during the Aug. 18 primary was inappropriate.

He told the state canvassing board this week that he had asked the Wyoming attorney general to investigate.

“The behavior of the observers was a bit aggressive ... it was just irregular,” the governor said at the Wednesday meeting. “Their behavior seems to exceed what the authority that Congress had given them was.”

He said the monitors said they were examining compliance with the Americans With Disabilities Act and civil rights law.

“I feel very strongly about federal government coming in and taking our guns,” Gordon said. “I don’t like that, and I don’t like the federal government coming in and taking our votes, either.”

Gordon said that to his knowledge, the local U.S. attorney was unaware of the deployment this month. A spokesperson for U.S. Attorney for Wyoming Darin D. Smith did not immediately respond to a request for comment.



Wyoming Gov. Mark Gordon (R) speaks at an event in Oklahoma City this month.

A Justice Department official in Washington said Smith was notified.

The Justice Department’s Civil Rights Division routinely sends attorneys and staff to polling places to assess compliance with federal voting laws, including the Voting Rights Act and the Americans With Disabilities Act. The department separately deploys federal observers, who have specific authority under the Voting Rights Act to enter polling and vote-counting sites in jurisdictions covered by federal court orders. The two monitors in Wyoming were Civil Rights Division attorneys, the agency said.

Historically, such monitors and federal intervention have been used to protect voting rights, especially for historically disenfranchised groups.

But Democrats have raised concerns about how such monitors could be used in the upcoming election, given Trump’s false claims of election tampering and unsupported allegations of voter fraud. Some worry that Trump will use the machinery of the federal government to restrict votes or interfere if Republicans suffer losses in this fall’s mid-term elections.

Trump has said Republicans should “nationalize the voting” and “take over the voting.” The Constitution gives states and

Congress — not the president — authority over election administration.

Harmeet K. Dhillon, the assistant attorney general who leads the Justice Department’s Civil Rights Division, said this month that the agency planned to deploy about 1,000 poll monitors to observe voting across the country on Election Day — a number she described as “historic” for a Republican administration.

She did not say where the monitors would be sent or how this year’s deployment would differ from previous ones. Concerns about the behavior of monitors in Wyoming were also voiced by Laramie County Clerk Debra Lee. She said in a written statement that two election monitors asked questions that appeared “outside the scope of federal voting rights laws.”

“They included questions about the nature, length, and timing of poll worker training. Monitors requested training guides, asked how our new election equipment was acquired, and wanted to examine our tabulators,” she said.

She said that the monitors also wanted to interview voters “to assess compliance with federal civil rights and voting rights law” but that she denied the request.

“We do not allow interviews to

be conducted in polling places,” Lee said.

“This was a poorly managed exercise and one that showed complete disregard for our state laws and administration of our elections,” her statement said.

The Justice Department official in Washington, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss details of the incident, disputed some aspects of these claims.

The monitors in Cheyenne, the official said, asked election workers if they had handicap-accessible voting locations — a question the official described as “common” to ensure compliance with federal law. The Justice Department official insisted, contrary to the local official’s account, that the monitors did not ask to inspect any voting machines. The department did not answer whether the monitors requested training guides, asked how the equipment was acquired or sought to interview voters.

A Justice Department spokesperson pointed to a statement Smith’s office issued on Election Day. “Voters deserve absolute confidence that their ballots are secure and their voices are heard without interference,” Smith said. “We are working alongside local officials to ensure every lawful vote is protected.”

British provocateur held by ICE, faces removal

BY ELAHE IZADI AND NATALIE ALLISON

Milo Yiannopoulos, the British far-right provocateur and former Yezezy executive, has been taken into custody by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement in Louisiana and is awaiting deportation.

ICE arrested Yiannopoulos on Thursday at the Louis Armstrong New Orleans International Airport, according to a statement from a Department of Homeland Security spokesperson, who referred to him as an “illegal alien from the United Kingdom” who legally entered the U.S. in 2019 but then “chose to overstay his welcome in violation of our nation’s laws.”

According to the agency, an immigration judge issued Yiannopoulos a final order of removal on July 22 after he did not show up to his immigration hearing. The statement said the Trump administration is “working diligently to ensure that aliens in our country illegally can no longer fly unless it is out of our country to self-deport.”

Immediate attempts to reach a representative for Yiannopoulos were unsuccessful.

Yiannopoulos was born in England and became a highly controversial figure in American politics, starting during Donald Trump’s rise in 2016, when Yiannopoulos worked as an editor for Stephen K. Bannon’s Breitbart.

While Yiannopoulos emerged as a leader in the alt-right movement, he was never accepted as a mainstream conservative figure, given his frequent misogynistic comments, associations with white supremacists and antisemites, and a history of other controversial remarks, such as saying a romantic relationship between a 13-year-old boy and an adult could be consensual — the latter costing him book and speaking opportunities.

In recent years he largely faded from conversation on the right, despite seeking to rebrand

as an “ex-gay” and working as an unpaid intern for then-Rep. Marjorie Taylor Greene (R-Georgia).

His support for Trump has ebbed over the years, and he’s recently been critical of the president. In December, Yiannopoulos appeared as a guest on Tucker Carlson’s show; Carlson also planned to publish a book by Yiannopoulos on his new imprint.

Last year, Yiannopoulos appeared on a podcast hosted by Candace Owens — another Trump supporter turned critic — who has been in a feud with influential MAGA blogger Laura Loomer.

Loomer told The Washington Post that since 2024 she has repeatedly contacted ICE, DHS more broadly and the FBI about Yiannopoulos. She said she reported him to the FBI after he made threatening social media posts calling for violence against her.

In an interview, Loomer took credit for Yiannopoulos’s detention, saying it was “100 percent” because she raised attention to his immigration status. “Who else reported that Milo was an illegal alien?” she said.

DHS did not immediately respond to Loomer’s comments.

Yiannopoulos also worked as chief of staff for Yezezy, the company owned by rapper Kanye West, known as Ye. Yiannopoulos claimed responsibility for inviting white supremacist Nick Fuentes to a 2022 dinner with Ye and Trump — a move that generated blowback for Trump, who had just announced his 2024 presidential campaign. Yiannopoulos later told NBC News he did it “just to make Trump’s life miserable.”

Yiannopoulos, who resigned from Yezezy in 2024, saying it was because of the rapper’s reported move into adult entertainment. He was then sued, along with Ye, by a group of eight employees claiming a hostile work environment; Yiannopoulos has denied the claims.



Milo Yiannopoulos

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BioNTech employees work at a manufacturing facility in Marburg, Germany, in 2021. The pharmaceutical company partnered with Pfizer to produce coronavirus vaccines.

Updated coronavirus vaccines approved as cases rise

Here’s what to know about the Food and Drug Administration’s revised covid shots

BY RACHEL ROUBEIN

The Food and Drug Administration on Thursday green-lit updated coronavirus vaccines for higher-risk Americans, such as older adults and people with at least one underlying health condition, vaccine manufacturers announced.

The approved shots from vaccine manufacturers Pfizer-BioNTech and Moderna, which make mRNA-based vaccines, have an updated formulation aimed at better targeting the coronavirus variants circulating around the country. The FDA also cleared an updated vaccine from Sanofi, which doesn’t use mRNA-based technology and was originally licensed by Novavax, a Sanofi spokesperson confirmed. The companies said the vaccines are expected to be available in the coming days.

But questions remain over formal federal recommendations for which Americans should get a vaccine, which could complicate availability of the shots in a handful of states. A federal vaccine panel charged with making immunization recommendations has been thrown into legal limbo after a federal judge ruled Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. improperly reconstituted it last year after firing all of its members.

However, public health experts and others involved in vaccination efforts aren’t anticipating last year’s widespread confusion. The coronavirus shots weren’t initially available in pharmacies in 16 states because federal vaccine experts and federal officials had not yet issued formal recommendations for which Americans should get a shot.

“A lot of the solutions already got put in place,” said Stephen Hoge, Moderna’s president. “As it stands right now, we believe everybody — most states and certainly any clinicians or pharmacies or others — have already planned to deal with this challenge.”

Kennedy, the founder of a prominent anti-vaccine group, has sought to bypass the traditional process for some of his department’s changes regarding who should get a coronavirus shot. Kennedy has criticized the shots, which President Donald Trump hailed as a “modern-day miracle” during the pandemic.

Medical experts say the vaccines are effective at preventing serious illness, hospitalization and death, but uptake of the shots updated annually remains low, according to Centers for Disease Control and Prevention data. Coronavirus infections are increasing or likely to be growing in 47 states, according to Aug. 19 CDC data.

Covid-19 has typically had a

summer wave the last several years, but infectious-disease experts note that the spread of the virus still remains low, particularly compared with last summer.

What does the FDA’s latest approval mean?

Specifically, the FDA signed off on updated vaccines for adults 65 and over, as well as those with at least one health condition putting them at risk of severe disease, according to the companies.

Last year, this included a wide range of conditions, such as diabetes, obesity, chronic kidney disease, physical inactivity and more.

Specific vaccines for higher-risk children depend on their age: A Moderna vaccine was approved for ages 6 months and older, Pfizer for those 5 years old and older, and Sanofi for those 12 years old and older.

The FDA last year narrowed approval of the shots to high-risk groups, a significant shift for the vaccine once routinely provided to nearly all Americans. Then-FDA Commissioner Marty Makary and top vaccine regulator Vinay Prasad, both of whom departed the agency earlier this year, laid out the new approach requiring vaccine manufacturers to conduct a randomized controlled trial before the agency signs off on shots for healthy people between the ages of 6 months and 64 years.

However, most Americans can still get the shots off-label, which essentially means doctors and other health care providers can administer medications to populations the FDA did not approve them for. Doctors generally weigh various factors, including the advice of major medical societies, government recommendations and a patient’s individual health.

Who is the vaccine officially recommended for?

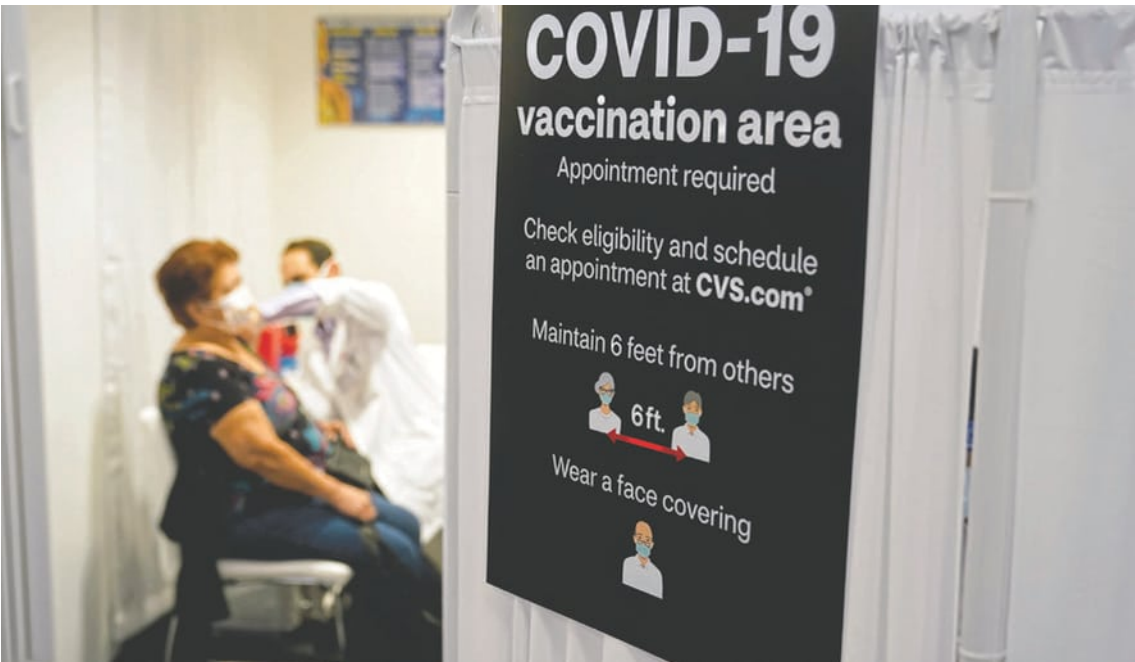
That is a complicated question — and it’s not clear whether there will be new federal recommendations this year.

Typically, an expert vaccine advisory panel, known as the Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices, votes annually on which people they believe should receive the updated coronavirus vaccine. Then the CDC makes an official recommendation.

But a meeting to discuss coronavirus vaccines has not been scheduled. That’s because a federal judge in March blocked many of the Trump administration’s changes to vaccine policy, including temporarily suspending the appointment of the vast majority of Kennedy’s hand-picked members, some of whom had histories of criticizing the



A person receives a shot of a potential coronavirus vaccine developed by Moderna in 2020.



A patient receives a coronavirus shot in Los Angeles in 2021.

“Once the vaccine arrives, patients will be able to see which CVS Pharmacy and MinuteClinic location has which vaccine, as well as appointment availability.”

Amy Thibault, a CVS spokeswoman,

use of mRNA coronavirus vaccines.

Last year, the panel replaced a universal recommendation that everyone 6 months and older receive the vaccine with a more restrictive approach. It sought for everyone to consult a health care provider before getting a shot — a recommendation that has been placed on

hold by a federal judge.

Yet two changes made under Kennedy’s leadership are still in effect: revisions regarding healthy children and pregnant women. There is currently no recommendation for pregnant women to receive the shots, and the vaccine is recommended for healthy children through shared decision-making, meaning parents and children should talk with health providers and decide what makes sense for them.

“This is really uncharted,” said Jennifer Kates, a senior vice president at KFF, a health policy research and news organization. “We have not had this situation ever before.”

What do medical societies recommend?

Medical societies are planning to put out their recommendations on who should get the updated shots in early September.

Here’s what major associations recently recommended:

- Children: The American Academy of Pediatrics last year recommended all children ages

- 6 months through 23 months receive a coronavirus immunization, as well as those who are at high risk of severe disease. For healthy children ages 2 to 18, the group said they can get an updated shot if their parents or guardians want them to have protection.
- Adults: The American Academy of Family Physicians last year recommended all adults 19 years and older receive the vaccine. The medical society said doing so was “especially important” for those 65 and older, at increased risk of severe disease or who have never received a coronavirus shot.
- Pregnant women: The American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists this spring said it continues to recommend routine updated shots for pregnant women, those considering getting pregnant and those who are breastfeeding.

Will the shots be available in pharmacies in all states?

Most Americans typically get vaccinated against the coronavirus at retail pharmacies. Pharmacies are actively pre-

paring to receive the updated shots, so they can begin vaccinations as soon as they receive shipments and all state requirements are met, according to Brigid Groves, a vice president at the American Pharmacists Association.

Amy Thibault, a CVS spokeswoman, said pharmacies and MinuteClinics are expected to start receiving supplies of the shots within a few days and “will be offering them to eligible patients in all states as permitted by law.”

She added, “Once the vaccine arrives, patients will be able to see which CVS Pharmacy and MinuteClinic location has which vaccine, as well as appointment availability.”

In a statement, Walgreens said the updated covid-19 shots will be available for “eligible patients in the coming days.”

It was not immediately clear in which states the shots would be offered. Yet, public health and pharmacy experts believe access will be quicker in most states than it was last year.

Some states tie the authority of pharmacists to offer vaccines to federal immunization recommendations. That led to a scenario last year in which the availability of vaccines at pharmacies in some states was initially delayed as federal vaccine advisers had not yet made a formal recommendation.

Since last year, there has been “substantial state-level work to preserve pharmacy access,” Groves said. That includes modifying pharmacy practice laws, updating regulations, issuing standing orders and executive orders, and more.

But authority still varies state by state.

Pharmacists’ ability to administer coronavirus vaccines may be tied to federal recommendations or other guidance in a “limited number of jurisdictions,” Groves said, meaning some patients may need prescriptions before they can get a shot.

In states where the shot isn’t linked to federal recommendations, patients can generally self-attest that they have an underlying health condition.

In the majority of states, younger people who don’t have certain health conditions would probably need a prescription, Groves said, because that would be outside the population the FDA had approved the vaccine for.

Will insurance cover the vaccines?

Major insurers have broadly pledged they’ll continue free coverage of coronavirus vaccines even absent new federal recommendations.

Medicare is required to cover the coronavirus vaccines, and it’s expected that Medicaid will cover them as well, according to Kates.

Daniel Wu contributed to this report.

THE WORLD

Greenland grab rattles Iceland, which now weighs joining E.U.

Trump’s threat to annex an Arctic neighbor adds urgency to vote over talks

BY ELLEN FRANCIS AND BEATRIZ RÍOS

BRUSSELS — Rattled by President Donald Trump’s territorial claims in the Arctic, the people of Iceland will vote Saturday on whether to restart talks on joining the European Union.

Iceland quit its E.U. bid more than a decade ago, after years of negotiations collapsed over fishing restrictions. Several factors, including rising prices and security concerns, have rekindled Icelandic interest in joining the bloc of 27 nations.

A major push, however, came this year from Trump’s fixation with seizing Greenland, Iceland’s neighbor in the North Atlantic.

Trump triggered a crisis at NATO when he insisted in January that the United States needed to take Greenland, which he called a “piece of ice.” Greenland is an autonomous territory of Denmark, a NATO member.

In public remarks, Trump mistakenly referred several times to Greenland as Iceland. Though evidently a gaffe, its repetition nonetheless stoked unease in Iceland about which island he wanted to grab.

“The international system we have lived with since the end of World War II is shaking,” Iceland’s Foreign Minister Thorgerdur Katrin Gunnarsdottir wrote in a recent report, stressing the value of cooperating with European allies.

A “weakened” relationship between Europe and the U.S. calls “for a new assessment,” Thorgerdur Katrin wrote. A referendum on E.U. talks, she said, would give the nation “a choice about where it wants to go” and “how it wants to secure its interests for the future.”

While Iceland, a nation of some 400,000 people just south of the Arctic Circle, is not an E.U. member, it is a member of NATO and also part of the E.U.’s common economic market under an agreement that includes Norway and Liechtenstein.

Proponents of reopening negotiations say the rift with the U.S. over Greenland, and global tensions over Arctic routes and resources, should push Iceland deeper into the E.U. fold.

Opponents argue that the bloc could infringe on Iceland’s decision-making, especially in the country’s key industries: fishing and farming.

Dagur B. Eggertsson, an Icelandic lawmaker and key figure in the pro-E.U. camp, said the goal was “strengthening our place within Europe at a time of growing uncertainty” about alliances that are crucial to smaller nations.

This “has increased the urgency of the European question for Iceland,” he told The Washington Post.

Dagur, a former mayor of Reykjavik, the capital, said the argument for E.U. membership is not to replace NATO or Iceland’s defense agreement with the U.S., but about “adding another layer of security.”

“When it comes to tariffs, trade wars and economic coercion, the E.U. is already a superpower,” he added. “It has the weight of the single market, an extensive network of trade agreements and the ability to defend its members collectively when economic pressure is applied.”

Joining the E.U. is an arduous process that entails years of ne-



People with Icelandic flags attend a “Forward, Iceland” rally, opposing the resumption of European Union accession talks in Reykjavik, Iceland, on Thursday.



Supporters of the “No” campaign rally in Reykjavik, Iceland, on Thursday, ahead of Saturday’s referendum.



gotiations with the bloc’s executive arm and requires enacting changes to align national laws and policies with E.U. requirements.

A candidate country must be judged to be in compliance with E.U. standards in more than 30 areas, from customs and agricultural regulations to anti-corruption measures and judicial independence.

Nations typically eyed economic benefits as an incentive to join the E.U., which was founded in 1993 to promote free trade across the continent. The E.U.’s single market is designed for seamless movement of people, goods, services and capital.

Today, the E.U. also pitches itself as a guarantor of stability and security at a time of mounting doubt about U.S. military commitments and fears of spillover from Russia’s war in Ukraine. Despite pledges to strengthen defense, the E.U. is not a military superpower and its 27 member countries are in a protracted, divisive debate about

whether to expand at all.

The ballot will ask voters one yes-or-no question: Should Iceland resume membership talks with the E.U.?

In 2016, Britain held a referendum that similarly asked a binary question: Should the United Kingdom remain a member of the European Union or leave the European Union?

“Leave” won by a slight margin and the result was Brexit, Britain’s painful departure from the E.U., which has led to a decade of economic decline and stagnation.

Advocates of a larger E.U. say that achieving a successful outcome for Iceland could unlock the stalled bids of other countries. If the “No” camp wins, it could dampen efforts to build momentum around the idea of expansion.

Marta Kos, the E.U.’s commissioner for enlargement, says admitting new members would create “a Europe capable of securing its own interests” at a time of renewed rivalry among

global powers.

In a world “where dependencies are weaponized ... becoming stronger together is our biggest asset,” Kos said in a speech this week.

European leaders, grappling with a looming U.S. military drawdown, have vowed to take charge of their defenses. Kos told The Post she sees expanding the bloc as part of the efforts to ensure long-term security.

“Iceland’s decision would undoubtedly strengthen the case for the E.U. to welcome new members,” she added. Kos said she expected negotiations on Iceland’s membership to take one to two years, potentially leading to entry in 2028.

Nearly all the E.U.’s neighbors are seeking membership or closer ties, reflecting rising interest in the E.U., she said.

But the accession efforts of several nations, including Serbia, Kosovo and North Macedonia, have stalled for political and administrative reasons.

Many of the bloc’s members,

from Germany to Bulgaria, have expressed reluctance about admitting others to the club, because of worries about the impact on the E.U.’s common budget, its foreign policy decisions and its power balance.

Montenegro is a front-runner in negotiations, while Albania is moving along its checklist. This summer, Ukraine and Moldova formally opened membership negotiations after Hungary dropped a long-standing veto against Kyiv.

Iceland, which has a stable economy, has fewer barriers to entry than most other candidates. In addition to being a member of the Common Market, it is also part of Europe’s visa-free travel zone.

In Saturday ballot’s, citizens will vote solely on resuming negotiations, not on actual membership. Ultimately, a deal would require Iceland to hold a second referendum, as well as receive approval from all 27 current E.U. member states.

“I think the European Union

needs a successful case because it hasn’t had one ever since 2013,” when Croatia was the last country to join, said Nina Vujanovic, a fellow at the Brussels-based Bruegel research institute.

Since Russia’s 2022 invasion of Ukraine, seeking E.U. membership has gained an added “security dimension,” Vujanovic said, signaling that a nation is part of Europe’s democratic orbit and aligning its identity as European.

“For a country like Ukraine, entering the E.U. and its institutions means stability and security,” she said. “For Iceland, it is also a security question,” given threats in the Arctic.

Trump’s tariffs and rhetoric on annexation have triggered bursts of patriotism in Canada, Greenland and across Europe. This has pushed nations like Iceland but also Britain, the only country to leave the E.U., closer to Brussels.

Tinatin Akhvediani, head of the E.U. Enlargement Program at the Centre for European Policy Studies, said a “Yes” from Iceland would help “make the case that the European Union and its membership are very attractive.”

It would highlight that “it’s not only candidate countries which are poor, which have security threats, which are bigger or have ongoing military conflicts,” Akhvediani added. “These are also prosperous economies, stable democracies ... that still want to be part of the European Union.”

DIGEST

CONGO
Ebola outbreak spreads to new zones

The fastest-growing Ebola outbreak in history has spread to two new health zones in eastern Congo, with a total of 60 now affected, according to the latest government figures published on Friday.

The two new zones affected are Biena and Manguredjipa in Congo’s North Kivu province, where the case fatality rate is much higher than the overall rate of 48 percent, due in part to delayed response efforts, according to Congo’s Ministry of Health data.

It said the outbreak has recorded 5,794 confirmed cases, including 2,786 deaths, as it is spreading at an unprecedented

speed, faster than efforts to track and slow it.

The outbreak is spreading under extremely difficult conditions, fueled by insecurity, displacement, a health workers’ strike and intense population movements. The World Health Organization has said that it remains out of control and is on track to surpass the 2014-2016 West Africa Ebola outbreak, the deadliest on record, which killed more than 11,000 people, primarily in Guinea, Liberia and Sierra Leone.

Aid group Doctors Without Borders said on Friday it had opened a new treatment center in Beni in North Kivu to enable a faster response in what it said was one of the hardest-hit areas.

While the large majority of cases are concentrated in northeastern Ituri province, North

Kivu has an Ebola fatality rate of close to 69 percent, one of the highest in the country, according to the latest government figures.

The new center “enables the rapid treatment of patients, strengthens contact tracing and supports the health authorities in their efforts to contain the spread of the virus,” Doctors Without Borders said in a statement.

— Reuters

BRITAIN
Four men plead guilty to arson attack

Four men pleaded guilty Friday to destroying four Jewish community ambulances in an arson attack in north London earlier this year that many said

was a direct result of the start of the Iran war.

Sentencing will take place in the spring of 2027 at the conclusion of a separate trial involving another man charged in connection with the ambulance attack, Justice Bobbie Cheema-Grubb said at London’s Central Criminal Court.

Hamza Iqbal, 20, Rehan Khan, 19, Judex Atshatshi, and Saif Ali, both 18, faced a charge of destroying or damaging property and of being reckless as to whether life would be endangered.

The four ambulances torched in the early hours of March 23 were owned by Hatzola, a Jewish volunteer-led charity operating in the Golders Green area of north London. The ambulances each cost around \$340,000.

The attack was one of several

incidents deemed to have been antisemitic that took place in the weeks after the U.S. and Israel first launched attacks on Iran on Feb. 28.

Three of the defendants were said to have set fire to the fully stocked vehicles, while a fourth waited in a car. The resulting blaze caused gas canisters inside the ambulances to explode, and nearby apartments and a synagogue were also damaged by the fire.

— Associated Press

KAZAKHSTAN
Dadebai elected as speaker of parliament

Kazakh lawmakers on Friday chose Aibek Dadebai, leader of the governing party and a former top aide to President

Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, as the speaker of the parliament as Tokayev cements his control of the country’s politics.

A longtime ally of Tokayev, previously having served as head of the presidential administration and as the president’s chief of staff, Dadebai headed up the pro-Tokayev Adilet party when it was formed this year.

The party won a large majority of the vote in a parliamentary election held on Sunday, having absorbed the previous governing party Amanat, which had dominated Kazakh politics under various names since the 1990s.

All deputies voted in favor of Dadebai’s candidacy, including those of the four small opposition parties which won seats, and which are seen as ultimately loyal to Tokayev.

A devastating alcohol epidemic is ravaging her territory — and her own life



Traytowu and Boe, a friend from another Bororo village in Mato Grosso, harvest sugarcane.

PHOTOS BY DAN AGOSTINI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

CHIEF FROM A1

already carried herself like a woman meant to lead.”

Five years ago, Traytowu, the daughter of Apido Paru’s previous chief, succeeded him as the first transgender Indigenous leader in Brazil, a symbol and source of inspiration far beyond her village. She’s respected, her mother says, for her deep knowledge of their Bororo culture and her fluency in Portuguese, a rare combination.

It wasn’t enough. Traytowu has also struggled with alcohol, she says, and late last year, she was removed from her position by her own mother. Jurema Adugo Oro says she had no choice. “If she doesn’t step away from her addiction,” Oro says, “she will lose everything.”

Now Traytowu is working to earn the job back.

She lives between two worlds. Outside this territory in central Brazil, she’s celebrated as proof that trans people can lead in traditional communities. Inside it, she’s struggling to hold on to influence and authority as addiction ravages her territory — and her own life.

For decades, Brazil has ranked consistently as the world’s deadliest country for trans people — and it isn’t particularly close. According to the National Association of Transvestites and Transgender People, 122 were killed here in 2024 and 80 last year.

Tadarimana, a territory of some 37 square miles, lies inside the conservative state of Mato Grosso, a stronghold of Brazil’s rapidly growing evangelical population. It’s home to 636 Indigenous people, spread among 10 villages, each with its own chief.

The central village, also called Tadarimana, with about 200 residents, elects its chief by majority vote. The other villages choose or remove their leaders through decisions made among the main families.

When Traytowu took the position at Apido Paru, the village had 70 people. Today, about 30 remain, living in six thatched houses along the Tadarimana River.

Leadership positions in Indigenous villages are typically held by married men with authority often shared within the couple. The choice of an unmarried trans woman was unexpected, analysts say, but not unthinkable.

Gender and sexual diversity have long been recognized in the country’s native societies. Discrimination against trans people, according to the Ministry of Indigenous Peoples, was introduced “alongside European moral and religious values, particularly those tied to Catholicism, which imposed more restrictive



Boe and Traytowu prepare sugarcane juice while Gael, Traytowu’s nephew, plays in a water tank in Apido Paru village, Mato Grosso.



Traytowu, Boe and one of Traytowu’s nieces squeeze sugarcane to extract juice.

views.” “Majur is an important representation of Bororo culture, a population that already challenges traditional gender roles,” says anthropologist André Drago, who has studied the Bororo people for 15 years. “But she was able to rise in this way because she comes from a family of lead-

ers and knows how to maneuver both inside and outside the village.”

In Bororo culture, a person’s identity is tied to their role in the community. Since childhood, Traytowu has performed tasks associated with women. She cooks meat, rice and beans, when they’re available, and cares

for her sister’s children.

During funerals, her community’s most important ceremony, she chants the pranto, a role reserved for women — a “very sad and very beautiful” recounting of the deceased, she says, and the void their death leaves.

It requires fluency in the language she learned from her

father, Raimundo Itogoga, a powerful cultural leader who, on falling ill in 2021, chose the youngest of his 15 children to succeed him. He saw in her a natural leader, her mother says, and that she could navigate two worlds and two languages better than anyone else.

As a young adult, Traytowu

wore feminine clothes, shaped her eyebrows and watched videos of people who looked like her. She didn’t yet understand the concept of being transgender, she says, but “I just wasn’t myself when I was among men. It wasn’t where I wanted to be.”

In 2018, when she was 27, she began seeing a psychologist. Asked about her aspirations, she said for the first time out loud that she wanted a woman’s body and a new name.

One day, someone called her “Majur,” and she felt immediately the name was hers. “It’s a strong name, a leader’s name, and I felt it resonate within me.”

Given logistical challenges and lack of money, she didn’t begin hormone transition until October 2021, three months after she became chief. She started treatment at a private clinic in Rondonópolis, a 90-minute drive from her village, using savings from her former job as a health agent.

Soon her voice softened, her breasts grew, and the little body hair she had thinned or fell away. She was happy, but she was forced to stop the medication when the money ran out. The role of chief brought no salary, and the nearest public health system offering the treatment was nearly 500 miles away.

But by then, she was already Majur. She had changed her name legally and introduced herself that way.

Adugo Oro, Traytowu’s mother, says her daughter’s identity is accepted by the village. Transgender people have long been visible in Bororo culture, she says; she knew a trans woman married to a cultural leader many years ago.

“My mom told me I’m not the first transgender woman among my people,” Traytowu says, “but I am an inspiration for those who come next. Girls who are afraid to come out find courage in me. They think, if she can do it, so can I.”

Some transgender Indigenous people have been rejected or even expelled from their territories.

Nat Kuparaka, a 24-year-old member of the Pataxó people, says she was cast out by her family for being a trans woman. “My parents became evangelical pastors, and they believe what I did is a sin,” she says. “Those who remain more closely tied to Indigenous traditions tend to be more accepting of different gender identities.”

At least two other trans women live in Tadarimana Indigenous Territory. Traytowu says she has never faced prejudice within her family or village, only outside it. “In the city, people look at me with anger. It is a double prejudice, for being Indigenous

SEE CHIEF ON A13



Raimundo Itogoga, Traytowu's father, sits on a bed in the family home while one of his granddaughters eats.

PHOTOS BY DAN AGOSTINI/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

CHIEF FROM A12

and for being trans.”

Boe, her childhood friend, reports a similar experience. She left 10 years ago to pursue a doctorate in anthropology.

“I don’t want us to be seen through this negative lens of prejudice, marginalization and death,” Boe says. “I want us to be seen for who we are. I’m a PhD student. Majur is a leader. And by being a leader, she challenges a system that would rather we didn’t exist.”

As chief, Traytowu mediated conflicts, secured food aid during and after the pandemic, and helped to bring a water distribution system to the village.

She traveled across Brazil and to France to promote Bororo culture and transgender Indigenous leadership.

She enjoys the spotlight, she says, but the constant demands of the role and the hormone treatment were stressful.

She thought she would find a solution in alcohol. “I started drinking about five years ago,” she says, around the time she became chief. “It was a hard time, so I drank all out.”

Geni Nuñez, a psychologist who has studied Indigenous culture, sees alcoholism among Indigenous communities as a symptom of chronic strain, particularly in territories under pressure and, like Tadarimana, near urban centers.

“In Majur’s case, the burden could be even heavier,” Nuñez says. “Leaders are always under scrutiny, but when someone comes from a marginalized position, as an exception, the demand is even greater.”

Among the Bororo, Drago says, alcohol has a violent history. Introduced by white military forces in the 19th century as a tool of pacification, it became part of a broader strategy of dispossession. “Non-Indigenous actors sought to reduce the Bororo population and take their land, and alcohol was used as an instrument in that process.”

Over the past year, relatives and friends say, Traytowu grew increasingly volatile, shouting, fighting at home and in the streets, unsettling a community that looked to her for guidance.

“Everyone respects Majur,” said Ruth Aranu, who lives in the central village. “She performs in our mourning rituals beautifully, speaks our language, she’s good to us. But the drinking gets in the way.”

At the end of last year, Aduogo Oro made what she describes as a painful decision. Her daughter had drawn too much atten-



Traytowu walks with Maria, the wife of the local cultural chief. Traytowu intends to run for chief in the near future.



Traytowu and residents of the Tadarimana Indigenous Territory attend a meeting led by chief Cícero Kudoropa.

tion, she says. People felt envy, perhaps even used dark magic against her. “She wasn’t herself. I had never seen her like that,” she says. “I was heartbroken, but there was no other way.”

She summoned Cícero Kudoropa, then the chief of the

central village and Traytowu’s godfather, and told him Traytowu would no longer lead Apido Paru. With her husband bedridden, she said, all matters would go through her. Kudoropa agreed.

Traytowu did not. Mother

and daughter clashed. After a fierce argument in February, Traytowu says, her mother told her it would be best to leave the village for a while.

“I felt the ground disappear beneath me,” she says. “It was a pain I’ve never felt before. Nothing

could fill the sadness and anguish. I was no one anymore.”

She begged for one last chance, she says. She promised to stop drinking and help again at home and with the family. Her mother agreed. “I like having Majur helping me here,

sweeping the house, cooking, bringing us food and helping take care of the children,” Aduogo Oro says.

Traytowu says she is now trying to get sober again. She had been sober for months, she said, before relapsing.

Twenty days after the fight between Traytowu and her mother, Kudoropa called a general assembly under a rain-heavy sky in the central village to address, among other challenges, the growing drinking problem in the Bororo community. Standing in a concrete hall with a microphone in his hand, he warned that more alcohol was reaching the territory more frequently.

“This has been a problem for 15 years, but it’s getting worse,” he said. “People from our own community are now buying it in the city and reselling it here for three or four times the price.”

He said he knew the sellers and had warned them before. He was reluctant to punish his own people, he said, but this was the final notice.

“If they keep selling alcohol here, we will notify the Federal Police and Funai,” the federal agency for Indigenous affairs, “and expel them from our land.”

His term ended this spring, and he had no plans to run again. Being a chief brings too many problems, he says. He, too, struggled with alcohol, he says. He nearly died in a car accident last year, he says, and has been sober since then. Now he wants to take care of his family.

“It’s too many demands, we’re constantly worried, we barely sleep,” he says.

Traytowu hopes to run for his job soon. She wants to build a movement to raise the visibility of transgender people within Indigenous communities and secure partnerships that would give young villagers more opportunities and less idle time with alcohol.

“I prepared myself for a long time, and I believe I’m ready to try to take on a role of this magnitude,” she says.

Kudoropa thinks she needs a little more. “I know the pain,” he says. “Majur is a good person and has a whole life ahead of her. If she gives up drinking, she could lead this entire territory one day.”

Majur seems to grasp what lies ahead. “Alcohol pushed people away from me,” she says. “I want to leave this life behind, learn from my mistakes and get back to work.”

Her mother looks out at the dark night and takes Majur’s hands. They set out for Apido Paru.



Traytowu says goodbye to her aunt Ruth Aranu in the collective kitchen at the end of a community meeting.

President’s deal for Venezuela’s oil is contentious and could cost billions

VENEZUELA FROM A1

come at no cost to U.S. taxpayers. But deal points reviewed by the Post and interviews with people who were close to negotiations as the deal came together suggest that for the plan to succeed in producing oil in the amounts the administration projects, the U.S. government may ultimately need to invest significant amounts.

A list shared with The Washington Post before the deal was announced noted 17 oil fields in which the U.S. would take a stake. Several of the fields lack any infrastructure or access to transport hubs to treat and move the crude. Those where such infrastructure does exist have fallen victim to years of neglect and theft of machinery.

Pumping oil from the fields could require investments of many billions of dollars and costly security plans to protect oil workers and production facilities in lawless and violent regions. The deal points reviewed by The Post say the U.S. government stake in the newly formed oil company will be split between equity ownership and guarantees that it will purchase oil produced by it at cost to refill the U.S. Strategic Petroleum Reserve.

But it is unclear who would make the tens of billions of dollars in infrastructure investments needed before oil can be pumped from the largely dormant fields. Major oil companies have mostly seen such spending as too risky.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio posted on X that the agreement “will bring nearly \$100 billion in private investment” to Venezuela without specifying which companies have committed to such spending.

The key Venezuelan partner in the deal is North American Blue Energy Partners, or NABEP, the second-largest private oil producer in Venezuela, according to a person familiar with the discussions.

The Pentagon, through its Office of Strategic Capital (OSC), would oversee and help fund the oil field licenses, according to the person familiar and one other with knowledge of the talks. The mission of that office is to “accelerate and scale private investment in critical supply chain technologies.”



The sun sets behind an oil well in a field near El Tigre, Venezuela.

FERNANDO LLANO/AP

Pentagon officials said they could not comment on any particular deals being weighed at the OSC, but they stressed that the office cannot take any ownership stake in private companies.

“OSC’s role is strictly limited to providing capital assistance in the form of a loan, loan guarantee, or technical assistance (including transaction structuring for developing and financing investments),” said a statement from Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell.

Bloomberg News first reported the involvement of NABEP and the Pentagon in a potential Venezuela deal.

NABEP is controlled by the Venezuelan businessman Alejandro Betancourt, a major player in the country’s oil sector who has become a key intermediary between the U.S. and Venezuela and has helped broker early contracts to get oil pumping fast in the country, The Post reported this week.

Betancourt has ramped up oil output by NABEP to nearly 200,000 barrels per day from 18,000 in just two years. In the

past decade he has also faced multiple investigations, in Switzerland, Spain and the United States, into alleged money laundering.

U.S. officials this year have lobbied to resolve the case in Switzerland in a way that would avoid criminal charges and end travel restrictions against Britain-based Betancourt, The Post reported, citing two people familiar with the matter, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss a sensitive matter.

The United States has also not acted on a Swiss arrest warrant against him, the people said. Instead, the U.S. has allowed Betancourt to enter the country repeatedly for meetings with the Trump administration, other people familiar with his travel said. Betancourt has not been charged and his attorney has denied he was involved in money laundering.

Substantial hurdles to executing the deal remain.

There is strong opposition in Venezuela to ceding control of natural resources to the United States. Revisions to the Venezue-

lan constitution may be required before the U.S. gains control of any oil fields, and the prospects of that happening are uncertain amid U.S. antipathy.

“An illegitimate interim [Venezuelan] government with an illegitimate hydrocarbons law has no legitimacy to strike this unconstitutional deal,” Ricardo Hausmann, a Harvard economist who served as Venezuela’s minister of planning in the early 1990s, said in a post on X. “It will be a fiasco for all involved, starting with @SecRubio.”

After striking the deal with the U.S., Venezuela is now weighing withdrawing from the OPEC consortium of energy-producing nations, according to people familiar, a move the Trump administration would welcome as it seeks to exert more influence over the international oil trade. Venezuela is a founding member of OPEC.

“I suspect the withdrawal from OPEC is associated more with U.S. control over the country than the reported U.S. investment deal,” said an oil industry official who spoke candidly on

the condition of anonymity. “To the extent the U.S. is building a western hemisphere energy block, it makes no sense for Venezuela to belong to OPEC.”

Trump made Rodríguez “interim” president while pledging that her country eventually will return to democratic, elected governance. “From a legal standpoint in Venezuela, Delcy has no standing,” said a Venezuelan with long participation in the oil industry who also spoke on the condition of anonymity to provide a candid assessment.

The person said this will leave banks and other institutions typically involved in financing drilling operations asking, “Why are we signing deals with people who have zero legitimacy?”

Rodríguez said in a statement that the agreement “will have a significant impact on our nation’s revival.”

Under the structure of the deal, according to people familiar with it, oil could be produced using an existing joint venture legal structure in Venezuela through which the United States would be granted access to de-

velop the oil fields, but Venezuela would still be guaranteed a cut of all revenue they produce.

The deal could face stiff resistance not just in Venezuela but in the United States.

Any U.S. government expenditures or loans needed to develop oil fields would probably need congressional approval just as Trump’s GOP allies risk losing control over the legislative branch in the upcoming midterm elections.

Democrats have been unyieldingly critical of the administration’s endeavors in Venezuela, including its opaque dealmaking with the country’s natural resources industries, since the U.S. ousted former Venezuelan dictator Nicolás Maduro.

Despite claims by the Trump administration that Maduro’s removal would unleash a frenzy of drilling in Venezuela, oil production there has increased little, up only about 200,000 barrels over the past year, with projections for the same increase or less next year.

It remains unclear “whether anybody would want to operate” in a country where electricity is limited and port infrastructure is not capable of handling increased production, among other limits that “are holding back the majors from going into the country right now,” said David Goldwyn, head of the international energy consulting firm Goldwyn Global Strategies.

Even if the deal enables the U.S. to supersede all Venezuelan government jurisdiction over the oil fields, those areas “would have the same risks” that have limited new investment so far to smaller, less risk-averse companies, Goldwyn said.

The Trump administration has announced other major deals for the U.S. to take a big stake in energy or natural resources production, only for little to materialize. These include plans for the United States to take a stake in Ukraine’s reserve of critical minerals and an announcement nearly a year ago that the U.S. would fund construction of large nuclear reactors in return for a stake in the Westinghouse corporation.

Neither of those agreements has led to the breakthrough developments in energy production that the administration forecast when they were announced.

Trump promised a short Iran war. Six months later, he has few good options.

IRAN FROM A1

eroded U.S. credibility and capabilities in the Middle East, but also with respect to other adversaries in other theaters.”

Trump boasted Thursday of the soaring stock market and said that Tehran was suffering from a U.S. naval blockade and a tightening sanctions campaign, both of which have put pressure on its economy.

He downplayed the war’s impact on the flow of oil through the strait, which before Feb. 28 carried more than a fifth of global supplies.

“Iran is right now, they’re not paying their troops. They’re in deep trouble,” Trump told reporters in the Oval Office as he signed an order that directed U.S. government agencies to change the name they use for Lake Ontario to Lake America.

“They have very little capacity. Last night, we took 24 boats through the strait. We’re taking them through all the time,” he said. “It doesn’t mean we’re finished with the military, but we are, the strait is open.”

More than 100 ships traversed the Strait of Hormuz on average every day before the war. Just five went through on one day this week, according to Kpler, a commodities and shipping tracker. U.S. officials say the true number is higher because some ships have been turning off their transponders to avoid getting hit by Iran, but oil supplies have remained tight and prices have stayed well above pre-war levels.

The president and his allies say they have dealt a historic blow to Iran’s military and its ability to construct a nuclear weapon. They point to the killing of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and the intense first phase of the war that destroyed much of Iran’s armed forces.

But half a year into a war that Trump said he launched to prevent Iran from building a nuclear weapon and oppressing its people, the country’s hard-line regime appears firmly entrenched, and it is still able to launch attacks against U.S. bases and allies.

Those allies and foes alike are contending with the severe depletion of the Pentagon’s arsenal. And as the midterm elec-



JACQUELYN MARTIN/AP

The Iran war has become a major challenge to President Donald Trump's second term.



VAHID SALEMI/AP

A pro-government demonstrator at a rally on Wednesday in Tehran.

prices at the gas station.

Approval of Trump’s handling of the war has been dropping as prices for gasoline and other goods remain elevated. A Reuters/Ipsos poll released this

week put Trump’s approval at 33 percent. The pollsters found that support for the war has been dropping among Republicans, although approval for the action within his party remains

69 percent.

Trump has been especially sensitive to investors’ reaction to his moves on Iran. In June, just after he signed an interim peace deal with Tehran that later fell apart, he said “every time we talked about the possibility of peace, the stock market shot up like a rocket ship.”

“I didn’t want to see economic catastrophe,” he said, explaining his decision to sign the deal.

Those economic concerns appear to have limited the administration’s willingness to push against Tehran economically. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent this week declared an “economic D-Day” against Iran, telling countries they risked the wrath of U.S. sanctions if they continued doing business there.

In the same breath, he took some of the sting out of the threats by saying he wasn’t imposing sanctions immediately, because “why would I want to blow up the global financial system?”

Iranians likely took notice, said Richard Nephew, who helped devise the sanctions regime during the Obama administration ahead of the 2015 Iran nuclear deal.

“It clearly sent a signal to the Iranians that there is a limit to how far we’re going to be prepared to act,” Nephew said.

Economic pressure remains an important tool, he said — but the war may be demonstrating the limits of both economic and military pressure.

“What worries me is whether or not we have now also, in addition, learned the limits to how far military coercion can push, and that actually the Iranian response is going to be, ‘We can handle all of this.’ In which case, it’s not just the the leverage on the economy that we’ve lost. We’ve lost leverage across the board,” Nephew said.

The war is reverberating far beyond the Middle East. Fresh U.S. intelligence indicates that the Kremlin sees the United States as weakened by the Iran war. Russian President Vladimir Putin may see that as an opportunity to escalate action against American interests and allies in Europe, the assessments say, according to two people familiar with the matter.

The intelligence assessments preceded CIA Director John Ratcliffe’s Tuesday trip to Moscow, where according to one of the people, he warned his Russian counterpart not to escalate against Ukraine, saying that such a move would backfire. The people spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the subject’s sensitivity. The CIA has not commented on the subject of the conversations, and Trump said Thursday that Putin is “not going to be attacking a NATO territory.”

The Post has previously reported that the U.S. has lost roughly a quarter of its Reaper drones, which cost between \$30 million and \$50 million each. They are used for surveillance and targeting. Stocks of sophisticated Patriot anti-missile defense systems, which are used to protect Israel, Ukraine and U.S. bases around the world, are also severely depleted.

The shortages have led some other countries to be more cautious about their aid for Ukraine and Arab allies, as they see a growing need to preserve a larger arsenal for their own defense in case the U.S. is less able to help them. Ukraine has sought Patriot batteries from Greece, for instance, but Athens has recently declined, instead relocating a system to the island of Crete, near a U.S. base there, following threats from Iran.

In the Persian Gulf region, where the U.S. has long maintained a robust presence, the Pentagon is assessing whether to pull back some U.S. forces rather than rebuild all of its damaged bases.

Washington’s allies “are going to hedge,” said Nate Swanson, who was the Iran director on the National Security Council during the Biden administration and continued into the first half year of the Trump administration.

The U.S. presence on their soil “has been a negative for these countries” over the last six months, Swanson said.

“It’s been a reason of justification for being attacked, and there wasn’t much we could do to defend that,” he said. “We are not going to be the sole dominant presence in the Middle East in the way we were before.”

Death toll in Nepal-China flooding disaster tops 500

Rescue efforts are hampered by fears of a further deluge

BY AOIFE WALSH, JOSHUA YANG AND N. KIRKPATRICK

Fears of further flooding complicated recovery efforts Friday, as authorities searched for hundreds of people still missing after devastating flash floods struck the Himalayan border between Nepal and China.

Nearly 1,000 people were still missing in Nepal, the country's national disaster management authority said, including 67 Americans. More than 550 were reported missing in China, according to state news agency Xinhua.

The death toll in Nepal has reached at least 540 people, police said Friday. Five people were killed in Tibet, Xinhua reported.

Authorities in Nepal on Friday warned of potential further flooding in the same area of the Bhotekoshi River, urging rescue teams to stay alert and prepared to move to a safe area. Nepal's police reported a burst water dam on the Tibet side of the border but did not specify the exact location.

Tibetan officials warned that the landslide that triggered Wednesday's flash floods had created a barrier lake, which posed a threat to rescue work and could breach, Chinese state media said.

Engineering and rescue experts were using drones and telescopes to monitor the barrier lake, the state-run Xinhua News Agency said.

Many of the tourists caught in the flash floods were taking part in the Kailash Manasarovar, a religious pilgrimage to Tibet's Mount Kailash, according to officials.

As the search continued, the Isha Foundation, an organization that guides pilgrims along the route, waited for news of a missing tour group of 80.

The group, which included 22 Americans and three Nepali volunteers, had arrived at a border crossing facility in Gyirong, Tibet, when the floods struck.

"We're holding out hope, but we've also seen what is happening on the site," said Leslie Crespi, the community liaison for the Isha Foundation in North America.

The foundation has been organizing treks to Mount Kailash for 21 years, she said. "The families are very shocked. It's very hard to take this in or even imagine the degree of devastation that has happened."

Geoscientists said initial assessments showed the floods were probably triggered by a landslide from a collapsing glacier. Tremors were initially mistaken for a 4.4-magnitude earthquake, though the U.S. Geological Survey later concluded the landslide was caused by a "glacial collapse and debris flow" and revised the magnitude upward to 5.2.

China's Ministry of Natural Resources said the disaster was triggered on the Nepal side of the



RITESH SHUKLA/GETTY IMAGES

An aerial view shows debris and mud covering an area following flash floods on Friday in Devghat village, Nepal.



EZRA ACAYAN/GETTY IMAGES

Residents view the Trishuli River from a hilltop Friday in Nepal amid fears of another possible surge.

border, according to state media. The ministry said falling ice and rock fell down a mountain slope, picking up loose glacial debris along its path before entering the Gyirong Zangbo River.

The seismic event unleashed a torrent of water, rock, mud and ice that swept through the border region, swallowing up

homes, blocking roads and damaging infrastructure.

The Nepal Tourism Board said Friday that 121 foreign nationals had been rescued, including two Americans, and 662 tourists were still unaccounted for.

The United Nations said Thursday that more than 30,000 security personnel are involved

in the rescue operation, citing Nepalese officials. The agency said access to the region has been complicated by the scale of destruction.

About 40 kilometers (25 miles) of road have been damaged, it added, and around 10,000 households are in immediate need.

Chinese leader Xi Jinping

The United States Geological Survey recorded a 5.2 magnitude landslide shortly before the flooding began.



Friday chaired an emergency meeting on China's response, state media reported, saying officials stressed that rescue plans "should be formulated in a scientific manner."

China will provide emergency aid to Nepal and cooperate with international rescue efforts, the reports added.

Conditions in Nepal appear wetter than normal into early September, with monsoon rains affecting the country. The unsettled weather could challenge recovery efforts and pose a new risk of flooding.

The U.S. Embassy in Nepal, citing the country's Department of Hydrology and Meteorology, said Thursday that continuing rainfall could trigger local flooding, landslides and additional damage.

VW CEO warns of sweeping layoffs

Automaker could shed tens of thousands of jobs amid global market shifts

BY MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

BERLIN — The chief executive of Volkswagen this week previewed sweeping layoffs at the German automaker, a signal of broader problems for an industry that powers the world's third-largest economy.

Addressing workers at the company's headquarters in Wolfsburg, Germany, Volkswagen Group CEO Oliver Blume warned Tuesday that eliminating tens of thousands of jobs could be necessary to remain competitive.

Volkswagen Group, which owns several other car brands including Bentley and Audi, has faced mounting pressure to adapt its business model to address excess facility capacity and high costs of energy and labor within Germany. But VW and other German automotive companies are struggling with an array of challenges, including increased competition from China, the war in the Middle East, growing regulatory burdens within the European Union and tariffs levied by the United States.

Stefan Bratzel, founder and director of the Center of Automotive Management in Germany, said the global automotive industry is in a "critical transformation period" as it shifts toward electrification, artificial intelligence and autonomous driving.

"It's especially a challenge for the established players that were used to being in the driver's seat," Bratzel said. If Volkswagen has a problem, he added, it will have ripple effects impacting "the whole industry's suppliers."

The automotive industry is a key driver of the German economy, serving as one of the largest sectors of employment. But auto jobs have been on a steep decline, dropping this year to their lowest level since 2005, according to the country's statistics office.

The planned cuts at Volkswagen would represent another drastic reduction. The company has faced scrutiny for years for its oversize headcount. Including its Chinese joint ventures, the Volkswagen Group employed some 667,000 people in 2025, with about 286,000 in Germany.

The proposed layoffs at Volkswagen would rival some of the biggest job cuts in history by a global automaker.

The meeting in Wolfsburg, where Volkswagen employs roughly 70,000 people, comes after the company's executive board unveiled a massive restructuring plan earlier this summer. The planned overhaul for 2030 could drastically cut Volkswagen's vehicle lineup, lead to the closure of four plants in Germany and eliminate tens of thousands of jobs.

Though the scope of the layoffs is not final, Blume mentioned eliminating 50,000 jobs in his remarks to employees in Wolfsburg. But labor representatives fear the true number is likely to be much larger and could top 100,000.

According to excerpts provided by the company, Blume told workers that roughly half the job cuts would be in Germany. But Blume said the company would try to minimize the impact on current workers, relying "as much as possible" on other means of workforce reduction, such as restricting hiring and offering phased early retirement programs.

In a statement, Daniela Cavallo, chairwoman of the Volkswagen Works Council — which aims to advance employees' interests in discussions with management — welcomed finally hearing, "information directly from the CEO." But she said workers are still waiting to learn what the cuts "will mean specifically for the brands and companies, and therefore also for the main plant."

Because of Volkswagen's unique ownership and supervisory board structure, German labor representatives and the German state of Lower Saxony have a say in major decisions. Labor representatives have publicly pushed back on the executive board's plan, and the government of Lower Saxony holds an influential 20 percent voting stake.

Meet the new king of Norway, Haakon VIII

Crown prince ascends to throne after the death of his father, King Harald V

BY VIOLET JIRA

After the death of Norway's Harald V on Friday, the country's Crown Prince Haakon VIII has ascended to the throne.

Haakon, 53, was the heir apparent. He said Friday he will use the same royal motto as his father, grandfather and great-grandfather: "All for Norway."

Haakon held his first meeting with cabinet ministers in Oslo on Friday, a formality.

Haakon is inheriting the kingship at a tumultuous time for the royals after the family faced scrutiny over his wife's association with the late sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. Mette-Marit — now queen consort of Norway — had what she described in a March interview as "a friendly relationship" with Epstein, the extent of which became apparent through the release of the Epstein files. Files released as part of a U.S. Justice

Department investigation revealed more than 100 messages between Mette-Marit and the disgraced financier.

"It is incredibly important for me to take responsibility for not checking his background more carefully," she said in a March interview with Norway's public broadcasting corporation. "And to take responsibility for being so manipulated and deceived as I was."

Prior to marrying into the royal family, Mette-Marit was a commoner. Her marriage to Haakon was controversial, having been an unmarried mother when they met.

Also this year, Marius Borg Høiby, her son, was sentenced to four years in prison after he was found guilty on two counts of rape in addition to charges for domestic abuse, drug charges and other offenses.

The scandals have rocked the royal family, leaving Haakon in the position of having to restore trust between Norway and his family, and shore up the family's public standing.

Though he is new to the role, he does bring some experience. As his father's health deteriorated, Haakon stepped into his shoes on multiple occasions.



LINDSEY WASSON/AP

Norwegian Crown Prince Haakon in 2024. He is inheriting the kingship at a tumultuous time after the family faced scrutiny over his wife's association with the late sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.

The former crown prince had been serving as regent — a temporary ruler — while his father was in the hospital receiving treatment for haemolytic anemia in the days leading up to his death.

Haakon grew up with one sibling, Princess Märtha Louise. He served in the Royal Norwegian

Navy and spent three years in the United States as a student at the University of California at Berkeley. He has two children, one of whom — Princess Ingrid Alexandra — is now the heir apparent to the crown. She would be Norway's first queen in centuries.

One of a few dozen remaining

monarchies in the world, the kingship in Norway is mostly symbolic — the country is a constitutional monarchy. With no real political power, the monarchy is tasked with formal duties such as opening parliament and signing laws, in addition to being a figurehead at home and abroad.

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER



Haitians deported from the United States deplane in Cap-Haitien, Haiti, on Thursday.

KETLAIN DIFFICILE/AP

EDITORIALS

A U.N. force was supposed to secure Haiti. A year later, gangs rule.

A MASSACRE OF 47 PEOPLE in Haiti last weekend is a grisly reminder of just how violent and lawless the Caribbean island remains — and how much a U.N.-backed international mission to restore stability is struggling a year after being approved. This is the situation to which Haitians living in the United States are being forcibly returned.

Last Sunday's killings occurred in the once-peaceful town of Kenscoff in the hills above the violence-wracked capital, Port-au-Prince. Kenscoff is next to Pétion-Ville, the relatively affluent suburb that is home to upscale hotels, the beleaguered government and what remains of the diplomatic community. Some 22 innocent civilians were slaughtered in a church. Houses were burned and women were raped, authorities said. About 50 people were taken as hostages.

The message from Haiti's gangs: No one, anywhere, is beyond their reach.

Last September, the U.N. Security Council approved a U.S.-sponsored plan to send a 5,550-member Gang Suppression Force to restore order and prop up the country's fledgling government. These peacekeepers were supposed to replace the hapless Kenyan-led police force, which struggled from the start with inadequate personnel and weapons and with navigating rules of engagement that required them to

mostly provide backup to outgunned local police.

The U.N.-backed entity came with a more forceful mandate to take the fight to the gangs and disarm them. But the force has been underfunded and numbered only about 1,000 as of last month.

Haiti's government, led by Prime Minister Alix Didier Filis-Aimé, has made limited tactical gains against gangs in the central part of the capital. That's mostly thanks to drone strikes carried out by the private security company Vectus Global, led by Erik Prince.

But the criminal gangs still control about 70 percent of Port-au-Prince and are expanding their reach into the countryside. Gangs have raided agricultural land and killed farmers in the breadbasket region of Artibonite and the south around Séguin. More than 1,400 people were killed between April and June, according to the U.N., and 1.5 million people across Haiti are displaced.

It's into this maelstrom that the U.S. is flying Haitian migrants who were stripped of their temporary protected status, known as TPS. The Trump administration insists the island is safe enough to receive the approximately 350,000 Haitians the U.S. wants to deport. These are people who have been legally living and working in the U.S. under TPS. Many work in health care and home care.

Commercial flights from the U.S. to

Haiti have been blocked amid reports of aircraft being struck by gunfire. But the Trump administration is sending planes of Haitians back to the island on deportation flights. The latest arrived Thursday, carrying about 70 people, including children.

President Joe Biden deserves some blame for his rapid overexpansion of the TPS program from about 400,000 beneficiaries to about 1.3 million people from 17 countries. Biden, in effect, created a backdoor immigration system that was always going to become politically untenable. The TPS program was meant to be "temporary," as its name suggests.

President Donald Trump and U.N. Ambassador Mike Waltz deserve credit, along with co-sponsor Panama, for pushing the gang suppression force through the Security Council. Last fall, Waltz said that, after years of failing the island, "the international community is sharing the burden, and living up to its promise to help Haiti turn the tide." Alas, the tide has not turned, and Haiti is drowning.

The U.N. force lacks the money and people needed to succeed. With guarantees of U.S. funding and equipment, more countries might be persuaded to contribute to a security force. With sustained, high-level attention, Haiti could be pulled back from the abyss. That would make sending home the 350,000 TPS recipients morally defensible.



MARK WOOD/THE SPECTATOR

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

How to keep global hunger declining

The Aug. 24 editorial "World hunger decline is the fruit of growth" rightfully praised falling global hunger. Although this progress is encouraging, there is still much to do to address food insecurity.

The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2026 report from the United Nations' Food and Agriculture Organization showed that child and maternal nutrition metrics are improving at a snail's pace, with anemia rates among women of reproductive age climbing and less than one-third of children aged 6 to 23 months achieving a minimally diverse diet. And though incomes available for food increased relative to food prices, families' ability to buy quality, nutritious foods is another matter. Investment must target affordability, especially for fruits and vegetables. Seventy to 75 percent of what consumers pay for a healthy diet accrues after the "farmgate," which is the net price paid directly to a farmer for a product before adding transport, processing or retail cost. To address this, there should be continued funding along the entire value chain. Investment in infrastructure and fiscal support redirected toward high-cost nutritious foods rather than commodity grains are essential to drastically decrease the number of moderately or severely food insecure people, currently numbering 2.1 billion.

Eric Mitchell, Washington
The writer is president of the Alliance to End Hunger.

Bring the score book back to the ballpark

Regarding Will Leitch's Aug. 22 column, "The old-school tradition making a comeback at the ballpark":

I, too, used to be a compulsive scorekeeper at baseball games. Keeping score pitch-by-pitch was as natural to me as breathing while taking in a game.

My passion, though, was minor league baseball. I often went to DMV-area teams' games, but I also toured more than 80 ballparks over the years. My score book was my constant companion, and it was a great conversation starter when I attended games by myself.

My mementos include not only the written details of the game but also the ticket stubs (remember those?), which I taped in the back of the score book, as well as autographs of players who never made it to the major leagues, such as Pork Chop Pough and Bubba Smith, and mustard stains from hot dogs past.

These books are the ultimate souvenirs. When I look back from time to time, memories of the games and the strangers who became friends for nine innings flood back.

No T-shirt, ball cap or even photograph captures the experience quite the way these beat-up old notebooks do.

Daniel W. Keiper, Falls Church

Will Leitch's column about attending and scoring games with his father brought back some fond memories for me.

I attended my first pro baseball game 70 years ago with my father in Shibe Park in Philadelphia, where the Phillies beat the Cincinnati Redlegs 10-6. Seeing Richie Ashburn, Del Ennis and Jack Meyer in the flesh was a thrill for a 9-year-old fan. I have attended many games over the years, which always involved looking at my card and filling out the scores in pencil.

On June 14, I went with my son and wife to see the Nationals play the Seattle Mariners. But when I asked to buy a program book and score book, the clerk told me that the Nats were no longer printing and selling them. I was crestfallen! However, Luis García Jr. threw me a ball in the stands. It was the first ball that I ever caught. So I wrote the date and score on the ball, and I cut out and laminated the box score that was printed in The Post. I will not be attending any more Nats games because I can no longer score them.

Joseph Scafetta Jr., Falls Church

The Pentagon loses a battle in its unnecessary war with Anthropic

ACT IN HASTE, repent at leisure. Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, take note.

A federal judge on Thursday struck down the Trump administration's sweeping effort to blacklist Anthropic, ruling that the Pentagon unlawfully retaliated against the artificial intelligence company and exceeded its authorities by labeling the firm a risk to national security.

The Pentagon had good reason to be frustrated with Anthropic. Its mistake was using a legal bazooka, which transformed a legitimate dispute over the terms of use for software into a sprawling campaign that handed the company an early win in an ongoing legal war.

The confrontation boiled over shortly after the January operation to capture Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro. An Anthropic executive contacted a counterpart at defense contractor Palantir, asking whether Anthropic's Claude model had been used. Pentagon officials took the inquiry as suggesting that Anthropic might object to the model's use in kinetic operations, an interpretation the company disputes.

The episode escalated tensions that had been building for months. Anthropic signed a government contract last year that included restrictions on its models being used in fully autonomous weapons and for mass domestic surveillance. A few months later, the Trump administration began negotiations to



Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth on Monday in Oshkosh, Wisconsin.

loosen those restrictions, insisting the Pentagon must have the authority to use the tools for all lawful purposes. A private company, the government argued, cannot have veto power over decisions made by democratically elected officials. Anthropic was refusing to bend.

The firm's perhaps casual inquiry into the Venezuela operation incensed the administration. President Donald Trump ordered federal agencies to stop using Anthropic technology, and Hegseth invoked two supply-chain laws aimed at hurting its business.

U.S. District Judge Rita F. Lin reject-

ed that gambit. She held that Hegseth's invocation of a law aimed at protecting government systems from an "adversary" that might sabotage or subvert them was arbitrary and capricious. She blocked Trump's government-wide ban and Hegseth's attempt to prevent other military contractors from doing unrelated business with Anthropic.

But Lin's ruling does not resolve the matter. The administration may appeal the decision. A second case, under a separate law, remains pending before the U.S. Court of Appeals for the D.C. Circuit. That court has allowed the Pentagon to continue excluding Anthropic while the case proceeds, calling the questions presented "novel and difficult."

None of this was necessary. Spooked by Anthropic, the Pentagon accelerated efforts to bring competing models onto its classified networks. By May, the military reached agreements with eight other technology companies, reducing dependence on any single entity. When Anthropic subsequently developed Mythos, an advanced model with extraordinary cybersecurity capabilities, the government found reason to work with the company again, even as the Pentagon continued to call Anthropic a supply-chain risk.

The lesson should be obvious. The government is right to be worried about private contractors second-guessing its lawful decisions in combat. But lashing out has helped no one.

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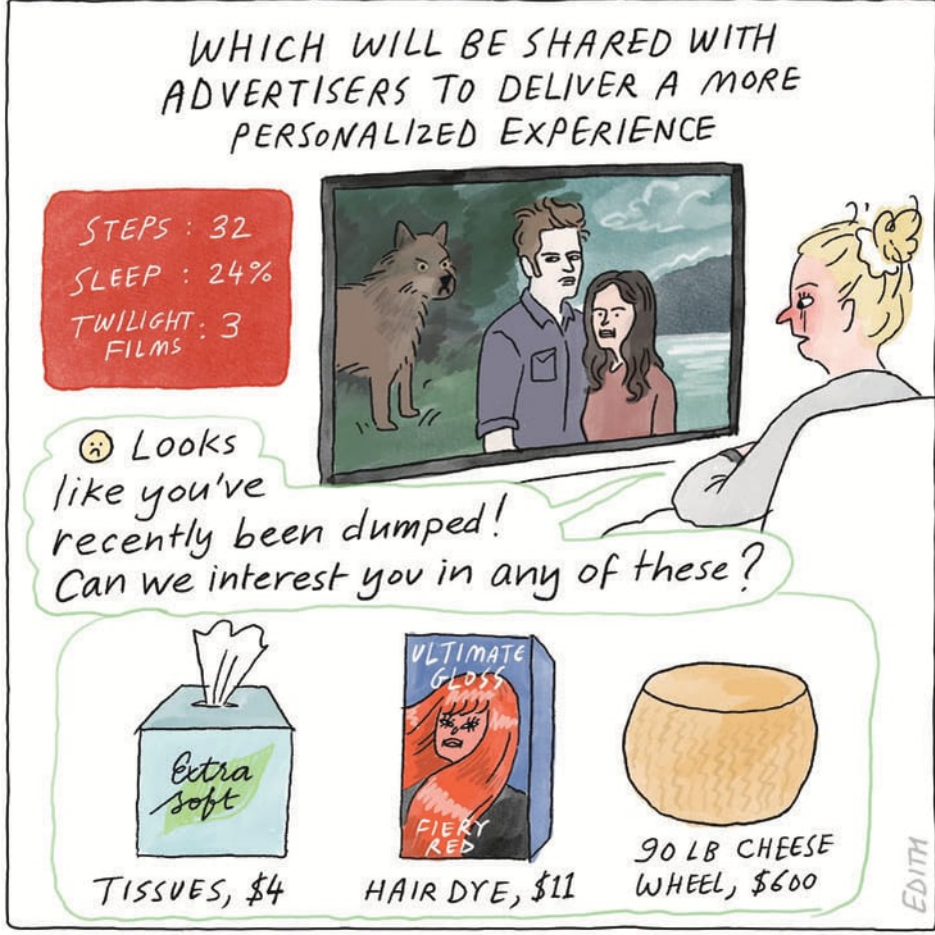
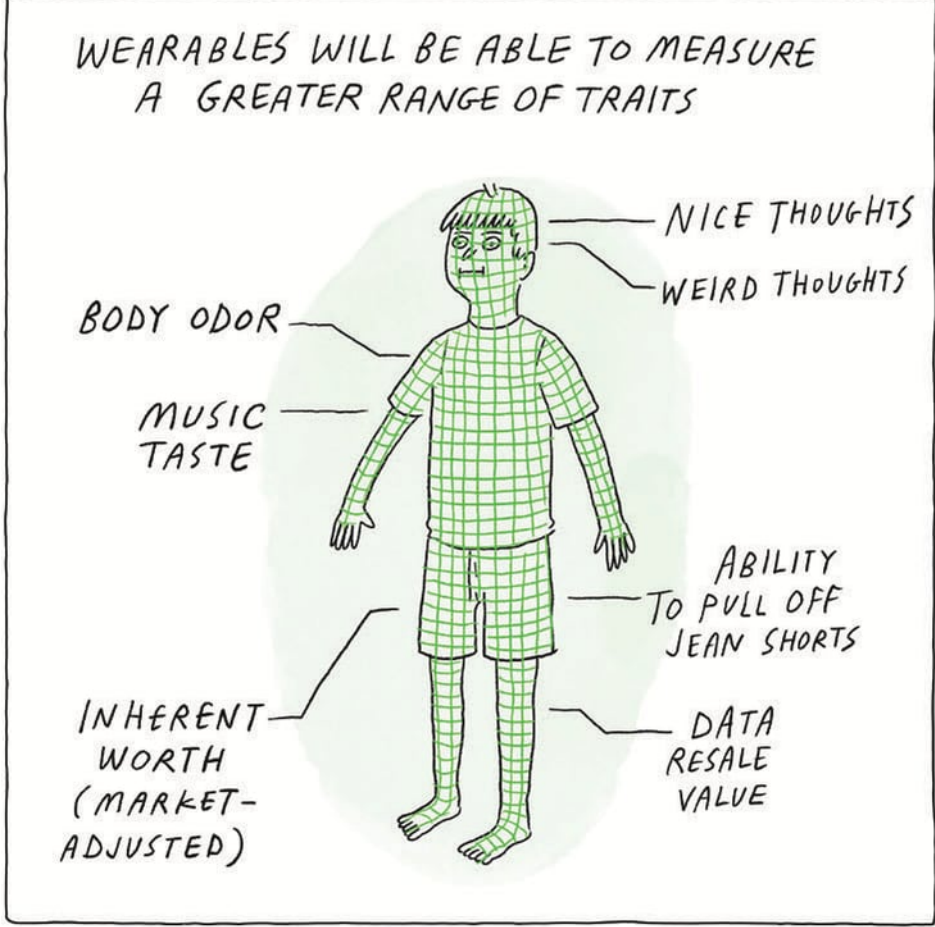
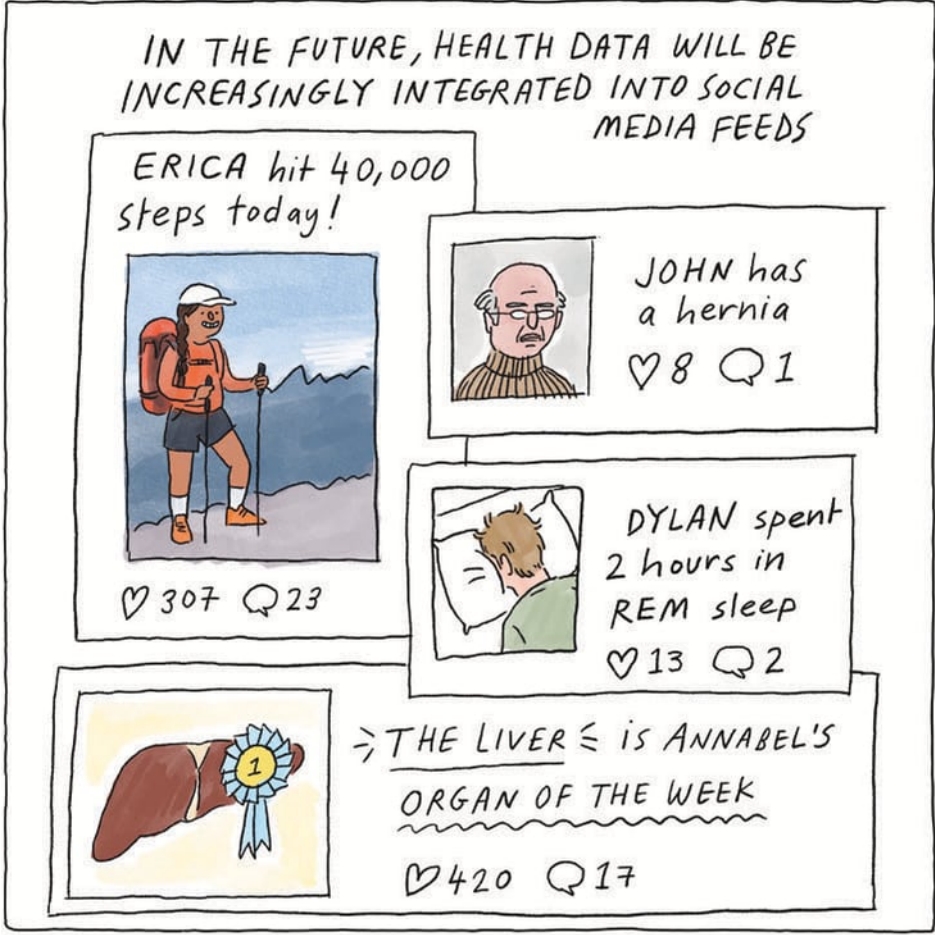
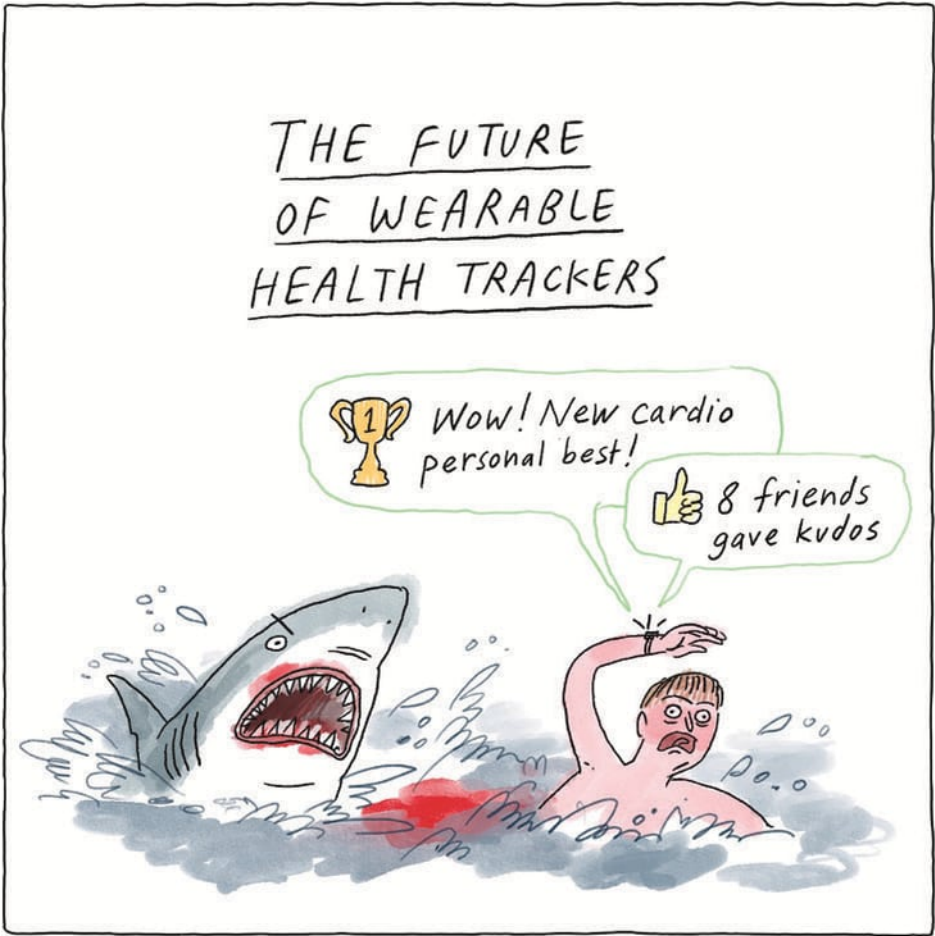
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OPINION

EDITH PRITCHETT



An unlikely state makes a bold bet on experimental medical treatments

BY VICKI NORTON

My 84-year-old mother succumbed to pancreatic cancer while exploring experimental therapies after standard care failed. State and federal right-to-try laws allow patients like my mom to seek more-promising early-stage treatments. But these laws do not provide enough infrastructure to help patients wade through options and red tape.

Legislative reform, however, is gaining momentum in one unlikely place: Montana. By enacting S.B. 535 in 2025, Montana became the first state to establish a licensing framework for experimental treatment centers where patients can seek help in accessing therapies that have completed Phase 1 clinical trials but are still under evaluation for safety and efficacy by the Food and Drug Administration.

In 2023, Montana extended its right-to-try law beyond interventions for serious and life-threatening conditions. But the 2025 law goes further. It introduces a category of licensed health care facilities authorized to recommend and administer investigational treatments. Montana created not just a legal right for patients to seek early-stage options but an infrastructure to deliver them.

The practical effect is significant. Montana is now positioned as a destination for medical tourists seeking antiaging drugs, stem cell procedures and other therapies that have cleared initial safety trials but remain years away from FDA approval.

Initial concerns that S.B. 535 was too skewed toward patient rights at the expense of patient safety have been partly allayed by regulations implementing safeguards, which were notably absent from the statute itself. For example, the regulations adopted by the Montana Department of Public Health and Human Services in July require reporting side effects, forming independent boards to approve clinical decisions, and developing programs to ensure quality by reviewing, for example, patient grievances and outcomes. In addition, centers must meet staffing and governance requirements, including retaining a medical director with a Montana license in good standing, who will develop and maintain a system for tracking patient outcomes and treatment approval status.

But additional questions remain. The right-to-try movement began at the state level in 2014 to promote patient rights. Within four years, 40 states had enacted some form of right-to-try legislation, creating momentum that Congress could not ignore. By May 2018, a federal right-to-try bill was signed into law. The state laws normalized right-to-try, created a political constituency of patients and advocacy groups, and generated pressure for a uniform federal framework that reduced uncertainty for manufacturers operating across state lines.

Could Montana trigger a similar groundswell? There are reasons to think that these new facilities may not gain the same traction. Original right-to-try laws were narrowly targeted at seriously ill patients seeking last-resort access to drugs still being tested — a politically sympathetic population with a straightforward narrative. Montana's law is far more expansive, establishing a system for deliver-



ILLUSTRATION BY CHLOE COLEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST; ISTOCK

ing experimental treatments to patients with any condition at negotiated prices.

Further, part of the rationale for S.B. 535 was to address the geographic gap in access felt acutely in Montana and other rural states underrepresented in clinical trials. To ensure that the treatment centers do not just become destinations for wealthy out-of-state tourists while leaving Montanans behind, S.B. 535 requires these new centers to allocate 2 percent of net profits to support access to care for qualifying Montana residents.

The law's expansive scope, set against a policy objective rooted largely in Montana's access-to-care challenges, may limit its appeal to other states and draw criticism from regulators and patient advocates who view the legislation as insufficiently protective of patient safety, notwithstanding the regulations.

A more pressing concern is whether federal action is needed to address legal exposure for manufacturers or clinics shipping unapproved treatments to Montana. The federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act generally prohibits introducing unapproved drugs into interstate commerce.

The federal right-to-try act carved out an exemption for eligible novel drugs provided to patients with serious or life-threatening ailments, but S.B. 535 allows for the sale of experimental treatments at licensed facilities to a broad patient population.

Two questions remain: whether the federal right-to-try exemption covers this new model — at least for dire health issues — and whether the FDA will decline to exercise its enforcement discretion against manufacturers shipping products to Montana.

If the state succeeds and others follow, the resulting patchwork of licensing regimes may generate demand for federal clarification through congressional legislation or FDA guidance. But manufacturers, investors and providers considering early entry into Montana's experimental treatment-center market cannot afford to wait. They need clarity on federal legal exposure today.

Vicki Norton is a partner at the Duane Morris law firm, where she co-leads the life sciences team.

WILL LEITCH

CBS News wants a new Andy Rooney. It should study the original first.

Last week, the media website Breaker reported that embattled "60 Minutes" executive producer Nick Bilton, empowered by equally embattled CBS News editor in chief Bari Weiss, wants to bring a long-lost segment back to the show: "A Few Minutes With." The segment, featuring Andy Rooney, ran for more than 33 years until Rooney's retirement in 2011 at 92. Bilton and Weiss are reportedly eyeing comedians (who, not coincidentally, tend to share Weiss's woke-skeptical worldview) such as Jerry Seinfeld (he turned it down) and John Cleese. With the show slated to return, much revamped and missing staples like Scott Pelley, on Sept. 13, they had better find someone fast.

If they're going to replace Rooney, it's probably worth remembering who he really was. Contrary to how it may have seemed at the time, Andy Rooney was not, in fact, born delivering commentaries to camera on Sunday nights. As we learn from "Andy Rooney: A Lucky Life," a terrific soon-to-be-released biography by Paul Grondahl, Rooney was an old-school journalist first and foremost.

He started his career covering World War II for Stars and Stripes alongside his lifelong best friend, Walter Cronkite. (Cronkite famously described a bombing over Germany as an "assignment to hell," a phrase Rooney for years mocked as too purple.) Rooney stood out, even then, for his lack of concern about decorum or likability. The only goal was the purest journalistic one: Tell the truth.

Covering the war for Stars and Stripes — a publication renowned for its independence (and currently under assault by Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth) from the government that funded it — Rooney skewered sacred cows such as Ernest Hemingway ("you could tell he was having the time of his life playing war") and, especially, George Patton, whom he called "a foulmouthed boor who got too many American soldiers killed for the sake of enhancing his own reputation." Patton wrote an angry letter to Stars and Stripes about that kind of coverage, to no effect. Rooney would eventually win the Bronze Star Medal for his work.

After the war, Rooney wrote for newspapers and, eventually, television: He won his first Emmy for CBS in 1968, quit two years later when CBS refused to run a segment called "An Essay on War," went on PBS to recite it (his first-ever appearance reading his own piece in front of a television camera) and was hired back by CBS a couple of years later. The "60 Minutes" gig happened because audiences hated a point-counterpoint segment (witheringly mocked by Dan Aykroyd and Jane Curtin on "Saturday Night Live"). They gave Rooney the last 2½ minutes and got an instant hit in return.

Rooney went at the peculiarities and indignities of American life with the same clear-eyed relentlessness that he went at Patton with. His commentaries were often about light subjects — why cereal

boxes were only half full, why electronic devices broke almost immediately — but they were based in an everyman perspective that was, more than anything, about the consumer standing up to corporate mistreatment. Grondahl writes: "He stood up for the little guy, railed against big business, spit in the eye of charlatans, exposed phoniness, skewered pomposity, grouched about everyday annoyances, and stuck to a bedrock philosophy sometimes mistaken for churlishness." That's who Rooney was: He was always trying to be a truth-teller.

This could get him into trouble. A quote from Pelley in the book is exactly right: "Andy understood that popularity has nothing whatever to do with journalism," he says. "He always had the courage of his convictions and he didn't give a damn what anyone thought about what he wrote." Pelley's right about popularity having nothing to do with journalism, but Rooney's perspective could be blinkered, whether it was mocking Kurt Cobain days after his suicide or, most notoriously, commenting on Black parents and same-sex marriage, which prompted CBS to suspend him. But he was also willing to change and, more important, to learn, saying on air that he didn't want to be "someone who had made life a little more difficult. ... I felt terrible about that." Rooney would make strong statements, but they were never hot takes, and, like any good journalist, he tried to fix the holes in his thinking.

He was also, in the purest sense, a dogged working writer: In his career, he wrote an estimated 2,000 syndicated newspaper columns and some 1,000 television commentaries, all from a desk he built by hand and dragged into the "60 Minutes" office by himself. He rarely missed a show. He died about a month after leaving the show, nearly fulfilling the writer's dream of doing what you love so much and for so long that, in the end, you just conk out at your desk.

The idea of the new "60 Minutes" having a Rooneyesque segment isn't bad. But Rooney wasn't popular, or beloved, because he just reacted to whatever dumb controversy happened to be making headlines. He was popular and beloved because he was *trusted*. And he was trusted because he took core journalistic principles and used them the way they're supposed to be used: by sticking up for the little guy.

He was, at his core, one of us. Any replacement would do well to remember one of Rooney's best quotes: "I just try to put down on paper some of the thoughts that have crossed my mind because I'm average enough so they've probably crossed the reader's too. I'm satisfied trying to quantify the obvious." In this age of disinformation, chaos and grift, I can think of no more noble calling. Here's hoping his replacement hears it, too, because we've never needed it more.

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

Labor market was weaker than reported early in Trump’s term

BY LAUREN KAORI GURLEY

The U.S. economy created even fewer jobs than originally reported in the private sector from April 2025 through March, as President Donald Trump’s tariffs and other policies took hold over parts of the economy.

Private employers added 178,000 fewer jobs than previously reported during that period, and jobs declined in retail, wholesale trade and manufacturing, according to revised jobs data from the Bureau of Labor Statistics released Friday.

Overall, the revisions to the jobs data were smaller compared to massive revisions in 2024 and 2025, and they were buoyed by public sector hiring.

“In general, it is consistent with the labor market cooling, but the temperature is falling more slowly this period than the prior two [years],” said Guy Berger, director of economic research at the Burning Glass Institute, a think tank that studies the labor market.

In recent years, the revisions data has shown the economy to be much weaker than previously thought, throwing the nonpartisan statistical agency into the spotlight and angering Trump and his allies.

However, between job reductions in the private sector and gains in the public sector, the data released Friday showed 79,000 fewer jobs over the 12-month period than initially reported, a minor adjustment compared to last year’s revisions.

However, the data suggests that an already soft labor market was weaker than previously thought. That doesn’t bode well for the Trump administration, which has been hammered on the economy ahead of the midterm elections, as higher prices weigh on Americans.

“Compared to historical revisions that found Biden-era job



TING SHEN/BLOOMBERG NEWS/GETTY IMAGES

A job fair in April 2025. Overall, the revisions to the jobs data were smaller compared to massive revisions in 2024 and 2025.

growth to have been overstated by millions, this minor revision shows that construction employment is actually up by 62,000 more jobs than previously thought – a strong leading indicator of future growth,” White House spokesman Kush Desai said in a written statement.

But manufacturing, which

had been shedding jobs because of tariffs, lost 67,000 more jobs than previously reported, Friday’s data showed. Retail, another struggling sector, shed 154,000 more jobs from April 2025 through March 2026 than initial estimates showed.

But construction and utilities sectors appear stronger. Both saw job growth during that pe-

riod fueled by the data center boom, expanding with a combined 70,000 more jobs over that period, the new data shows.

Last summer, Trump took the unprecedented step of firing BLS Commissioner Erika McEntarfer following the release of a grim jobs report that he claimed, without evidence, had been “rigged.” The following month, BLS un-

veiled revisions showing employers had created 911,000 fewer jobs than previously thought, the largest downward revision on record, and the White House declared that the agency was “broken.”

Economists, however, have shot down accusations that the data is unreliable, attributing large revisions to a variety of fac-

tors. When the economy is rapidly growing or shrinking — as it did during the pandemic, or as it can at the start of a recession — large changes can result, because it is harder for surveys to capture how many businesses are opening or shutting down, they say. Major shifts in immigration flows in recent years may have also distorted the data. The issues causing those revisions appeared to have at least partially resolved this year, and there were smaller adjustments to the data.

However, declining response rates to government phone and online surveys used to collect the data still plague the agency.

McEntarfer’s firing last year ignited fears that Trump would try to coerce the agency into producing more favorable numbers. But economists — including McEntarfer, who is now a research fellow at Stanford University — widely agree that there remains no evidence of interference in the data, which is subject to strict agency procedures and protocols. The Trump administration installed Brett Matsumoto as the new leader at the Bureau of Labor Statistics.

A career government economist who most recently worked in Trump’s White House, Matsumoto inherits challenges including rebuilding public trust in the data and addressing survey response rates. The agency’s budget has fallen behind inflation and many BLS positions remain vacant after Trump administration cuts to the federal government workforce.

The Bureau of Labor Statistics released the revised jobs numbers as part of an annual process, known as benchmarking. The revisions are preliminary and will be finalized in early 2027.

Luis Melgar contributed to this report.

AI firm Anthropic wins its lawsuit challenging Pentagon’s blacklisting

Judge rules company was illegally labeled a ‘supply chain risk’

BY IAN DUNCAN

The artificial intelligence company Anthropic won a federal lawsuit challenging the Trump administration’s decision to brand the company a national security risk earlier this year, blocking it from doing business with the entire government and military contractors.

A federal judge in San Francisco ruled Thursday that the government’s actions — justified largely by a four-page memo — were “illegal and baseless.”

Anthropic’s leaders clashed with top defense officials in February over the Pentagon’s demand that it must be allowed to use the company’s AI models for any lawful purpose. The company sought guarantees that its systems would not be used to

power fully autonomous weapons or carry out mass domestic surveillance.

Defense officials refused, and labeled the company a supply chain risk — a designation with far reaching consequences for Anthropic’s business that the judge ruled threatened to “cripple” the company by shutting it out of federal contracts.

U.S. District Judge Rita F. Lin in San Francisco ruled Thursday that while the Pentagon was free to pick and choose which contractors it works with, the administration had no basis for taking such sweeping actions.

Officials’ “contemporaneous words and deeds confirm that the challenged actions were based on a desire to make a public example out of Anthropic for its ‘arrogance’ in criticizing the government,” Lin wrote.

Anthropic makes the ChatGPT rival Claude, which has over the past year become popular with software companies for its coding skills. Thursday’s ruling follows a preliminary order by the judge in March and represents

a stinging rebuke of the Trump administration’s handling of the situation. But a separate but overlapping case in Washington is still playing out.

The government’s lawyers said at a recent hearing in the case that the Pentagon was continuing to remove Anthropic’s tools from its systems, and expected to complete the work by the end of September.

Anthropic said on Thursday that it welcomed the judge’s decision.

“We remain focused on working productively with the government to harness AI for our national security so all Americans benefit from this technology,” the company said in a statement.

The Pentagon and the White House did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Anthropic was the first AI company to be cleared to work on classified government systems in 2024 and initially worked enthusiastically with defense officials. When the battle between the two sides reached its climax



DADO RUVIC/REUTERS

Anthropic had sought guarantees from the Pentagon that its systems would not be used to power fully autonomous weapons or carry out mass domestic surveillance.

in late February, it appeared that the relationship between one of the nation’s leading AI companies and the federal government would be left badly damaged.

The Trump administration’s stance softened in April, when Anthropic announced it had developed a new model called

Mythos that had powerful new computer hacking abilities. Federal officials raced to get their hands on the technology to understand the risks it posed, and Anthropic chief executive Dario Amodei visited the White House.

Lin wrote in her decision Thursday that the government’s

ongoing discussions with Anthropic about using Mythos undercut its argument that the company posed a risk.

“None of that is consistent with a genuine fear that Anthropic is a saboteur who would poison its software to harm national security,” she wrote.

DIGEST

BANKING

Operations limited by Trump administration

The Trump administration is taking steps to limit an Egyptian bank’s operations in the United Arab Emirates, accusing the financial institution of serving as an economic lifeline to Tehran’s leadership as the U.S. war against Iran reaches the six-month mark.

Under a new rule proposed Friday by the Treasury Department, the Emirati branches of Banque Misr, Egypt’s second-largest bank, would be severed from access to the U.S. financial system.

It follows Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent’s announcement this week of a new campaign to push countries that still do business with the already heavily sanctioned Islamic Republic to sever their financial ties or face retaliation from the United States.

In stopping short of imposing sanctions on the Egyptian bank, the move signals the Republican administration’s reluctance to penalize major trading partners that do business with Iran,

including China and India. Bessent told reporters on Monday that he wanted countries to have an opportunity to shift away from Iran before it was too late in a bid to avoid upending the global financial system.

The rule will be subject to a 30-day public comment period before it takes effect, the Treasury Department said.

Egypt’s foreign ministry and central bank confirmed knowledge of the new rulemaking and are communicating with U.S. officials, according to a statement issued by the Central Bank of Egypt on Friday.

It added that the measure does not affect any other Egyptian bank and does not extend to the Banque Misr’s operations inside Egypt or to any of its overseas branches.

— Associated Press

QUANTUM COMPUTERS

Canada to lend \$140M for plant

The Canadian government will loan \$140.78 million to Xanadu Quantum for setting up a plant that would make photonic components for quantum computers, in the country’s largest ever support for the technology.

The move, unveiled on Friday, highlights growing global interest in quantum computers and comes months after the Trump administration decided to take \$2 billion in equity stakes across nine quantum-computing firms to secure U.S. leadership.

Experts have long touted quantum computers’ potential to solve problems regular computers cannot and speed up scientific discoveries, but the technology remains error prone because of its extreme sensitivity to any disturbances including sound.

Friday’s loan covers the federal portion of up to C\$390 million in potential government funding Xanadu announced in March. The company said it expects to announce a deal for the remaining sum of up to C\$195 million, from Ontario’s provincial government, “in the near future.”

Xanadu said it would use the federal loan to help build a manufacturing plant for photonics in Toronto, without sharing the terms.

— Reuters

INDUSTRY

Inspectors find tank was not fit for service

An inspection contractor found a chemical tank at a Washington state paper mill “not fit for continued service” 10 months before it failed in May, killing 11 in one of the deadliest U.S. workplace disasters in recent decades, according to a federal report released Friday.

The U.S. Chemical Safety Board’s update about the May 26 failure in Longview, which expelled enough caustic liquid to blow out building walls, is part of an ongoing investigation. The federal agency said it is still determining the cause of the failure.

The board found that the contractor provided Nippon Dynawave Packaging Company with recommendations for internal inspections and shell repairs, but the company did none between a July 2025 inspection and the May 2026 failure.

The Association of Western Pulp and Paper Workers released a statement on Friday saying the board’s findings were “deeply troubling.”

A lawyer representing the family of two brothers who were killed, Tyler and Bradley Covington, said the board’s findings are “nothing short of alarming.”

In July 2025, the contractor found “significant thinning” below the minimum safe thickness in the lower regions of the tank after an external inspection, according to the board’s report. The minimum safe thickness is a threshold that measures a tank’s ability to contain the pressure of the liquid and support the tank’s weight, the report said.

The same contractor inspected the exterior of the tank in October 2025 and February 2026 and both times identified that “large portions of the tank remained thinner than the calculated minimum safe wall thickness.”

The tank failure released roughly 900,000 gallons of a liquid known as white liquor that is used to break down wood for making paper products and is capable of causing severe burns. In addition to the workers killed, several others and one firefighter were injured.

All eight workers in the electrical maintenance shop as well as a worker in the courtyard

were killed. In the mechanical maintenance shop, five employees and the foreman escaped, but two were killed from exposure to the chemical, the report said. Two of the people who escaped were seriously injured due to chemical burns.

— Associated Press

A federal appeals court on Friday said Kalshi is not entitled to an injunction to block Nevada from overseeing its prediction markets platform, which allows people to bet on the outcome of sporting events. In a 3-0 decision, the 9th U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals in San Francisco said the federal Commodity Exchange Act likely did not preempt Nevada’s gaming regulations as applied to the sports event contracts. The ruling for Nevada increases the possibility that the Supreme Court may choose to decide whether states or the U.S. Commodity Futures Trading Commission should regulate the fast-growing prediction markets industry.

— From news services



SPORTS
D.C. United has taken a step forward, but the team isn't a true contender yet. **B7**



METRO
The East Potomac Park overhaul hasn't started, but trees are being cleared. **B13**

The Washington Post
Style

SATURDAY, AUGUST 29, 2026

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PHOTOS BY GREG DERR/POOL/PATRIOT LEDGER/AP

Above, Lindsay Clancy listens to testimony Thursday during her murder trial in Plymouth, Massachusetts. At right, defense attorney Kevin Reddington holds up a picture of the Clancy family during closing arguments in the trial.



SCREENS

The abject hell of the Lindsay Clancy trial

The Massachusetts woman is on trial for killing her 3 children, but she's already been damned

BY MONICA HESSE

In the waning days of Lindsay Clancy's trial this week, the final witness, a neatly trimmed forensic psychiatrist, told the jury what Lindsay had told him about the evening she killed her three children. According to the doctor, Lindsay said she'd brought her middle child, 3-year-old Dawson, to the basement first, and then her 5-year-old, Cora, downstairs to a separate room. The baby was last, which might have been why doctors were able to briefly restart a heartbeat once he was rushed to the hospital after his father returned home. Callan was 8 months old.

Before we go any further, there are not enough trigger warnings in the universe to prepare you to have watched this trial, which has been live-streamed every day since it began last month, and for which the jury began deliberations Thursday afternoon. It will probably give you nightmares. It certainly gave them to me. It became a referendum on motherhood and mental health, but also on conspiracy theories and courtroom demeanor, and women's hair accessories, all against the backdrop of the worst thing you can imagine.

Lindsay's accounting of events has occasionally shifted in minute details over the past three years. But she's never changed the basic contours of her story, which is that on Jan. 24, 2023, she suggested takeout for dinner and, while her husband, Patrick, was retrieving it, she heard a voice com-

manding her to kill their children, so that she could then kill herself. She strangled the children with exercise bands. Then she went upstairs, swallowed an assortment of pills, sliced her neck with a knife, and jumped out a second-story window.

The pills, the knife and the fall were not enough to end her life, but she did mangle her spine on impact, an injury that left her permanently using a wheelchair.

Her survival turned an already tragic story into a ghoulish one, because an alive Lindsay Clancy is one who must account for her actions. She was arrested and, this month in Massachusetts, sat before a jury of her peers in a trial that has made so many home viewers completely lose their bearings.

Throughout the four weeks that I have spent following Lindsay Clancy's trial and the online response, I have heard observers speculate that she is a monster. I have heard them speculate that she is a victim. That she is a loving mother and a criminal mastermind. I have heard that she is a psychopath. That she made her psychiatrist fall in love with her. I have viewed security-footage stills from a CVS, which online commenters swore was game-changing, and which they marked up with arrows and circles. Only no matter how many times I looked, I couldn't tell what those arrows and circles were supposed to mean.

I have heard people speculate that an intruder killed Lindsay

SEE **SCREENS** ON **B2**

Songs that showcase Parton's brilliance

As a singer and songwriter, the country music maven worked overtime on '9 to 5' and other hits

BY ETHAN BECK

Over the years, Dolly Parton steadily transformed into a mythical figure. Parton, who died Tuesday at 80, was the consummate business executive behind Dollywood, the mastermind behind a book-gifting program, the philanthropic giant whose donation helped spur the Moderna vaccine for the coronavirus. Each of those pieces of her public-facing persona seemed to naturally grow from a vast discography where Parton established herself as hardscrabble, emotionally forthright and full of intuition.

She was that rare singer-songwriter whose unparalleled gifts remained clear across her entire career, no matter if she was dabbling in disco, pop or full-throated rock. But Parton's dual roles as vocalist and composer were rare for women in the 1960s. "I really couldn't

make a choice: I have to write and I have to sing, and I'd rather do both," she said in 1967, estimating that she'd already written a few hundred songs. Here are just six of the plainspoken, infectious classics that Parton was behind:

'Your Ole Handy Man' (1967)

Many might point to "Dumb Blonde," which contained the assertion that Parton "ain't nobody's fool," as an early example of how she built a larger-than-life persona. But "Your Ole Handy Man" remains an astute look at how domestic labor gets undervalued in relationships. A tumbling drum groove and healthy harmonies assist Parton as she rebukes her lover as being "as helpless as a baby."

'Coat of Many Colors' (1971)

One of Parton's early country hits, "Coat of Many Colors" re-

SEE **SONGS** ON **B3**

FINDING EMILY ★★☆☆

British rom-com is predictable but still charming

BY LINDSEY BAHR
Associated Press

Late August can be a depressing time at the movie theater, but there's a gem to be found in the British romantic comedy "Finding Emily," now in theaters. Here, finally, is a smart, funny and sweet story about young love that moviegoing audiences deserve. Yes, the setup is contrived — it even fits almost entirely into a movie trailer — but it's in a way that's familiar and grounded enough, and unlike the insanely dystopian "One Night Only." There are no ridiculous laws against premarital sex on this university campus in Manchester; Just regular young people getting in their own way.

The movie begins with one of those too-good-to-be-true meet-cutes, where Owen (Spike Fearn) finds his dream girl (Sadie Soverall) who is dressed in a fairy costume and seems to be into him. Brit pop plays in the background and the world seems to fade away. The night takes her elsewhere with her friends, but not before she gives her number to Owen. He leaves on cloud nine, wondering how much time to let pass before

SEE **'FINDING EMILY'** ON **B2**



MATT SQUIRE/FOCUS FEATURES/AP

Spike Fearn, left, and Angourie Rice in the smart, funny and sweet romantic comedy "Finding Emily."

Clancy’s trial has been fodder for an array of would-be armchair detectives

SCREENS FROM B1

Clancy’s children. I have heard people speculate Patrick did it, then pushed his wife out the window, then she got amnesia, then became gaslit into believing she is the guilty one.

She *is* the guilty one — she has never denied that her children died at her hands. The question is whether she’s legally guilty. The question is whether Lindsay, who had been struggling mightily with mental health issues after the birth of her third child, who was suffering from insomnia, and who had been prescribed multiple antidepressants and sleep aids that she did not feel were working, was undergoing a psychotic break at the time of the deaths.

The defense implied she was overmedicated and failed by clinicians who should have realized she was a danger to herself and others. They said she lacked the capacity to understand that what she was doing was wrong and should be found not guilty by reason of insanity.

The prosecution’s argument is that, while Lindsay might have been suffering, on the night of the deaths, she was still able to understand that killing her children was both wrong and criminal. But she wanted to end her own mental suffering, so she proceeded with a course of action that required both haste and planning.

“What types of decisions had to be made to effectuate the strangulation of the children?” one prosecutor asked a psychologist on the stand earlier this week.

“There are many ongoing decisions that have to be made to accomplish a killing like this in 18 to 20 minutes,” the psychologist said. “For example: Why the basement? Who among the children goes first? What do you say to the kids to keep them from panicking?”

Is there significance in the fact that Lindsay may have crushed the pills before swallowing them? What to make of the fact that the restaurant Lindsay suggested was one the Clancys didn’t typically frequent? Or that she’d timed out the route before sending Patrick to pick up the food?

Maybe nothing. Maybe there is no significance. But when a complicated case is presented on YouTube, suddenly everyone believes it’s *something*, that they have cracked the whole thing open, in ways that doctors, investigators, lawyers and Lindsay herself could not.

This case was blood in the water for every would-be armchair detective, circling and ready to divvy up the misery. The horror became a project, the grief became must-see TV; if you watched on YouTube, as I did, testimony about the effects of Wellbutrin, for example, might be periodically interrupted by ads for bunch-free underwear or industrial-strength packing materials.

While watching the live stream, I wondered a lot about the trial’s camera operator. For most of the court proceedings, the lens remained focused on whomever was testifying, a series of experts and family acquaintances.

But sometimes the camera would pan to Lindsay. As if the operator knew that viewers wouldn’t want to simply evaluate expert testimony, but witness

Lindsay’s reaction and then evaluate that, too.

She normally sat expressionless and still, brown hair held in place with a headband and curled around her shoulders. Who can guess what was going on in her mind? I don’t know if, in a situation like that, you force yourself to be present for the horror, or you attempt to escape by trying to remember all the transition metals on the periodic table. All the European capitals. Something like that.

At one point, while a medical expert described examining the lifeless body of Cora Clancy, Lindsay’s shoulders began to heave up and down as she sobbed. “I can’t do this,” she wailed.

Lindsay’s face was largely blocked from view as the court hastily adjourned for a recess, but we could still hear her crying, “I can’t do this; I can’t do this,” until the camera panned to the place it always did during breaks, to the blue Massachusetts seal on the courtroom wall.

Have I gotten it wrong? Left something out? If you are one of the spectators who has been following this trial, your answer is almost certainly yes, I did not properly interpret the circles and arrows, I left out the most important thing. Something to do with Patrick’s involvement as a husband, maybe, or with Lindsay’s career as a labor and delivery nurse, or with the difference between hearing voices and having intrusive thoughts.

We want to really nail this down. To have it all make sense and learn the secret of what compelled Lindsay to kill her children.

If you believe Lindsay should be found guilty, it might be because this is the most hideous act you can imagine, and you think that a mother’s love should be able to supersede any alleged voices in your head.

If you believe she should be found not guilty, it might be because you want to believe that if a good mother — and Lindsay was by all accounts a good mother — kills her children, then she must have been insane while doing it.

Andrea Yates drowned her five children in a bathtub after her husband persuaded her to have another baby — despite doctors’ warnings that another pregnancy would be ruinous to her mental health. She was initially found guilty until the case was thrown out; in a new trial she was found not guilty by reason of insanity. Susan Smith pushed a car containing her two sons into a lake, and then blamed it on a fictitious hijacker. She was not unwell, just unimaginable.

But almost everyone seems to agree that Lindsay Clancy was desperately, desperately sick. At various points, we learned in the trial, specialists who treated or interviewed Lindsay speculated that she might have had major depressive disorder. Or adjustment disorder with anxiety and depression. Bipolar disorder. Bipolar 2. Postpartum depression. Postpartum psychosis. Postpartum stress disorder.

A courtroom is not the right place for this, I found myself thinking more than once. Which is ridiculous because the courtroom is the only place we have for this. But our legal system is adversarial, so jurors have to choose one option or the other: either she was a failed by the



Lindsay Clancy’s parents, Michael and Paula Musgrove, exit the courthouse earlier this week.



Supporters of Clancy gather outside the courthouse in Plymouth, Massachusetts.



Defense attorneys argue that Clancy should be found not guilty by reason of insanity.

medical system, or she was a monster.

It seemed to me, though, that Lindsay was often helped by many professionals to the best of their ability. She had outpatient treatment. Inpatient. She was referred for talk therapy. She was prescribed medications, some of which she was afraid to take because of the side effects. The family was close with Lindsay’s parents, and they offered help. The family was close with Patrick’s parents, and they offered help.

Lindsay was begging for help. Everyone tried to help. But there are vast chasms of the mind that we still do not understand, that we try to fit into our personal concepts of “motherly instinct,” and that we then expect a court to figure out.

We can’t nail it down. It’s not going to make sense. That is the secret.

I’m going to tell you something that nearly every mother has said when we have discussed this case at the swimming pool, or on the sidewalk after pickup or in a group chat that originally started because of Dolly Parton. The thing that almost every mother has said is, *I would be dead by now*.

As in, Lindsay did not ultimately end her own life when she ended her children’s, but how did she not try again later? How does she continue to wake up every morning?

One mental health expert testified that Lindsay was now “future oriented,” which we were left to assume is an official psychological term referring to the ability to envision and plan ahead, but which I heard and thought, *what future is there?* What future would she want there to be?

“She did nothing wrong in her life,” her attorney said in closing arguments. “She was a nurse, a daughter, a wife and a darn good mother,” who ended up in a nightmare “because of the damn medicine and the lousy medical care.”

“She was depressed,” the prosecutor said in her closing arguments. “She was exhausted. She was done. She didn’t want to try anymore, she felt damaged. Those kids were her protective factor. They were keeping her from ending her misery. And so she had to remove the protective factor.”

I have been watching this trial for days. I have been nauseated by it at night. Sometimes when I can’t sleep I tiptoe in to look at my sleeping daughter, who is the same age that Cora Clancy was when she died, thinking about what I would do if someone hurt her. And then thinking about if that person was me.

I sit there on the edge of the bed, and after weeks of doing nothing but hearing people try to convince me of Lindsay Clancy’s guilt or innocence, I find myself having a difficult time caring about the outcome. Because I have a difficult time picturing caring about the outcome even if I were Lindsay Clancy.

Instead, I wonder if I’d be thinking: *Punish me. Don’t punish me. Send me to prison. Send me to the hospital. Send me home. It does not matter to me. None of it matters to me. Give me my children. Give me back January 23. Punish me or don’t, but there is nothing you can do that is worse than the hell I created and where I live every day.*

‘Finding Emily’ nods to the grand tradition of Brit rom-coms in the 1990s

‘FINDING EMILY’ FROM B1

he texts. But there’s a problem: The number is one digit short. Was it intentional? Was it a mistake? He chooses to believe the latter and sets off to find her, knowing only her first name, Emily.

No one is especially charmed by Owen’s desperate quest to find Emily on campus. Rachel Hiron’s script understands a fundamental truth about romantic comedies and the grand gesture — they work only if the other party is into it. If they’re not into it, at best, it’s creepy. At worst, it’s the beginning of a horror movie. But then another Emily (Angourie Rice) emerges and, after giving Owen a hard time and name checking the manic pixie dream girl trope, decides to help. What the audience knows, however, and he doesn’t, is that this Emily, an American, has an ulterior motive. She’s trying to prove, for a thesis that will get her a job and allow her to stay in the country, that love drives people mad. “He’s my very own Stanford Prison Experiment,” she excitedly tells a friend.

You can see where this is going, right? Even if it’s predictable, it’s also really quite sharp and charm-

ing under Alicia MacDonald’s direction, both nodding to the grand tradition of ’90s Brit rom-coms (“Finding Emily” shares producers with “Bridget Jones’s Diary”) while also adding a grain of Gen Z salt to the proceedings. You can bet that there are some Serious Concerns raised by women’s groups on campus when Owen, who is not a student but an employee on probationary hire, emails all the Emilys.

Fearn, as Owen, manages to never cross the line into creepy. With his very Noel Gallagher haircut and so skinny, twitchy innocence, he’s flustered by the attention and accusations of incel-dom thrown his way. Rice, meanwhile, has a more challenging hurdle to win over the audience, but we’ve forgiven worse rom-com offenses, right? And, unlike the alien beauty of the stars of “One Night Only,” her costumes and manner seem at least a little more relatable (while also knowing that she too is a beautiful movie star).

One especially fresh aspect of “Finding Emily” is that the will-they-won’t-they isn’t even the real driving force of our interest. Are we really rooting for Owen and American Emily? Do we think they might, gasp, last if it hap-

pens? This movie knows what it is. It knows that its leads are in their early 20s, and it knows that we can enjoy spending time with them without investing too much in a possible relationship. “Finding Emily” is just one story in their lives.

It’s bleak out there for romantic comedy fans, and it seems lately that the flashiest of the meager offerings are the most suspect. It’s not that these movies aren’t being made at all, it’s just that the ones that seem to get the most attention have been the worst in recent months, like, say, “Office Romance.” It’s promising that “Finding Emily” is getting a theatrical release, perhaps it won’t be lost in the streaming ether like the very good “Voicemails for Isabelle,” which spent some time atop the Netflix charts but has basically disappeared since. And it’s notable that “Voicemails” was also written and directed by a woman (Leah McKendrick); Perhaps all studios should take note where the recent good ones are coming from.

PG-13. Contains coarse language, drug references, sexual references and some crude material. 111 minutes.



“Finding Emily” director Alicia MacDonald, center, with Angourie Rice, left, and Amber Grapp.

The essential songs of country’s Dolly Parton

SONGS FROM B1

flected her meager upbringing in eastern Tennessee. Her mother sewed clothing from rags, resulting in kids at school once locking Parton in a closet. But she got the last laugh with “Coat of Many Colors,” which turns that childhood distress into something hopeful: “Although we had no money, I was rich as I could be/ In my coat of many colors my mama made for me,” Parton sang.

‘Jolene’ (1973)

“Jolene” came from another true-life story in which Parton realized that her husband had a little crush on a local bank teller. She directed anxieties around her potential competition into a galloping, tense number that doesn’t offer a happy ending for its narrator. Parton’s plea to a woman who could “easily take my man” is unforgettablely personal, but her desperation has such an intense appeal that both the White Stripes and Miley Cyrus have covered it.

‘I Will Always Love You’ (1974)

Long before it had been supercharged by Whitney Houston into one of the ballads of pop music, “I Will

Always Love You” was Parton’s goodbye to the singer Porter Wagoner, whom she spent years performing with as a duo. The airy vocal on the original recording anchors Parton’s heartache, while those tender electric guitars and a doo-wop-esque choir make it clear why Elvis Presley wanted to do a rendition.

‘Light of a Clear Blue Morning’ (1977)

If Parton’s professional separation from Wagoner eventually resulted in one of the biggest songs of all time, it also brought us “Light of a Clear Blue Morning,” which transitions from piano ballad to rollicking gospel sermon with ease. As Parton’s second single to reach the Billboard Hot 100, it managed to reach only No. 87, a shocking status for a song that scales such ecstatic heights.

‘9 to 5’ (1980)

Anyone who’s taken a dead-end job to pay the bills understands the plight of Parton’s tale where she’s just “barely gettin’ by.” It’s an anthem that’s been adopted by a broad swath of humanity — drag queens, soundtrack supervisors for “Deadpool 2” and “Gravity Falls,” labor unions — thanks to those horn honks and a disco-flavored groove.



PA IMAGES/GETTY IMAGES

Dolly Parton at London’s Heathrow Airport in 1976. She was the rare female artist in the ’60s who was both vocalist and composer.



CINDY ORD/GETTY IMAGES

Kit Harington, third from left, will play a Hogwarts instructor in HBO’s “Harry Potter” series.

Harington joins ‘Harry Potter’ series

BY ALEXANDRA DEL ROSARIO
Los Angeles Times

Kit Harington has returned to the realm of HBO’s fantasy programming.

Harington, popular for portraying reluctant hero Jon Snow in the TV adaptation of George R.R. Martin’s “Game of Thrones,” has joined the cast of HBO’s “Harry Potter” series, the network confirmed Monday. HBO teased Harington’s casting on Instagram, revealing he will play Professor Gilderoy Lockhart.

“Superman” and “Renfield” actor Nicholas Hoult was initially cast in the role but departed the series over scheduling issues, according to Deadline. In the film

adaptations of author J.K. Rowling’s beloved children’s series, Kenneth Branagh portrayed the Hogwarts instructor.

Emmy-nominated Harington comes to the TV series with some “Harry Potter” experience already in hand. Last year he voiced Professor Lockhart for Audible’s “Harry Potter” audiobooks. Years after “Game of Thrones” ended in 2019, Harington reunited with HBO for its gritty finance drama “Industry,” portraying a complicated tech CEO.

HBO’s “Harry Potter” is set to premiere on Christmas Day with Dominic McLaughlin as Harry Potter, Alastair Stout as Ron Weasley and Arabella Stanton as Hermione Granger. Other cast members include John Lithgow

as Albus Dumbledore, Nick Frost as Rubeus Hagrid, Paapa Essiedu as Severus Snape, Janet McTeer as Minerva McGonagall, Luke Thallon as Quirinus Quirrell and Paul Whitehouse as Argus Filch.

Earlier this year, actor Gracie Cochrane’s family announced that the young actor departed the series— she was to play Ron Weasley’s younger sister Ginny — because of a “challenging decision” to “unforeseen circumstances.”

“We support Gracie Cochrane and her family’s decision not to return for the next season of HBO’s ‘Harry Potter’ series,” HBO wrote in a statement at the time, “and we are grateful for her work on season one of the show.”

Spouse is at a stalemate with in-laws who stubbornly refuse to eat at a table



Carolyn Hax

Adapted from an online discussion.

Dear Carolyn: My in-laws do not sit at the table to eat. Whether it is just mother- and father-in-law at home or the

entire extended family, food goes on the counter and people self-serve and sit all over the house — some in front of the TV, others in the living room or porch looking at phones.

When I’m at their houses, I go with the flow. In our house, I want to sit at the table unless it is something like a cookout or the Super Bowl. This was such a concern of mine that I raised it with my husband while dating and we agreed to sit at the table.

Now when his parents come over, they refuse to sit at the table. His dad in particular says he’s not a child and I can’t force him. So we are in a bit of a stalemate.

I don’t want to have them over for a meal if it means working hard to prepare it only to sit scattered in our house and not talking. My mother-in-law is telling everyone in the family that I won’t have them over for a meal.

They like to play bingo and take their dog to the park for

long walks. My husband has asked if we can join them to do these things or go to a restaurant, and my mother-in-law refuses, because she knows we are asking to avoid meals at our house.

I waffle between thinking I’m being obnoxious and should give up, to thinking my in-laws are really being bullies. My husband is supporting me but frustrated, too. He asked me to write to you. So I am and hoping you’ve got ideas for me.

— A Seat at the Table

A Seat at the Table: Whoo. Good luck with these two.

A few things.

1. Tell your husband thanks.
2. Also tell him I’m sorry, because his dad is such a child. “You can’t force me,” really? And congrats, too, for falling a notable distance from the tree.
3. You, Seat, already “won” a while ago. You both did. That’s in irony quotes because the only victory is harmony, even if each of you eats crouched alone in a different closet. You two are a gently united front against this bizarre tantrum his parents are having. Great.
4. For what it’s worth, though: Drawing the hard line on the in-laws’ visits was totally within your rights to do, but you inadvertently stepped into a



ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFIANAKIS FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

power struggle. Presumably you and Mr. You Can’t Tell Me What to Do had already met? Mind you, they sound like wonderful people not to have across from you at any table anywhere, so if you were ready to let dinner die on this hill, then I’m all for that — but given the dad’s tendencies,

putting bingo-and-dog-walks first might have been the better move if you weren’t ready for outright war.

5. You’re here now, so, back to marital peace, at least. Please work this out with your husband: How would you like to deal with his parents, so that you

both can be content not to think about their big standing stand ever again? That will be the entirety of the answer once we’re through harrumphing about all the other stupid parts they’re forcing you to deal with, such as your mother-in-law’s bad-mouthing campaign. Holy bats.

6. Your in-laws really are being bullies. The whole sit-off is so insane, you have no weak spots to concede on. Unless you want to: “If they want to enforce their rules in our home [I mean really, wow], then I won’t work to host.” So, they can bring the food, or eat air-fryer hors d’oeuvres. And wander only in designated spots, if, for example, you don’t want red wine near your white sofa. Did I typo an H in there? Oh, goofy me.

I included that option in case you want one. If I were you, though, then I wouldn’t do that; I’d want my beloved apple to distance himself fully from the tree on this, in the following talk with his parents: “You’ve got one shot at life. This is really the best you’ve got? Insulting my spouse? Trashing us to the family? Refusing invitations to compromise-freaking-bingo?” Followed by a pledge of many warm invitations once they find their manners again, which will be easier once they extract their heads from [places].

Maybe that’s their issue with sitting.

Re: Seat: Personally, I would look for the solution that amused me the most, and I think it would be pretty hilarious to invite in-laws to dinner, set the table (elaborately), serve the food at the table, but say nothing if the in-laws took their plates and departed. You and your husband could stay at the table and eat as if nothing was happening and in-laws could wander around.

What I would NOT do is serve from the kitchen. Make them come to the table to fill their plates then do whatever they like. Better yet, invite other people and have everyone at the table but them.

— Anonymous

Anonymous: “I would look for the solution that amused me the most.”

Everything just snapped into focus.

Thank you. To you and to the reader who advised disconnecting the TV.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/live-chats.

Looking for clever response to backhanded compliments at high school reunion

Miss Manners

JUDITH MARTIN, JACOBINA MARTIN AND NICHOLAS IVOR MARTIN

I believe my response was “Thanks ... I think.” Later this year, I will be attending another reunion, and am seeking your advice on an appropriate response, should I be the recipient of a similar comment.

Dear Miss Manners: I attended my high school reunion about 10 years ago, and while standing in line at the buffet, a former classmate told me, “Gee, you look a lot better than you did in high school.”

I would hate to repeat myself!

“I suppose I just keep getting better.” And then resist the temptation to indicate that your classmate clearly has not.

Dear Miss Manners: On my birthday, my family all insists upon calling and speaking with me individually to wish me a happy birthday and check in. I don’t begrudge them the sentiment, but I must admit that I don’t particularly enjoy this ritual. I speak with my siblings and parents otherwise on a

regular basis, and those other conversations are wonderful, but usually limited to weekends when both parties have more downtime, and often I may speak with one relative a day ... not all of them in one day.

When my birthday falls on a weekday, I would much rather spend the time in the evening, after returning from work, with my children and spouse rather than on the phone having perfunctory conversations. Heck, even when it is a weekend birthday, I don’t want to have to schedule in these calls.

Can you suggest a polite way to

decline the request of “When are you free for a call today?” When it is my other family members’ birthdays, I do not go out of my way to call them, but rather will send them a birthday text that does not require any response.

This year for my birthday, I suggested that they all call me around the same time, so that I could politely end one call to pick up the new call that was just incoming. This worked well enough, but I suspect my parents were up to my ruse, and quite frankly, even managing this subterfuge was more than I cared

for. I don’t want to be rude, and I certainly want to continue our occasional phone calls, but how can I better manage the requests to speak on my birthday?

Do not pick up. Or when your family texts to ask what time to call, tell them that you have a busy day planned, but appreciate the sentiment and will catch up on your next occasional call.

This solves the problem and is not impolite. But Miss Manners warns you that it is not without long-term consequences. There may come a day when you will

welcome these calls, as tedious as you find them at the moment. Miss Manners hopes that your current fatigue will dissipate and you will see that your family loves you and only wants to celebrate you. That they annoy you, too, is just a bonus.

New Miss Manners columns are posted Monday through Saturday on washingtonpost.com/advice. You can send questions to Miss Manners at her website, missmanners.com. You can also follow her @RealMissManners.

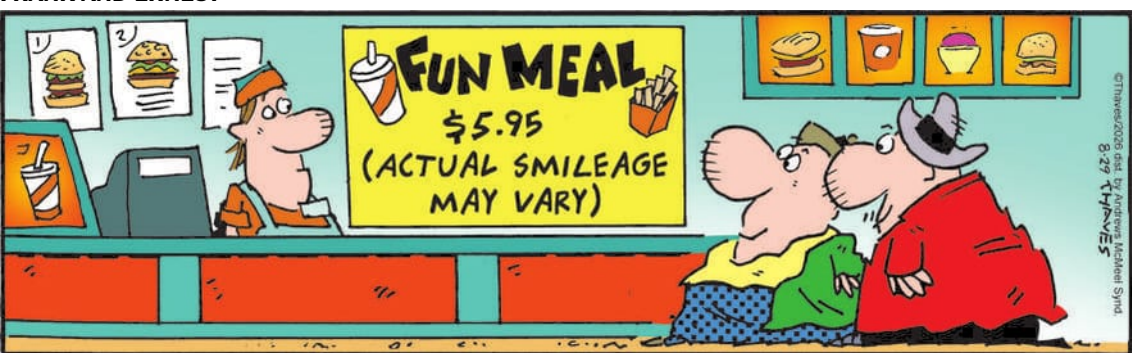
CLASSIC DOONESBURY



RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



CLASSIC PEANUTS



RHYMES WITH ORANGE



LIO



HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



BLONDIE



BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



PICKLES



AGNES



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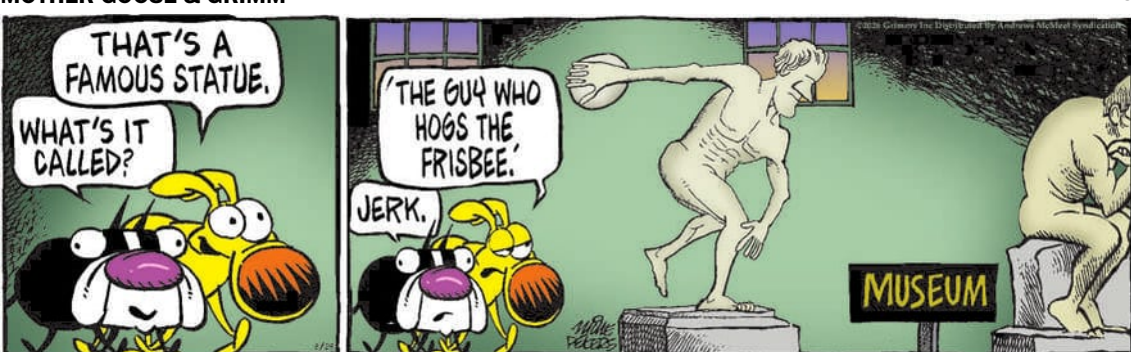
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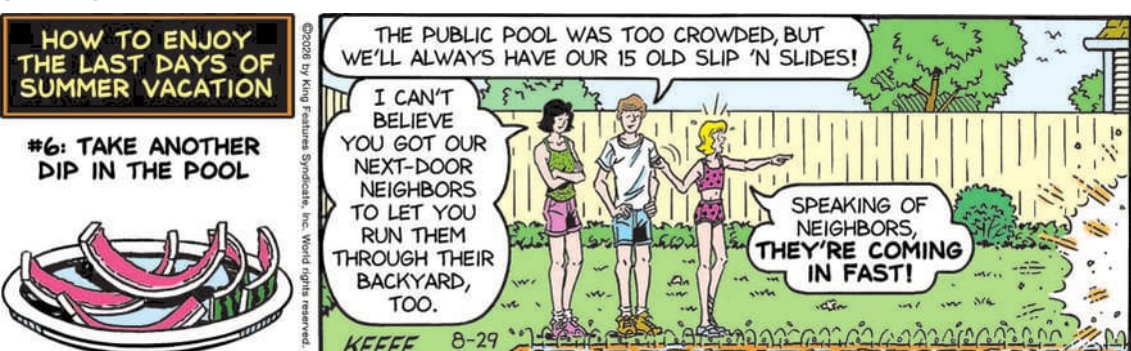
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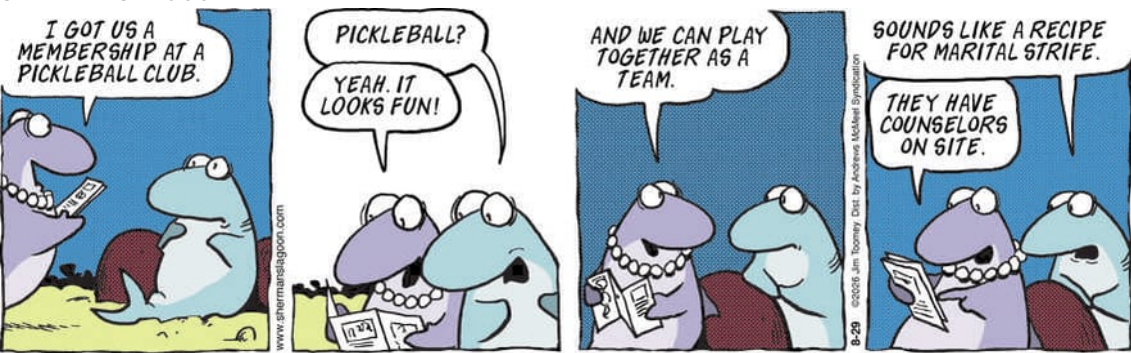
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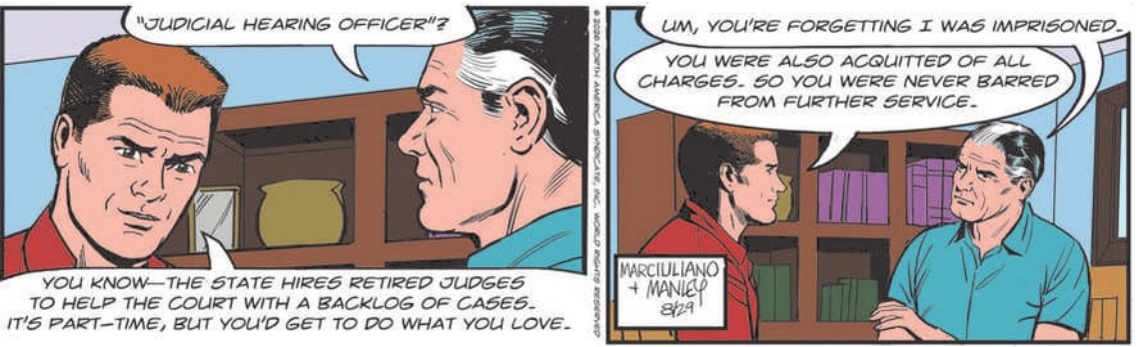
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HEART OF THE CITY



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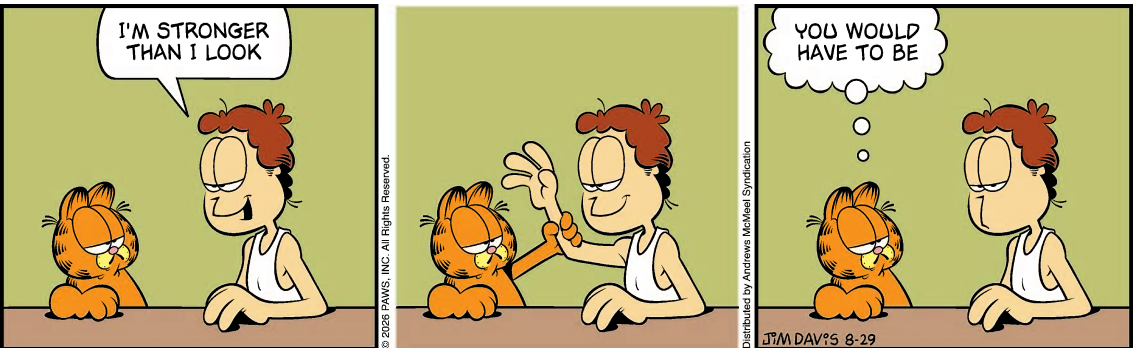
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SIX CHIX



GARFIELD



BARNEY AND CLYDE



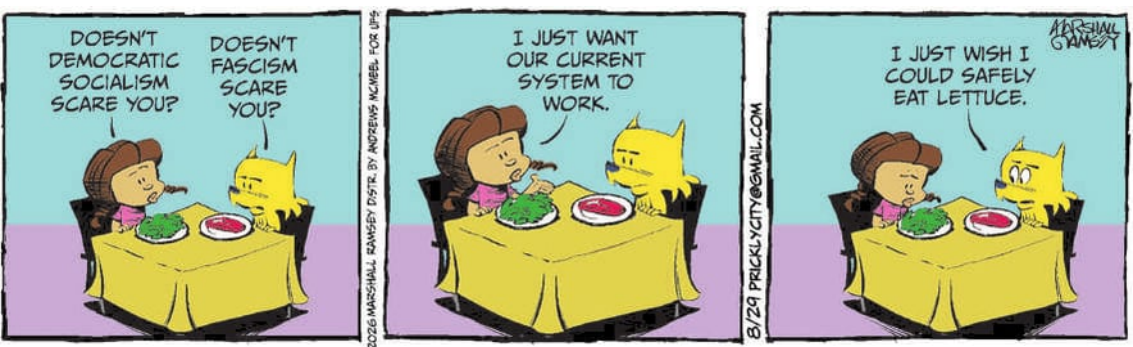
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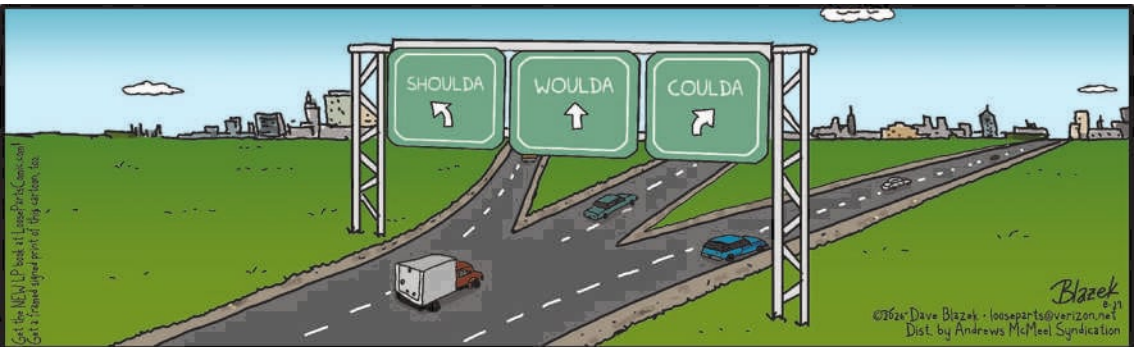
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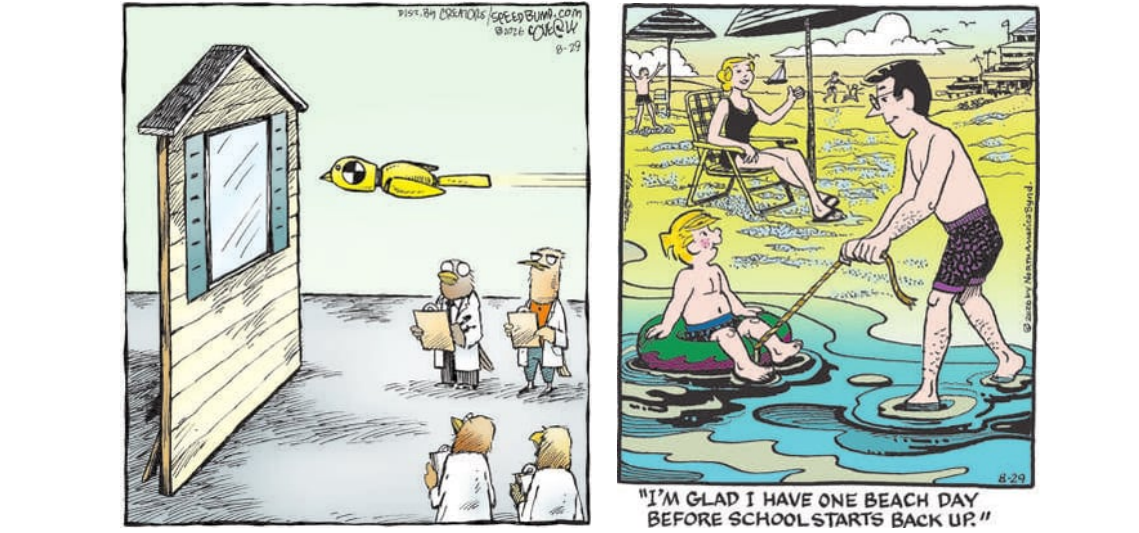
BABY BLUES



WALLACE THE BRAVE



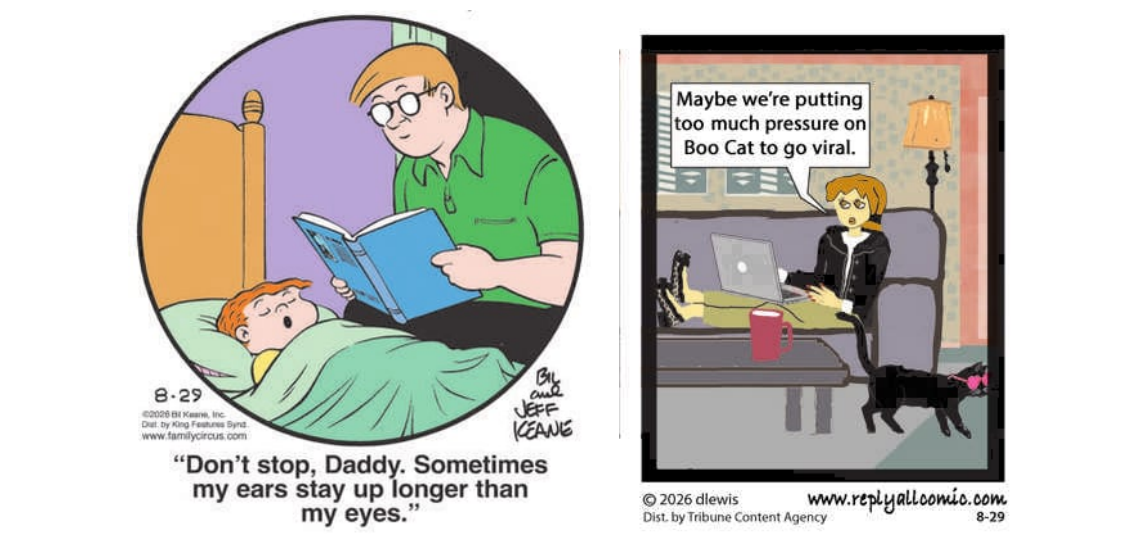
SPEED BUMP



ON THE FASTRACK



FAMILY CIRCUS



BEETLE BAILEY



REPLY ALL LITE



TELEVISION

8/29/26	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00
4.1 WRC (NBC)	• NASCAR Cup Series Coke Zero Sugar 400 (Live)								• NEWS..
4.2 WRC (IND)	Frasier	Frasier	Columbo		Columbo				Foxworthy
5.1 WTTG (Fox)	• MLB Baseball Boston Red Sox at New York Yankees (Live)					• Football Memphis at UNLV			
7.1 WJLA (ABC)	• Wheel	• College Football Alabama A&M vs. Howard (Live)					• News		
9.1 WUSA (CBS)	• Abich	• Abich	• Big Brother		• Georgie	• 48 Hours			
14.1 WFDC (UNI)	(6:30)	• Fútbol Mexicano Primera División			• Fútbol Mexicano América vs. Puebla (Live)			• Fútbol	
20.1 WDCA (MNTV)	• College Football North Carolina Central at Texas Southern (Live)					• Family	• Extra		
22.1 WMPT (PBS)	• Christina	• Indian	• Foyle's War			• American Experience			
26.1 WETA (PBS)	• The Essence of Eva			• The U.S. and the Holocaust			• Masters		
32.1 WHUT (PBS)	(6:30) • Movie: City of ...	• Here	• Here	• World on Fire		• Patience	• Origin		
50.1 WDCW (CW)	• College Football New Mexico State at Florida State (Live)					• News			
66.1 WPXW (ION)	(6:30) • NWSL Soccer	• NWSL.. / (:45) • NWSL Soccer			• NWSL..				• Law-SVU
A&E	Storage Wars		Storage Wars		Storage Wars		Storage Wars		Storage
AMC	Movie: Jaws ★★★★★ (1975) A man-eating shark terrorizes a New England resort town.					Movie: Jaws 2 ★★ (1978)			
Animal Planet	Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Jeff: RMV		Dr. Dee: Alaska Vet		Dr. Dee
BET	The Equalizer		The Equalizer		Movie: Set It Off ★★ (1996)				
Bravo	(5:30) Movie: Transformers: Age of Extinction ★★ (2014)				Movie: Jurassic World: Fallen Kingdom ★★ (2018) Owen and Claire try to save the dinosaurs from a volcano.				
Cartoon Network	Burgers	Family Guy	Family Guy		Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Rick Morty	Rick Morty
CNN	CNN Newsroom		Real Time With		CNN Special Program		CNN Special Program		Real Time
Comedy Central	(6:30) Movie: Step Brothers (2008)					Movie: Ted ★★ (2012)		Movie	
Discovery	Expedition X		Expedition X		Expedition X		Expedition X		Expedition
Disney	Movie: Camp Rock 3 (2026)		(:45) Kiff		(:10) Kiff		(:35) Kiff		Phineas X Phineas
E!	(6:30) Movie: The Help ★★ (2011)					Movie: The Help ★★ (2011)			
ESPN	College Football East Texas A&M at Mercer (Live)					Scoreboard (Live)		High School Football (Live)	
ESPN2	(6:00) High School Football DeSoto (TX) at St. Thomas Aquinas (FL) (Live)				College Football Prairie View A&M at Tarleton State (Live)				
Food Network	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners	Diners
Fox News	Weekend (Live)		Life, Liberty (Live)		My View With (Live)		Saturday Night (Live)		
Freeform	(5:40) Movie: M...	(:45) Movie: Monsters University ★★ (2013) At first rivals, Mike and Sulley became the best of pals.					(:15) Movie: The Garfield Movie ★★ (2024)		
FX	(4:30) Movie: B...	(6:00) Movie: Black Panther: Wakanda Forever ★★ (2022) Warriors must protect Wakanda from intervening world powers.							Movie: Avenger.
Hallmark	(6:00) Movie: Right in Front of Me (2021)		Movie: Much About Love (2026) (P)				Movie: Aussie at Heart (2026)		
Hallmark M&M	(6:00) Garage Sale Mysteries		Garage Sale Mysteries				Murder, She Wrote		Murder ...
HBO	(6:30) Movie: Stand by Me ★★ (1986)		Movie: Sicario ★★ (2015)				(:05) Lanterns		Conan O'Brien
HGTV	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters
History	History's Gr		History's Gr		Modern		(:05) Modern		
Lifetime	(6:00) Movie: Girl Who Survived: Alina Thom...		Movie: The Copycat Killer (2026) A criminal profiler investigates a copycat murder. (P)						
MASN	(6:00) FanDuel Racing (Live)		SportsWr...		O's Xtra		MLB Baseball		
Monumental	The Stanley Pup		Politics		Politics		Caps	Hometown	nba
MSNBC	The Weekend		Connect With		Crooked on MS NOW		The Rachel		
MTV	Movie: Harry Potter and the Goblet of Fire ★★ (2005)							Movie: Harry Potter ...	
Nat'l Geographic	To Catch a Smuggler		To Catch a Smuggler		Catch a Smuggler		Contraband Capture		Catch...
Nickelodeon	Movie: SpongeBob Movie: Sponge Out of Wat...					Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang
NWSN	Batya		NewsNation (Live)		NewsNation (Live)		NewsNation (Live)		
Paramount	Movie: Forrest Gump ★★ (1994) A slow-witted Southerner experiences 30 years of history.					Movie: Cast Away ★★ (2000)			
Paramount+Sho	(6:15) Movie: Body Cam (2020)		Movie: Gravity ★★ (2013)			Movie: Top Gun: Maverick ★★ (2022)			
Syfy	(5:30) Movie: The Matrix Revolutions ★★ (2003)			Movie: Renfield ★★ (2023) Dracula's aide, Renfield, seeks a new lease on life.			Movie: The Predator ★★ (2018)		
TBS	(5:45) Movie: Central I...		Movie: Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle (2017)				Movie: Jumanji: Welcome to the J...		
TCM	(6:00) Movie: Affair in Trinidad ★★ (1952)		Movie: Gilda ★★ (1946) A temptress pits her husband against her former lover.				Movie: Cover Girl ★★ (1944)		
TLC	Baylen Out Loud		1000-lb Roomies		1000-lb Sisters		1000-lb Sisters		1000-lb
TNT	(5:00) Movie: Wonder Woman ★★ (2017)		All Elite Wrestling: Collision					Collision Movie: San Andreas ★★ (2015)	
Travel	Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adv
truTV	Movie		Movie: The Lord of the Rings: The Two Towers ★★ (2002)						
TV Land	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	Seinfeld
TV One	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTimes	GoodTim...	GoodTim...	GoodTim...
USA Network	Chicago Fire		Chicago Fire		Chicago Fire		Chicago Fire		Pigeon
VH1	(6:00) Movie: 30 Minu...		Movie: Ace Ventura: Pet Detective (1994)						
WNCS	Abich	WorldNe...		20 / 20		WJLANe... WJLANews Attkisson			
LEGEND: ★ indicates new or live programs ♦ High Definition Movie Ratings (from TMS) ★★ Excellent ★★ Good ★★ Fair ★★ Poor No stars: not rated									

HOROSCOPE

BIRTHDAY | AUGUST 29: You're clever, independent, wise and often romantically involved with someone. You are always inquisitive. This is a slower paced year. Take time to rejuvenate your energy and your outlook. Focus on business and personal relationships, and make sure you hang out with people who are kind, helpful and have your back.

Moon Alert: Caution! Avoid shopping (except for food and gas) and important decisions all day today until 11 p.m. EDT. After that, the Moon moves from Pisces into Aries.

ARIES
(March 21-April 19)
Today you feel a strong need to relate to others. Your emotions are heightened with the Moon in your sign, which can make things a little tricky. You can be emotionally giving, but also emotionally demanding.

TAURUS
(April 20-May 20)
You might be tempted to withdraw from the demands of people and duties around you because you want to avoid something. Probably, you don't feel like socializing. You might want to explore the mystical side of your world. (You need some privacy.)

GEMINI
(May 21-June 20)
Today your contact with friends and members of groups is important. This is why you might feel more protective and supportive to someone. You might even feel a bit jealous if this person pays more attention to someone else.

CANCER
(June 21-July 22)
You're high-viz today, which means

people notice you more than usual. Keep this in mind in case you're tempt-ed to have a public argument with a loved one. (Hissing in loud whispers in an elevator?) Be aware that people seem to know details about your private life today.

LEO
(July 23-Aug. 22)
You want to shake things up today. You want some adventure! You need a change of scenery. Therefore, change your daily routine. Go somewhere you've never been before. This could be a minor thing, but at least it's fresh and new! This is what you hunger for.

VIRGO
(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)
Because your emotional experiences are more intense than usual, this might be reflected in your encounters with others. Perhaps it's because you feel possessive about something, or it could be related to memories from your past. You might want something that someone else has.

LIBRA
(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
Your attention will likely turn to your most personal relationships because you feel the need to express your feelings today. Because of this, if you have conflict with a spouse, partner or close friend, it will be more emotional. Guard against knee-jerk reactions.

SCORPIO
(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
You might have to put your own emotional considerations second to those of someone else today. Don't worry; you're not being a martyr. This is just what's happening. Meanwhile, take a moment to focus on your health

and what you might do to improve your it. Ideas?

SAGITTARIUS
(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
This is a lovely day for romance, socializing, enjoying a vacation and expanding your world through the theater, movies and the entertainment world. You also might feel protective and nurturing to children or a romantic partner.

CAPRICORN
(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)
This is the perfect day to retire by yourself somewhere and enjoy your own privacy. Make an effort to do this, even if for only a short time. Relax. Make some food that is a guilty pleasure. Read a book; watch TV; indulge yourself. You need it. Give yourself a mental health break.

AQUARIUS
(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)
Today you feel a strong need to talk to others because you have something you want to say. The key is you have to find someone who is willing to listen to you, genuinely and sincerely. In other words, you don't want to simply chat with someone about something inconsequential.

PISCES
(Feb. 19-March 20)
It's easy to identify with your possessions today, which is why you might feel more possessive than usual about something. For example, perhaps you don't want to lend something to someone. Check the Moon Alert before spending money today.

— Georgiia Nicols

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BRIDGE

N-S VULNERABLE
NORTH
♠ A J 3
♥ J 10 9 8 5
♦ 7 5 2
♣ 9 5

WEST
♠ Q 10 8 2
♥ 6 3
♦ Q 10 6 4
♣ J 7 6

EAST
♠ 6 5 4
♥ A K 7 4
♦ 9 8
♣ Q 10 8 2

SOUTH (D)
♠ K 9 7
♥ Q 2
♦ A K J 3
♣ A K 4 3

The bidding:
SOUTH 2 NT Pass 3 ♦ Pass
WEST Pass 3 NT All Pass
NORTH 3 ♥ Pass 3 NT All Pass
EAST All Pass
Opening lead — ♠ 2

Simple Saturday columns focus on basic technique and logical thinking.

"I took time to explain the word 'bargain' to my daughter, and she said it meant a great deal to her." — graffiti

Beware of bargains at the bridge table. In today's deal, West led the deuce of spades against 3NT, dummy followed with the three, East played the four and declarer bought the first trick for the bargain price of a seven. South next led the queen of hearts, winning, and a heart to dummy's jack. East took the king and led a club.

South won and had to reach dummy twice to set up and then cash the long hearts. He led the nine of spades, planning to play dummy's jack, but West alertly put up the queen. Then dummy's second entry vanished, and South couldn't use the hearts and won only eight tricks.

South needed to pay a fair price

for the first trick: He must win with the king. He can finesse with the jack later to get a necessary second entry to dummy and finish with an overtrick.

DAILY QUESTION
You hold:
♦ 6 5 4 ♥ A K 7 4
♦ 9 8 ♠ Q 10 8 2
Your partner opens one diamond. The next player bids one spade. What do you say?

ANSWER: Without the overcall, you would have responded one heart, but you have too few hearts and too few points to bid two hearts. Your best call is a negative double, which by agreement shows enough strength to respond, with a heart suit plus diamond tolerance or clubs. If your partner bids two hearts next, pass.

— Frank Stewart

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SUDOKU

Complete the grid so that every row, column and 3x3 box contains every digit from 1 to 9 inclusively.

				8	4	9	6	
8	9						1	
		1		9		3		
		3		7	1			2
				4				
7			6	3		1		
		7		2		5		
3						7	9	
4	5	9	6					

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★★

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PREVIOUS SUDOKU SOLUTION

3	1	7	9	8	4	5	6	2
9	4	2	7	6	5	3	1	8
8	6	5	3	2	1	7	9	4
4	2	6	5	7	9	1	8	3
5	8	9	1	3	6	2	4	7
1	7	3	2	4	8	9	5	6
2	5	4	8	1	7	6	3	9
6	3	1	4	9	2	8	7	5
7	9	8	6	5	3	4	2	1

SCRABBLEGRAMS

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A

I

E

Y

S

T

C

RACK 1

A

E

I

S

S

K

C

Double Word Score

E

I

O

O

Y

L

B

RACK 3

A

E

I

M

S

T

H

3rd Letter Triple

A

E

I

M

S

T

H

RACK 4

PAR SCORE 155-165

BEST SCORE 219

FOUR RACK TOTAL

TIME LIMIT: 20 MIN

DIRECTIONS: Make a 2- to 7-letter word from the letters in each row. Add points of each word, using scoring directions at right. Finally, 7-letter words get 50-point bonus. "Blanks" used as any letter have no point value. All the words are in the Official SCRABBLE® Players Dictionary, 5th Edition. SOLUTION TOMORROW

For more information on tournaments and clubs, email NASPA - North American SCRABBLE Players Association info@scrabbleplayers.org. Visit our website - www.scrabbleplayers.org. For puzzle inquiries contact scrgrams@gmail.com

08-29

JUMBLECROSSWORDS

by David L. Hoyt

8-29-26

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

CLUE

ACROSS

ANSWER

1. show

Postage

White

Hardship

CLUE

DOWN

ANSWER

1. paper

jacket

Roman god of the sea

Reveal

CLUE: It contains calcium

CLUE: Significant event



Quarterback Sam Hartman, vying for the backup role with Marcus Mariota ailing, was one of the Commanders on the roster bubble who played Friday in Baltimore.

STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/AP

Almost there ...

BY TASHAN REED

In their preseason finale, the Washington Commanders fell, 41-3, to the Baltimore Ravens on Friday at M&T Bank Stadium — not that the listless performance particularly mattered.

The Commanders rested 41 players, including all of their starters and many key backups. The most significant players who suited up were centers Matt Gulbin and Julian Good-Jones, who are competing for the backup job behind Nick Allegretti.

The cautious strategy was nothing new. While various key contributors on Washington's first-team defense got notable reps in the first two preseason games, the front-line offense hardly saw the field Friday. Quarterback Jayden Daniels and the rest of the starters played just three snaps against the Detroit Lions in the second week of the

RAVENS 41, COMMANDERS 3

Dozens rest in preseason finale ahead of roster cutdown

preseason.

Coach Dan Quinn focused on using the joint practices against the Lions and Ravens to simulate gamelike situations rather than put his starters at additional risk of injury. Given how beat-up the team is right now, it's hard to argue with that approach.

The Commanders have until 4 p.m. Sunday to trim their roster to 53 players. Once the period to claim players from the waiver wire passes at 1 p.m. Monday, they will be able to sign up to 16 players to their

practice squad. They could also have access to a 17th spot to keep defensive end T.J. Maguranyanga through the international player pathway program.

Here's my final roster projection:

Offense (26)

Quarterback (3)

Starter: Jayden Daniels

Backups: Marcus Mariota, Athan Kalia-manis

Cut: Sam Hartman

Running back (4)

Starter: Jacory Croskey-Merritt

Backup: Rachaad White, Kaytron Allen, SEE COMMANDERS ON B9

Week 1: Commanders at Eagles

Sunday, Sept. 13, 4:25 p.m., Fox

Davis's comeback narrative casts a dark shadow

BY EDDIE PELLIS,
JIM MUSTIAN
AND JOSHUA GOODMAN
Associated Press

CHARLOTTE — Nobody could overlook the off-the-field community work — bankrolling a college scholarship endowment, a Thanksgiving food drive, a Christmastime gift giveaway — that cast Thomas Davis of the Carolina Panthers as one of the true good guys around this city and across the NFL.

But what really turned Davis into

Ex-Panthers linebacker, who overcame three ACL tears, battled opioid addiction

royalty in North Carolina was how tough he was. A legend was born when the linebacker who had already made a historic comeback after tearing an ACL in the same knee three times — and seemed to get better each time he returned — suited

up and played in Super Bowl 50 despite a freshly broken arm.

Turns out, all those comebacks from all that pain took their toll and led to a deeper and more troubling story: As his career wound down, Davis became dependent on opioids, an addiction he blames for the unseemly breakup with his wife, Kelly, and the sully of his once-pristine reputation.

The Associated Press found that prescriptions filled to feed Davis's addiction led to the downfall of Joan Rubinger, a

SEE DAVIS ON B9

For United, progress is difficult to measure

D.C. is much improved but 'still struggling,' according to Weiler

BY BAILEY JOHNSON

It is undeniable that D.C. United has improved in 2026.

Last year, the club finished last among the 30 MLS teams with a 5-18-11 record and just 26 points. This year, United has 24 points through its first 21 games. There should be little question that, with 13 matches remaining, D.C. will be able to finish with more points than it did last season.

But it is also undeniable that, despite the steps forward, there's still a large gap between United and the true playoff contenders. The MLS postseason format changes often, but even as the league continues to expand the field, United hasn't qualified since 2019. This year, the team is tied for the Eastern Conference's ninth and final playoff spot but on the outside looking in because of the tiebreaker (wins).

"It's so difficult to win games for us this season," Coach René Weiler said ahead of Los Angeles FC's visit to Audi Field on Saturday night. United has lost its past two games and has just one win in its past 10, dating back to early May.

"Of course, we want to have better results," Weiler added. "Maybe we need a little bit more time. Maybe we need to be a little bit more composure. I'm mostly satisfied with the team's

SEE UNITED ON B11

Los Angeles FC at D.C. United
7:30 p.m., Apple TV

Titanic shot from House helps Kent get first win

NATIONALS 9, MARLINS 2

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Brady House hit a three-run homer, left-hander Jackson Kent threw seven innings of one-run ball to pick up his first MLB win, and the Washington Nationals beat the Miami Marlins, 9-2, on Friday night at Nationals Park to earn back-to-back wins for the first time in nearly three weeks.

Washington (64-73) scored five runs with two outs in the third after Miami starter Eury Pérez walked the first three batters on just 14 pitches. The Nationals scored two runs on a wild pitch to take a 2-1 lead, and House hit his 10th homer of the season 4:45 feet.

The Nationals added four runs in the seventh. Harry Ford hit his third home run of the season over the wall in left-center field for a 6-1 lead. Dylan Crews hit a double into the left-field corner to score two more and reach base for the eighth consecutive game.

Daylen Lile tripped over the center fielder to score another run, his sixth triple of the season.

Washington snapped an eight-game losing streak in the series with the Marlins. The Nationals had scored just 15 runs over their past seven games against Miami.

Kent (1-2), who faced the Marlins (68-67) for the second straight start, got through five innings for the first time in his career. He threw 106 pitches and allowed only three hits and four walks.

Pérez (7-10) allowed five earned runs in three innings.

Miami's Heriberto Hernández hit his fifth homer in nine games against the Nationals this season. The Marlins have lost three of four and trail the San Diego Padres (72-63) by four games for the final National League wild card.

Marlins at Nationals
4:05 p.m., Nationals.TV

Contesting in Cali

Mystics center Shakira Austin, center, puts up a shot against Sparks forwards Cameron Brink, left, and Dearica Hamby in the first quarter of Friday night's game at Crypto.com Arena in Los Angeles.

Washington was looking to improve its playoff position and go 4-0 on its western road trip before the WNBA goes on hiatus for the FIBA Women's World Cup. The game ended too late for this edition; for coverage, visit [postsports.com](https://www.washingtonpost.com/sports/wnba).



LUKE HALES/GETTY IMAGES

THE DAY IN SPORTS

HOCKEY

Avalanche inks Makar to a record extension

Cale Makar and the Colorado Avalanche agreed to an eight-year, \$163.2 million extension Friday that will make him the highest paid player in NHL history.

The terms of the deal were confirmed by his agency, Bartlett Hockey.

Makar's extension is set to be the richest in league history, surpassing the eight-year, \$136 million extension signed by Minnesota Wild forward **Kirill Kaprizov** last September. Makar's deal runs through the 2034-35 season.

With an average annual value of \$20.4 million that begins in 2027-28, Makar's contract also eclipses that of San Jose Sharks superstar **Macklin Celebrini**, who signed a five-year, \$94 million extension in late July that has an \$18.8 million AAV.

The 27-year-old Makar is coming off a season in which he had 20 goals and 59 assists. He finished second to **Zach Werenski** of the Columbus Blue Jackets in the Norris Trophy voting, an award that goes to the league's top defenseman. Makar has won the award twice in his career.

GOLF

Gerard, Hovland even at Tour Championship

Ryan Gerard hit it well enough to card five relatively easy birdies and dropped a surprise from just inside 80 feet for another, giving him a 5-under-par 65 and a share of the 36-hole lead with **Viktor Hovland** at the PGA Tour's season-ending Tour Championship in Atlanta.

Hovland had one of five birdies on the peninsula-green 15th hole, a par-3 at only 155 yards but tucked to the left near a sharp slope that feeds off the putting surface. He had a 66 to join Gerard at 10-under 130 going into the weekend.

Right behind? Just about everybody.

That includes **Scottie Scheffler**, the world's No. 1 player who had a 67 and was two back. And it included **Cameron Young**, in last place after the first round and atop the leaderboard for much of the day after a 62. He also wound up two behind.

Collin Morikawa and **Chris Gotterup** each shot 67 and were one behind at 9-under 131. ...

Miyu Yamashita was back on top of an LPGA Tour leaderboard days after tying the tour's 72-hole scoring record in a nine-stroke victory in Canada.

The diminutive Japanese star shot a 2-under 70 at TPC Boston for a share of the lead in the FM Championship with **Hyo Joo Kim** and U.S. Solheim Cup qualifier **Allisen Corpuz**.

PRO BASKETBALL

Clark and Mitchell lead charge for Fever again

Caitlin Clark and **Kelsey Mitchell** each scored 34 points as the Indiana Fever got past the Connecticut Sun, 111-91, in Indianapolis.

The pair scored 30 or more points for the fourth game this season, extending their WNBA single-season record for a duo. Mitchell had her 24th straight 20-point game in the Fever's final game before the FIBA Women's World Cup break. ...

Carla Leite scored 26 points, **Emily Engstler** added a career-high 25, and the visiting Portland Fire routed Atlanta, 101-83, ending the Dream's four-game winning streak.

Angel Reese had 16 points and 16 rebounds for Atlanta (25-14), which fell into fifth place in the standings, one-half game behind Indiana. Reese, who has already set the league record for rebounds in a season, matched a WNBA record with her 28th double-double of the year.

COLLEGES

Florida gives Golden another new contract

Florida men's basketball coach **Todd Golden** signed his third extension in three years, raising his average annual salary to \$8.25 million and making him the highest-paid coach in school history, according to multiple reports.

The new deal, now six years at \$49.5 million through the 2031-32 season, boosted Golden's yearly average by \$2.25 million, per reports. He got a raise from \$6 million to \$7.5 million for this coming season. ...

The Big Ten announced the expansion of its player availability



BRIAN SNYDER/REUTERS

It's all a big racket

Former doubles star Bob Bryan takes part in the celebrity pro classic at the tennis Hall of Fame in Newport, Rhode Island.

SPOTLIGHT: COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Sandusky accuser seeks to recant allegations

BY ED WHITE

A judge granted a hearing to explore claims that a man wants to recant allegations of sexual abuse by then-Penn State assistant football coach Jerry Sandusky.

Sandusky, 82, has been serving a decades-long prison sentence since he was convicted of 45 counts of sexual abuse in 2012. Eight young men testified about what happened to them as boys. He has repeatedly lost efforts to get a new trial, but Sandusky's lawyers are trying again.

A man identified in court documents as R.R. said he was coached extensively by authorities.

"I was told — both directly and indirectly — that trauma may have fragmented my memory, and that I could safely affirm details I did not fully recall. I was assured this was common and even expected," R.R. said in an affidavit filed by Sandusky's attorneys.

A court hearing in Centre County has

One of eight who testified against ex-Penn State assistant says authorities coached him

been scheduled for Sept. 8.

R.R.'s allegations were "based on suggestive leading questioning, prosecutorial coercion and influence, confirmatory bias and memory manipulation, which permeated throughout each of the accusers as well," Sandusky's attorneys said in a court filing.

The Pennsylvania Office of Attorney General said Friday that R.R.'s recantation is "highly suspect."

Sandusky coached the defense at one of the country's top football programs under Hall of Fame coach Joe Paterno. The scandal led to Paterno's firing, and the university paid more than \$100 million to

people who said they had been abused by Sandusky.

Jules Epstein, a professor at Temple University law school in Philadelphia, said Sandusky would not automatically get a new trial, even if the judge believes the recantation is valid. He said a judge would need to determine how R.R.'s testimony fit into the broader case, which had many charges and victims.

Authorities said Sandusky found and groomed boys at The Second Mile, a charity that he started for at-risk youth. He has repeatedly declared his innocence.

At trial, R.R. was 25 years old. He testified that he was 11 when Sandusky performed oral sex in the coach's basement in 1998, a transcript shows.

"He told me that if I told anybody that I would never see my family again," said R.R., who was in foster care at the time.

Sandusky later apologized and said "he loved me," R.R. testified.

— Associated Press

TELEVISION AND RADIO

MLB	
1 p.m.	Game 1: Boston at New York Yankees » MLB Network
4 p.m.	Colorado at Atlanta » MLB Network
4:05 p.m.	Miami at Washington » Nationals.TV, WJFK (106.7 FM)
7:15 p.m.	Game 2: Boston at New York Yankees » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)
10 p.m.	Philadelphia at Los Angeles Angels » MLB Network
10:05 p.m.	Baltimore at Athletics » MASN, WYFV (97.9 FM), WSNB (630 AM)

WNBA	
1 p.m.	Chicago at New York » WUSA (Ch. 9), WJZ (Ch. 13)
NFL PRESEASON	
1 p.m.	Detroit at Indianapolis » NFL Network
6 p.m.	Chicago at Tennessee » NFL Network

COLLEGE FOOTBALL	
Noon	North Carolina vs. TCU » ESPN
3 p.m.	San José State at USC » WRC (Ch. 4), WBAL (Ch. 11)
3 p.m.	Southern vs. Alabama State » ESPNU
3:30 p.m.	North Carolina State at Virginia » ESPN, WSNB (630 AM)
5:30 p.m.	Jacksonville State at North Dakota State » CBS Sports Network
7 p.m.	New Mexico State at Florida State » WDCW (Ch. 50), WNUV (Ch. 54)
7 p.m.	East Texas A&M at Mercer » ESPN
7 p.m.	Hawaii at Stanford » ACC Network
7:30 p.m.	Alabama A&M vs. Howard » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)
9 p.m.	Prairie View A&M at Tarleton State » ESPN2
10 p.m.	Memphis at UNLV » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)

AUTO RACING	
9 a.m.	Indy NXT at Milwaukee Mile, practice » Fox Sports 2
11 a.m.	IndyCar: Snap-On Makers and Fixers 250, qualifying » Fox Sports 1
12:30 p.m.	Indy NXT at Milwaukee Mile, qualifying » Fox Sports 1
2:30 p.m.	IndyCar: Snap-On Makers and Fixers 250, first race » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)
7:30 p.m.	NASCAR Cup Series: Coke Zero Sugar 400 » WRC (Ch. 4), WBAL (Ch. 11)

GOLF	
7 a.m.	DP World Tour: British Masters, third round » Golf Channel
1 p.m.	PGA Tour: Tour Championship, third round » Golf Channel
3 p.m.	PGA Tour: Tour Championship, third round » WUSA (Ch. 9), WJZ (Ch. 13)
3 p.m.	LPGA Tour: FM Championship, third round » Golf Channel

SOCCER	
7:30 a.m.	English Premier League: Nottingham Forest at Liverpool » USA Network
7:30 a.m.	English League Championship: Stoke City at Wolverhampton » CBS Sports Network

10 a.m.	English Premier League: Hull City at Coventry City » USA Network
10 a.m.	English League Championship: Sheffield United at Cardiff City » CBS Sports Network
11:15 a.m.	French Ligue 1: Lens at Strasbourg » BeIN Sports
12:30 p.m.	English Premier League: Newcastle at Tottenham » WRC (Ch. 4), WBAL (Ch. 11)
12:30 p.m.	German Bundesliga: Hamburger SV at Borussia Dortmund » USA Network
12:30 p.m.	Italian Serie A: Frosinone at Fiorentina » CBS Sports Network
1 p.m.	Portuguese Primeira Liga: Porto at Académico de Viseu » BeIN Sports
2:45 p.m.	French Ligue 1: Le Havre at Lyonnnais » BeIN Sports
6:30 p.m.	WNSL: North Carolina at Kansas City » Ion
7:30 p.m.	MLS: Los Angeles FC at D.C. United » Apple TV
8:45 p.m.	WNSL: Chicago at Denver » Ion
11 p.m.	Mexican Liga MX: Tigres UANL at Santos Laguna » CBS Sports Network

TENNIS	
4 p.m.	ATP: Winston-Salem Open, final » Tennis Channel
6 p.m.	Hall of Fame induction » Tennis Channel
7:30 p.m.	WTA: Monterrey Open, final » Tennis Channel

PROFESSIONAL SOFTBALL	
8 p.m.	Athletes Unlimited All-Star Cup: Team Flippen vs. Team Kilfoyl » MLB Network

HORSE RACING	
5 p.m.	Travers Stakes (post time 6:35 p.m.) » WTTG (Ch. 5), WBFF (Ch. 45)

WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL	
2 p.m.	Miami at Michigan » Big Ten Network
3 p.m.	Arizona State vs. USC » Fox Sports 1
4 p.m.	Connecticut at Penn State » Big Ten Network
5 p.m.	Creighton vs. Minnesota » Fox Sports 1
8 p.m.	Nebraska vs. UNLV » Fox Sports 1
10 p.m.	TCU vs. Texas » Fox Sports 1

HIGH SCHOOL FOOTBALL	
2 p.m.	Bishop Gorman (Nev.) vs. Christopher Columbus (Fla.) » ESPN2
6 p.m.	DeSoto (Texas) at St. Thomas Aquinas (Fla.) » ESPN2
10:30 p.m.	Chandler (Ariz.) at Basha (Ariz.) » ESPN

LITTLE LEAGUE BASEBALL WORLD SERIES	
12:30 p.m.	International Championship: Japan vs. Curaçao » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)
3:30 p.m.	U.S. Championship: Ohio vs. Nevada » WJLA (Ch. 7), WMAR (Ch. 2)

SOCCER

Amorim's Milan draws English foes in Europa

AC Milan and new coach **Ruben Amorim** will play two English opponents in the Europa League after being drawn to host Sunderland and play at Bournemouth.

Milan also will host Benfica —

the team it beat in the 1990 European Cup final — at San Siro in the eight-game league phase.

Juventus was drawn against two Spanish opponents, Real Sociedad and Celta Vigo, and will travel to a neutral venue to play Hapoel Beer-Sheva of Israel.

Crystal Palace, which won the third-tier Conference League last season, finally gets to play in the Europa League one year after its

entry was blocked by UEFA because it shared ownership links with Lyon through United States businessman **John Textor**. Lyon will host Palace in the competition after Textor cut ties with the French club.

Bayer Leverkusen, which lost the 2024 final after going unbeaten in both the German league and Europa League until then, was drawn to face French teams Marseille and Lyon. ...

Ajax will play at Atalanta in the marquee fixture of the Conference League after the 36-team draw paired two clubs who were in the Champions League last season.

Former Liverpool star **Mohamed Salah** also dropped down to the third-tier competition with his new club Trabzonspor, which will host Freiburg, Heart of Midlothian and Jablonec in Turkey. ...

Eintracht Frankfurt signed up-and-coming German goalkeeper **Noah Atubolu** from Freiburg on a season-long loan as the Bundesliga season got underway. ...

The Colorado Rapids traded forward **Dante Sealy** back to CF Montreal in exchange for up to \$1.7 million in general allocation money. ...

Vancouver Whitecaps defender **Tate Johnson** signed a contract extension through the 2029-30 MLS season. ...

Rayan Cherki scored two goals in five minutes, and **Erling Haaland** also got a brace as Manchester City won at Crystal Palace, 4-1, in London to maintain its perfect start to the English Premier League season.

Elsewhere in Europe, Bayern Munich got the Bundesliga off to an impressive start with a 5-1 home win over Stuttgart, while defending French league champion Paris Saint-Germain needed two goals in stoppage time to salvage a 2-2 draw at Lille.

AUTO RACING

Eliminated Chastain claims pole at Daytona

Ross Chastain took the pole for NASCAR's regular season finale at Daytona International Speedway.

Chastain covered the 2¼-mile superspeedway in Daytona Beach, Florida, in 48.808 seconds, five-hundredths of a second faster than **Chris Buescher** in the second and final round of qualifying.

Chastain, who already has been eliminated from playoff contention, and Buescher will share the front row in the Coke Zero Sugar 400 on Saturday night. Buescher is already locked into the 16-car postseason field.

Austin Hill qualified third, followed by **Ryan Preece** and **Riley Herbst**. **Shane van Gisbergen**, **Connor Zilisch**, **Austin Cindric**, **Joey Logano** and **Kyle Larson** rounded out the top 10 starting spots.

TENNIS

Buse, Fery will face off in Winston-Salem final

Third-seeded **Ignacio Buse** and fourth-seeded **Arthur Fery** advanced in distinct fashions and will meet in Saturday's final at the Winston-Salem (North Carolina) Open.

Buse, a 22-year-old from Peru, edged France's **Benjamin Bonzi**, 6-2, 4-6, 6-1, while Fery advanced when Australia's **James Duckworth** had to retire in the second set. Fery led 6-4, 1-2 when Duckworth could not continue because of an apparent right leg injury.

Both Buse, the No. 32 seed at the upcoming U.S. Open, and Fery will head to New York after the title match in Winston-Salem. ...

Frenchwoman **Diane Parry** upset fifth-seeded American **Ann Li**, 7-6 (9-7), 6-4, to advance to the final of the Monterrey (Mexico) Open.

CYCLING

Norway's Leknessund takes Stage 7 of Vuelta

An emotional **Andreas Leknessund** broke down in tears after claiming Stage 7 of the Spanish Vuelta just hours after the death of Norway's **King Harald V**.

Leknessund conquered the grueling 150-kilometer (93-mile) mountain route in Aramón Valdelinares in nearly four hours. Teammate **Tobias Halland Johannessen** was second, 34 seconds back, and **Wout van Aert** rounded out the podium, trailing by 47 seconds.

Overall leader **Tadej Pogacar** finished 19th, 4:23 behind Leknessund. That effort proved more than enough to retain the red jersey.

— From news services

PRO FOOTBALL

Cuts are coming after Commanders get crushed

COMMANDERS FROM B7

Jeremy McNichols
Cut: Robert Henry Jr., Craig Reynolds

Wide receiver (6)
Starters: Terry McLaurin, Stefon Diggs, Luke McCaffrey
Backups: Antonio Williams, Jaylin Lane, Dyami Brown
Cut: Treyton Burks, Jaden Bradley, Van Jefferson, Jacoby Jones, Nick Nash

Tight end (4)
Starter: Chig Okonkwo
Backups: John Bates, Ben Sinnott, Colson Yankoff
Cut: Lawrence Cager, Tre McKitty, Quentin Moore

Offensive line (9)
Starters: Brandon Coleman, Chris Paul, Nick Allegretti, Sam Cosmi, Josh Conerly
Backups: Andrew Wylie, D.J. Humphries, Trent Scott, Matt Gulbin
Injured reserve: Laremy Tunsil (torn triceps)
Cut: Julian Good-Jones, Daniel Brunskill Foster Sarell, Max Scharping, Nicholas Petit-Frere, Tanoa Togiai, Trey Hill

All eyes are on center. Allegretti is still sidelined with a calf strain, and the uncertainty around when he'll be ready to return has bred plenty of anxiety among the fan base.

It's a two-man race between Gulbin and Good-Jones to determine who will back him up. Gulbin served as the starting center while Good-Jones rotated at right guard during Wednesday's joint practice against the Ravens. That seemed to indicate Gulbin was ahead in the race, but neither he nor Good-Jones performed well in that session.

The preseason finale provided another opportunity for someone to pull ahead as Gulbin got the start. Ultimately, I decided to give the rookie the nod. I still would expect General Manager Adam Peters to explore an addition on the waiver wire.

At quarterback, Kaliakmanis breaks through to make the roster. He has shown progress, and it could be too risky to subject him to the waiver wire. The Commanders hope Mariota will be ready to return from his MCL sprain by Week 1, but that's not guaranteed. If he's unable to go, Kaliakmanis — who was 7 for 13 passing for 45 yards Friday — would be the backup.

Wide receiver is another position in which I've gone back and forth, but I'm going to stick with Brown. He has been the better player to close out training camp, and he provides the room with some more experience.



STEPHANIE SCARBROUGH/AP

Qwuantrezz Knight, right, is fighting for a spot in a crowded Commanders safety room. The team will finalize its roster by 4 p.m. Sunday.

Defense (24)

Defensive tackle (4)
Starters: Daron Payne, Javon Kinlaw
Backups: Tim Settle, Ricky Barber
Cut: Shy Tuttle, Maurice Hurst II, Byron Cowart, Jeffrey M'ba
Injured reserve: Jer'Zhan Newton (torn pectoral)

Defensive end (1)
Starter: Charles Omenihu
Backup: N/A
Cut: D.J. Johnson, T.J. Maguranyanga
Reserve/suspended list: Dorance Armstrong
Physically unable to perform list: Deatrich Wise (torn quad)

Outside linebacker (4)
Starter: Odafe Oweh

Backups: K'Lavon Chaisson, Joshua Josephs, Javontae Jean-Baptiste
Cut: Boogie Basham

Inside linebacker (5)
Starters: Sonny Styles, Frankie Luvu
Backups: Leo Chenal, Jordan Magee, Ale Kaho
Cut: Kain Medrano, Curtis Jacobs, Kry's Barnes

Cornerback (5)
Starters: Trey Amos, Amik Robertson, Mike Sainristil
Backups: Rasul Douglas, Antonio Hamilton Sr.
Cut: Fabian Moreau, Darius Rush, Fred Davis II, Car'lin Vigers

Safety (5)
Starters: Nick Cross, Jeremy Reaves

Backups: Quan Martin, Tyler Owens, Percy Butler
Cut: Joshua Bledsoe, Quindell Johnson, Qwuantrezz Knight

Wise is still rehabbing from the torn quad he suffered last September, and it seems unlikely that he will return from the PUP list before the start of the season. If he remains on that list on roster cut day, he will have to miss at least the first four games.

"He had a good evaluation recently. He's certainly getting closer, but they haven't given us a time frame," Quinn said Monday. "He looks good. I'm pleased with the work that he's put in. For him, this has been a long rehab. It's a serious injury. To see him on the other side of that, knowing the light at the end of the tunnel is nearby, that's exciting."

With Armstrong also set to miss Week 1 because of a suspension for a violation of the NFL's personal conduct policy, the defensive end group will be thin against the Philadelphia Eagles on Sept. 13. That probably will lead to more playing time for players such as Josephs and Jean-Baptiste.

Special teams (3)

Kicker: Drew Stevens
Punter: Tress Way
Long snapper: Tyler Ott

There's no suspense here in terms of who makes the roster, but it will be interesting to see how Stevens (who converted from 39 yards and missed from 62 on Friday) performs early in the season. If the rookie struggles, the Commanders may have to seek outside help.

Addiction was part of Davis's tale of resilience

DAVIS FROM B7

self-styled healer who listed Davis among her dozens of high-profile pro-athlete clients who swore by her pain-relief miracles.

"I live my life in a way that I wanted my kids to always be proud of me," said Davis, a father of four, in a recent episode of The Pivot Podcast, where he discussed his drug problem publicly for the first time. "That was something that was extremely important to me. And some of the things that happened, it made it extremely hard for them to ever be proud of the man that I had started to become."

Davis did not respond to several calls and texts from the AP, and no one answered his door in North Carolina when visited by an AP reporter. Requests for comment were also made through his representatives.

A sturdy presence

The high point of Davis's career might have been 2014 — the season he was honored as the NFL's Walter Payton man of the year. The award, which comes with a trophy and a patch the player wears on his uniform for the rest of his career, recognizes the winner for his "community service, charity work and good play on the field."

There was plenty of good play. A college all-American at Georgia, Davis might have been voted to more than three NFL Pro Bowls and named to more than one all-pro team had he played in a



CARY EDMONDSON/USA TODAY SPORTS

Former Carolina LB Thomas Davis overcame three ACL tears in his right knee and played in Super Bowl 50, above, with a broken arm.

bigger market — or maybe not shared the limelight with Luke Kuechly, the linebacker who was inducted into the Pro Football Hall of Fame earlier this month and name-checked his good buddy, Davis, as part of his induction speech.

"I couldn't have asked for a better person to start my playing career than next to Thomas," Kuechly said. "He taught me about effort, toughness, competitiveness, and most of all, having joined the game of football."

But Davis never lacked for accolades in the town where he played the first 14 of his 16 NFL seasons.

He played nine of those years after his third knee surgery. All his best seasons came during that stretch.

Off the field, he was a constant presence at charity events, many of which he sponsored. Davis, his wife and kids painted the picture of a family that had deep, meaningful connections to the heartbeat of this burgeoning southern metropolis in NASCAR country that, like so many cities, places its sports stars on a pedestal.

All of this fit into Davis's wider life story.

Raised in a one-parent house in Shellman — a rural farming town in southwest Georgia — his mother moved 40 miles away to Eufala, Alabama, for a higher-paying job when Davis was in 11th grade to help pay the bills.

Davis stayed behind and moved in with an older cousin so he could keep playing at Randolph-Clay High in nearby Cuthbert, where, he said, he had carved out his niche on the football field as "The Man."

"My mom allowed me, in that moment, to say, 'Hey, I'm establishing myself,'" Davis said. "I had a goal. She had trust in me that I was going to make the right decisions."

A comeback story

For more than a decade, he did. The multiple comebacks from knee surgeries — he's believed to be the first and only NFL player to play on after tearing the same ACL three times — made him larger than life in North Carolina.

"I didn't want to be that token,

like, mascot for ACL recoveries," Davis said. "I wanted to be the person that came back and showed every NFL club that you don't have to give up on your players when they face injuries."

His first-team all-pro honor (2015), three Pro Bowls (2015-17) and that larger-than-life trip to the Super Bowl (2016) all came after the knee surgeries.

"The guy has been through a lot and is the heart and soul of our team," teammate Dwan Edwards said in the lead-up to Carolina's 24-10 loss to the Denver Broncos in Super Bowl 50. "He's our emotional leader, our playmaker on the field."

The first crack in this storybook tale came in 2018 when Davis was handed a four-game ban for violating the NFL's performance-enhancer policy after testing positive for a banned estrogen blocker, the likes of which can be used to mask steroid use. He said he didn't cheat, had been using the same supplements as always, but did not protest the ban.

Davis said the ban caused him to rethink his plans to retire. He spent 2019 with the Los Angeles Chargers and 2020 with the Washington Football Team. That year, Washington's head trainer was found to have been illegally distributing oxycodone to players — an unsettling reminder of the NFL's difficult history with painkillers.

The league spent nearly 10 years defending a lawsuit accusing its teams of overprescribing opioids and other painkillers. The lawsuit was eventually dismissed in 2023 because of what a judge said was its overly sprawling nature.

One of the revelations that came out during that period was a study of former players, 52 percent of whom said they had used prescription opioids during their career.

The NFL Players Association did not want to comment on this story. The league, which has

enhanced its monitoring of prescriptions since the lawsuit, said it was unaware of Rubinger. It referenced a study from 2021-22 that showed only 10 percent of players received prescriptions for opioids.

The downfall

In 2022, the Drug Enforcement Administration opened its investigation after Kelly Davis accused Rubinger, the "pain doctor," of fueling her husband's opioid addiction. Authorities said Davis received more than 13,000 pills of oxycodone and Percocet from November 2019 through March 2024.

"She preyed on these guys' pain," Kelly Davis told the AP. "They had money, they had injuries, they had mental health issues."

Davis's addiction casts a different light on the couple's separation, their eventual divorce and the mini-scandal that erupted when news broke of Kelly Davis's 2025 arrest for assaulting a woman she believed was sleeping with her husband.

These days, Davis is still a presence around the Panthers facility, where the memories of all the good he did for the team and the community live on.

But, he concedes, he has been chastened by his stunning downfall. Davis said he has gotten the help he needs, and that his focus is on trying to make things right with his children — one of whom, Thomas Davis Jr., is a freshman linebacker at Notre Dame. Davis Sr. says he places blame on nobody but himself, but he is well aware of the toll drugs took.

"I take full ownership of every single component of everything that's happened in my life," he said. "But at the end of the day, I know there were some factors that took place that ultimately led me to a space that I didn't anticipate being [in]."

Steve Reed contributed to this report.

NOTES

Romo faces three more citations after arrest

FROM NEWS SERVICES

Tony Romo is facing three more citations in connection with his arrest last month that got him placed on leave from his role as the lead NFL analyst on CBS.

Romo was arrested July 23 in Wisconsin on suspicion of operating a vehicle while under the influence.

The case against the former Dallas Cowboys quarterback was amended Thursday to add citations for possessing open intoxicants in a motor vehicle, unsafe passing on the right and first-offense operating while intoxicated. He already had received a citation for refusal to take a test for intoxication after arrest.

CBS Sports President David Berson said earlier this month that he does not have a timeline for a decision about Romo's future.

Romo, 46, has been the lead game analyst for the network's NFL coverage since 2017 after making four Pro Bowl appearances during a playing career that ran from 2004-16 and was spent entirely with Dallas.

Analyst JJ Watt will join play-by-play announcer Jim Nantz and sideline reporter Tracy Wolfson on CBS Sports' lead NFL team during Romo's absence. Their first game will be Sept. 13, when the Minnesota Vikings host the Green Bay Packers.

Romo's arrest followed a traffic stop as he was driving south on Interstate 43. According to the Milwaukee County Sheriff's Office, Romo performed poorly on field sobriety tests before getting arrested, booked and released.

Citations released by the Milwaukee County Sheriff's Office indicated an open bottle of an alcoholic beverage was found in the passenger's side of Romo's black Jeep during an inventory before it was towed.

Body-camera footage released earlier this week showed Romo telling deputies he had been coming from a golf course and was on his way "to visit grandma and grandpa" when he was stopped. A deputy told Romo he suspected him of being impaired because he had "red glassy eyes" and an "odor of an intoxicating alcoholic beverage."

"Tony accepts full responsibility for his actions and has taken proactive steps to ensure that this isolated civil matter is properly resolved," a Romo spokesperson said in a statement to the Milwaukee Journal Sentinel and TMZ. "We are working with local authorities to bring this matter to a close and we are communicating with CBS about next steps."

• **JETS:** Rookie running back Chip Trayanum was hospitalized with a neck injury after being tackled on the final play of the first half against the New York Giants.

The Jets announced that Trayanum, an undrafted rookie from Toledo, was awake, alert and had movement in all of his extremities.

The Jets got the ball with 10 seconds left before halftime, and rather than have Cade Klubnik take a knee, they opted to run a play. Trayanum took the hand-off from Klubnik and was immediately hit by Trace Ford.

Trayanum stayed down on the field as trainers and doctors ran out to examine him. Jets players and coaches remained on the field — many on their knees and praying — as Trayanum was attended to.

After several minutes, it appeared Trayanum was put in a neck brace, strapped to a backboard and loaded onto a cart and driven off the field. The running back appeared to be flexing both of his hands as he was driven inside.

• **TITANS:** Wide receiver Wan'Dale Robinson is not believed to have suffered a concussion in Thursday's joint practice with the Chicago Bears, NFL Network reported.

Robinson underwent tests after a helmet-to-helmet hit from Chicago safety Xavier Woods, a shot Tennessee Coach Robert Saleh characterized as "cheap."

The Titans will continue to check Robinson for potential concussion symptoms, but "early indications are positive," per the report. He walked to the locker room under his own power following the hit as a fracas broke out on the field and the two teams had to be separated.

BASEBALL

National League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10	STR
Atlanta	80	55	.593	—	6-4	W-5
x-Philadelphia	74	60	.552	5½	8-2	W-1
Miami	68	67	.504	12	4-6	L-1
Washington	64	73	.467	17	4-6	W-2
New York	60	75	.444	20	4-6	L-3

Nationals 9, Marlins 2

MARLINS	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Hernández lf.....	3	1	0	1	0.235
Ramírez dh.....	3	0	0	0	0.228
Lopez ss.....	4	0	1	0	0.307
Sanoja rf-3b.....	3	1	1	0	0.280
Edwards 2b.....	4	0	0	0	0.285
Stowers lb.....	3	0	1	0	0.242
Calisfie rf.....	1	0	0	0	0.124
Jiménez 2b-1b.....	3	0	0	0	1.203
E.Ruiz cf.....	3	0	0	0	0.236
Mack c.....	3	0	0	0	0.230
Navarrete c.....	0	0	0	0	0.118
TOTALS	30	2	5	2	5 4 —

NATIONALS	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Abrams ss.....	3	1	0	1	0.272
Ortiz lb.....	1	2	0	0	0.224
Crews rf.....	4	1	2	0	0.220
Lile lf.....	3	1	1	1	0.251
House 3b.....	4	0	1	0	0.235
Vivas 2b.....	4	0	1	0	0.235
Ford c.....	4	1	1	0	0.197
Chaparro dh.....	2	2	0	2	0.246
Young cf.....	3	1	0	1	0.247
TOTALS	31	9	7	5	8 —

MIAMI..... 010 000 010 — 2 5 1
WASHINGTON..... 005 000 40X — 9 7 0

E: Mack (7). LOB: Miami 6, Washington 3. 2B: Sanoja (2B), Ortiz (3). Crews (14). 3B: Lile (6). HR: Hernández (21). off: Kranick; House (10), off Pérez; Ford (3), off Monteverde. RbB: Edwards (51), Hernández (56), House 3 (36), Ford (8), Crews 2 (33), Lile (75). SB: Edwards (20).

MARLINS	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Pérez.....	3	2	5	4	5	743.44	
Zuber.....	0	0	0	0	1	123.68	
Monteverde.....	4	5	4	1	2	659.00	

NATIONALS	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Kent.....	7	5	1	4	3	1065.59	
Kranick.....	2	5	1	1	1	245.94	

WP: Kent (1-2). LP: Pérez (7-10). WP: Pérez, Monteverde, ABS Challenge. Crews (Strike-Overturned to Ball) T: 2:35. At: 18,047 (41,376).

HOW THEY SCORED

MARLINS SECOND

Javier Sanoja doubles. Xavier Edwards singles. Javier Sanoja scores. Kyle Stowers grounds out. Xavier Edwards to third. Leo Jimenez hits into a force out. Xavier Edwards out at home. Estuary Ruiz strikes out swinging.

Marlins 1, Nationals 0

NATIONALS THIRD

Andres Chaparro walks. Jacob Young walks. Andres Chaparro to second. CJ Abrams walks. Jacob Young to second.

Andres Chaparro to third. Abimelec Ortiz strikes out swinging. Dylan Crews called out on strikes. Throwing error by Joseph Mack. CJ Abrams to second, Jacob Young scores. Andres Chaparro scores. Daylen Lile walks. Brady House homers. Daylen Lile scores. CJ Abrams scores. Jorhit Vilas grounds out.

Nationals 5, Marlins 1

NATIONALS SEVENTH

Harry Ford homers. Andres Chaparro walks. Jacob Young lines out. CJ Abrams flies out. Abimelec Ortiz singles. Andres Chaparro to third. Dylan Crews doubles. Abimelec Ortiz scores. Andres Chaparro scores. Daylen Lile triples. Dylan Crews scores. Brady House strikes out swinging.

Marlins 9, Marlins 1

MARLINS EIGHTH

Heriberto Hernandez homers. Agustín Ramirez pops out. Otto Lopez singles. Javier Sanoja grounds out. Otto Lopez out at second.

Nationals 9, Marlins 2

NATIONALS' LEADERS

Entering Saturday's game.

Ramirez pops out. Otto Lopez singles. Javier Sanoja grounds out, Otto Lopez out at second.

Nationals 9, Marlins 2

NATIONALS' LEADERS
Entering Saturday's game.

PITCHERS	W	L	ERA	IP	ER	BB	SO
Tolman.....	0	0	0.00	2.2	0	2	2
Waldron.....	0	0	0.00	2	0	0	2
Yean.....	0	1	1.80	10	2	6	6
Fernández.....	0	0	2.25	4	1	2	3
Dion.....	1	1	2.45	14.2	4	6	12
Williams.....	0	0	2.65	17	5	6	66
Poulin.....	3	0	2.70	36.2	11	21	25
Griffin.....	12	5	3.06	129.1	44	30	116
Cavalli.....	42	5	3.26	129.1	53	43	169
Bird.....	0	0	3.24	8.1	3	2	10
Beeter.....	5	4	3.61	42.1	19	42	42
Alvarez.....	2	6	3.72	84.2	35	38	80
Lord.....	5	2	3.74	112.1	28	67	120
Lovely.....	3	5	3.91	23	10	17	21
Ribalt.....	0	2	3.95	41	18	18	38
Lawrence.....	0	0	4.26	6.1	3	7	6
Cosgrove.....	1	2	4.80	15	8	4	13
Littell.....	7	8	4.97	112.1	62	75	30
Cornello.....	2	1	5.40	20	12	20	9
Joken.....	1	2	5.59	19.1	12	15	17
Irvin.....	2	6	5.62	81.2	51	39	82
Mikolas.....	3	9	5.82	116	75	23	58
Kranick.....	0	0	5.94	16.2	11	8	10
Pérez.....	2	3	6.19	16	11	11	9
Schultz.....	1	2	6.40	23.1	23	12	32
Parker.....	3	3	6.58	39.2	29	13	34
Z.Kent.....	0	0	6.75	10.2	8	15	2
Waldichuk.....	0	0	6.75	9.1	7	6	8
Varland.....	1	2	6.82	31.2	24	15	30
Palmaquist.....	0	2	7.71	16.1	14	8	15
Knook.....	0	1	7.91	4.2	4	6	4
Henry.....	0	2	7.90	13.2	12	7	15
Granillo.....	0	0	9.64	9.1	10	8	3
Cruz.....	0	1	11.25	4	5	4	0
Vivas.....	0	0	13.50	4	6	0	0
Perales.....	0	0	18.00	2	4	3	3

INHERITED RUNNERS-SCORED	W	L	ERA	IP	ER	BB	SO
Edwards.....	5	6	3.30	23	6	11	21
Thornton.....	5	6	4.25	3	6	11	31
Thornton.....	5	6	4.25	3	6	11	31
Palencia.....	1	1	1.1	1	0	24	19

WP: Lowder (6-8); LP: Thornton (5-5); S: Pagán (18). Antone pitched to 3 batters in the 8th Inherited runners-scored: Burke 2-0. HBP: Ciale (McLain). WP: Mey, Peterson. ABS Challenge. Lowder (Ball-Overturned to Strike) T: 3:07. At: 39,036 (41,363).



DAVID BANKS/IMAGN IMAGES

Stephen-slam

Reds designated hitter Tyler Stephenson rounds the bases after hitting a three-run homer against the Cubs at Wrigley Field. Cincinnati went on to win, 10-8.

Reds 10, Cubs 8

Tyler Stephenson hit a three-run homer to high-light a five-run sixth inning: Jose Trevino, TJ Friedl and Sai Stewart also went deep; and Cincinnati beat Chicago.

REDS	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Myers cf.....	5	0	0	0	0.254
De La Cruz ss.....	5	1	3	2	0.268
Stewart lb.....	4	2	2	2	0.263
Stephenson dh.....	5	1	2	3	0.248
Suárez 3b.....	5	1	3	0	0.205
Bleday lf-rf.....	5	1	1	0	0.219
McLain 2b.....	4	1	0	0	0.191
Trevino c.....	5	1	2	1	0.237
Rodriguez lf.....	3	2	2	1	0.245
Friedl lf.....	1	1	1	0	0.161
TOTALS	41	10	13	10	4 10 —

CUBS	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Crow-Armstrong cf.....	5	0	0	0	0.177
Suzuki rf.....	5	2	3	2	0.174
Busch lb.....	4	1	1	2	0.244
Bregman 3b.....	5	0	1	1	0.252
Happ lf.....	5	1	1	0	0.219
Hoerner ss.....	5	1	3	0	0.261
Ramirez 2b.....	4	1	1	3	0.285
Conforto dh.....	3	0	0	0	0.229
Shaw ph-dh.....	1	1	1	0	0.252
Kelly c.....	3	1	0	1	0.257
TOTALS	40	8	13	8	2 7 —

CINCINNATI..... 000 115 201 — 10 13 0
CHICAGO..... 002 000 140 — 8 12 2

E: Peterson (5), Bregman (5). LOB: Cincinnati 3, Chicago 2. 2B: Suzuki (28), Bregman (25), Shaw (7). HR: Stewart (29), off Peterson; Trevino (5), off Thornton; Stephenson (13), off Thornton; Friedl (4), off Palencia; Busch (17), off Lowder; Ramirez (4), off Antone.

REDS	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Lowder.....	5	6	3	3	0	55.14	
Mey.....	1½	2	1	1	1	0.368	
Burke.....	½	0	0	0	1	1.245	
Antone.....	0	3	3	0	0	0.392	
Mullins.....	1	2	1	0	1	0.464	
Pagan.....	1	0	0	0	1	0.390	

CUBS	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Peterson.....	5	6	4	2	3	65.11	
Thornton.....	½	4	5	1	1	0.332	
Conteras lb.....	4	0	0	0	2	0.278	
Palencia.....	1	1	1	1	0	0.249	

WP: Lowder (6-8); LP: Thornton (5-5); S: Pagán (18). Antone pitched to 3 batters in the 8th Inherited runners-scored: Burke 2-0. HBP: Ciale (McLain). WP: Mey, Peterson. ABS Challenge. Lowder (Ball-Overturned to Strike) T: 3:07. At: 39,036 (41,363).

Yankees 1, Red Sox 0

Paul Goldschmidt homered, left fielder Cody Bellinger threw out the potential tying run at home plate to end the seventh inning, and New York edged Boston in the opener of a pivotal four-game series.

Cam Schiltler struck out eight in 5½ innings of two-hit ball.

RED SOX

RED SOX	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Sogard ss-2b.....	5	0	0	0	0.257
Rafaela cf.....	4	0	2	0	0.287
Abreu rf.....	3	0	2	0	0.255
Bellinger lf.....	4	0	0	0	0.254
Rutschman c.....	4	0	0	0	0.233
Durbin 3b.....	2	0	0	2	0.255
Gasper dh.....	0	0	0	2	0.275
Veen rf-lf.....	1	2	1	0	0.250
Duran lf.....	2	0	0	0	0.209
White ph-lf.....	2	0	1	0	0.238
Seigler 2b.....	1	0	0	1	0.250
Monasterio ph-ss.....	2	0	0	0	0.253
TOTALS	30	0	5	0	6 9 —

YANKEES	AB	R	H	BIBBSO	AVG
Goldschmidt 1b.....	4	1	1	0	0.247
Rice dh.....	4	0	2	0	0.235
Bellinger lf.....	4	0	0	0	0.254
Ramos rf.....	1	0	0	2	0.239
S.Jones ph-rf.....	1	0	0	0	0.229
Grisham cf.....	2	0	0	1	0.216
Lombard ss.....	2	0	0	1	0.257
Chisholm 2b.....	3	0	0	0	0.226
Calabrese 3b.....	3	0	0	0	0.232
Wells c.....	3	0	0	0	0.378
TOTALS	27	1	3	4	11 —

BOSTON..... 000 000 000 — 0 5 0
NEW YORK..... 001 000 00X — 1 3 1

E: Wells (6). LOB: Boston 10, New York 6. 2B: Sanoja (2B), Ortiz (3). Crews (14). 3B: Lile (6). HR: Hernández (21). off: Kranick; House (10), off Pérez; Ford (3), off Monteverde. RbB: Edwards (51), Hernández (56), House 3 (36), Ford (8), Crews 2 (33), Lile (75). SB: Edwards (20).

RED SOX	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Sandoval.....	5½	3	1	4	7	42.0	
Weissert.....	½	0	0	0	1	3.88	
Guerrero.....	0	0	0	0	1	0.265	
Monasterio.....	1	0	0	0	0	0.200	

YANKEES	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA
Schiltler.....	5½	2	0	0	5	82.09	
Headrick.....	½	1	0	0	1	11.86	
Blackburn.....	1½	2	0	0	0	0.167	
Bednar.....	1	0	0	0	0	0.231	

WP: Schiltler (12-6); LP: Sandoval (1-3); S: Bednar (31). Inherited runners-scored: Weisbert 3-0, Headrick 1-0, ABS Challenge. Schiltler (Ball-Overturned to Strike) T: 2:47. At: 43,476 (47,309).

Dodgers 2, Tigers 1

U.S. OPEN

Sakamoto knocks off his idol to earn a spot in main draw

Up-and-comer ends bid by compatriot Nishikori for a final Slam berth

BY BRIAN MAHONEY

NEW YORK — Rei Sakamoto played his way into the U.S. Open — but only by taking the spot that Kei Nishikori, Japan's greatest men's tennis star, hoped to earn for one last Grand Slam appearance.

In a changing-of-the-guard match, Sakamoto beat Nishikori, 6-4, 7-6 (7-3), on Friday in the final round of qualifying to earn a place in the main draw.

“Not happy to lose today, but I’m happy for Rei,” Nishikori said. “He’s the next Japanese top player.”

The 20-year-old Sakamoto, like many other players from Japan, considers Nishikori his hero. He was 8 years old and remembers when Nishikori reached the 2014 U.S. Open final, becoming the first Asian man to get that far in a Grand Slam tournament.

“I honestly grew up watching him play, and he was my idol for my whole life,” Sakamoto said, “and it’s also a pity to see his last season.”

Sakamoto, like many tennis players, doesn’t like to look at his draw ahead of time to see whom he might face. This time, though, he couldn’t help but find out.

“Like, after the second that draw came out, my mom texted me, ‘Hey, I hope you can make it to the final and play Kei,’” Sakamoto said. “So this time I got spoiled by my mom.”

Nishikori, 36, has battled injuries in recent years and has said this will be his final season. No longer ranked high enough for a guaranteed spot in the main draw, he was given a wild card by the U.S. Tennis Association into the qualifying tournament.

He won two matches but needed one more to lock up his spot. With fans chanting his name late in the second set, Nishikori was outplayed by Sakamoto, who pounded 19 aces, the last to end it after Nishikori had saved two



CHARLY TRIBALLEAU/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Rei Sakamoto, above, defeated Kei Nishikori, 6-4, 7-6 (7-3). “I honestly grew up watching him play, and he was my idol for my whole life,” the 20-year-old Sakamoto said.

match points.

Afterward, Nishikori was presented with a framed portrait of himself in action by U.S. Open officials. Sakamoto helped hold it up for a picture together.

It was a big moment for Sakamoto, but also a bittersweet one.

“I think a lot of people — like most of the people — still follow tennis because of him,” Sakamoto

said. “So he’s a superstar, and he did a lot to Japanese tennis.”

The final round of qualifying was pushed back to Friday because of rain. Zheng Qinwen, the 2024 Olympic women’s gold medalist in singles, pulled out a three-set victory to reach the main draw, while Bianca Andreescu — who beat Serena Williams in the 2019 U.S. Open final but has struggled

to stay healthy since — blew a lead and lost in three sets.

Grigor Dimitrov, who reached the 2019 U.S. Open semifinals after beating Roger Federer in what turned out to be Federer’s final match in Flushing Meadows, advanced Thursday when his opponent withdrew.

None of those matches had the same stakes as Nishikori’s. Once

ranked No. 4 in the world, he returned to the U.S. Open semifinals in 2016 and 2018 but had various injuries that kept him off the court for long stretches, and he determined he will stop playing after this year’s Japan Open.

“I think his career would have been one of the best, maybe on a similar level to maybe a [Andy] Murray or Stan Wawrinka if he

didn’t have so many injuries, because he was injured a lot, especially in his prime,” No. 1 seed Alexander Zverev said. “Once he got up to No. 4 in the world, No. 5 in the world, every single time he got injured. So I’d say in that aspect he was a little bit unlucky, but from a tennis point of view, he was amazing.”

— Associated Press

On the eve of his Hall of Fame enshrinement, Federer reflects upon his legacy

BY BRIAN MAHONEY

NEW YORK — Roger Federer loved to win, of course, and at the peak of his career he almost always did.

All those victories and trophies he piled up alone would have made Federer remembered forever in tennis, but they were only part of the reason he enjoyed playing. He liked traveling to tournaments, meeting people and making new friends, whether they were on the other side of the net or sitting in the stands.

Only after he finished competing did Federer realize how much that impacted his legacy in the sport.

“I think when you retire, I think I said it before, that there was a lot of talk also about maybe my personality and what I brought to the game overall when I wasn’t on court, which I was a little surprised,” Federer said. “I thought it was about, in the moment, forehands and backhands and saving break points and victories and all that stuff.

“But actually it becomes a little bit, not irrelevant eventually, but it’s about what were you remembered for, how did you behave in the locker rooms or in the corridors or maybe with the media, or with the tournament directors, the ball kids.”

Federer will have a chance to reflect back on it all Saturday



BRIAN SNYDER/REUTERS

Roger Federer considers the relationships he forged while on tour to be a vital part of his tennis legacy.

when he is enshrined in the International Tennis Hall of Fame in Newport, Rhode Island.

The 45-year-old from Switzerland, who will be honored along with broadcaster and former

player Mary Carillo, said it would be his first trip to Newport. That seemed surprising, given how many places he has seen because of tennis.

Sure, there were regular stops

such as New York, London and Paris for Grand Slam tournaments, but there were also cities such as Cape Town, South Africa, for an exhibition match against Rafael Nadal that drew nearly

52,000 fans; or Mexico City, for one against Alexander Zverev that drew more than 42,000.

Those were near the end of his career, when Federer was forced to limit his schedule for health reasons. He hated having to do so, because he liked going to too many places, even ones that didn’t host the biggest events.

“For me, if I look back, that’s kind of what I’m very happy about, that I went through 25 years on tour, and actually felt like I made a lot of friends and a lot of people miss me,” Federer said. “Same with fans. They come up to me and say, ‘What a shame you’re not playing anymore.’”

“Then I get a flashback saying it was an amazing time, and I say it every time. I loved it, and it’s a shame I can’t be on the tour anymore. But it was a great, great time, and I miss it dearly.”

The fans clearly miss Federer. When he returned to the U.S. Open this week for an exhibition, his first time playing in Flushing Meadows since 2019, the lines of fans waiting to get into Arthur Ashe Stadium resembled a night in the second week of the tournament.

Federer won five straight U.S. Open titles from 2004-08, during a stretch when he compiled a 247-15 record from 2004-06 and reached a record 10 consecutive Grand Slam finals from 2005-07, winning eight. He went on to win

1,251 matches and 103 tournaments, including 20 Grand Slams.

“He’s the best I’ve ever played against,” Andre Agassi, Federer’s opponent in the 2005 final, said in a video the U.S. Open showed before Federer took the court Tuesday.

The way he won, with far more flair than some stuffy champions of the past but without the temper tantrums of others, earned him accolades that his skills alone couldn’t. He won the ATP Tour’s sportsmanship award every year from 2004-09, and again from 2011-17, and the fan favorite award every year from 2003-21. Those came while earning prize money of nearly \$130.6 million.

Federer hits sometimes with his children — he and wife Mirka are parents of two sets of twins — and tries to attend a few events a year to keep himself connected to the sport.

“I’m in a very comfortable place today, but I’m still happy to be out there and being in the tennis world from time to time, because it is the glue to everything that surrounds me still today,” Federer said.

“I had the best time, had a lot of friends on tour, from players to people who were organizers, et cetera. So I hope that a lot of the players who retire also feel the same way about the game, because I care dearly.”

— Associated Press

Despite signs of progress, D.C. United is ‘struggling’

UNITED FROM B7

performances, but there is still a gap to the other teams. I know what we can and what we can’t do today. But that is the next step we want to go. We want to turn tight games into better results.”

LAFC, sitting third in the Western Conference, has visited Washington just once — a 4-0 rout of D.C. in April 2019.

This will mark United’s first match against that opponent since LAFC signed Son Heung-min, the South Korean forward who starred for English Premier League club Tottenham before arriving in MLS last summer.

“Of course, we are much stronger than we were last season, but

we are still struggling,” Weiler said. “We have to play on our limits. Everybody has to play on their limits. We need top performances. It should be better for us to have the entire squad on board.

“Now, we are missing again some starters and, of course, there’s an impact in our team.”

With defender Kye Rowles and forward João Peglow both questionable to face LAFC with thigh injuries, Weiler noted the impact such absences can have on the “fine line” between winning and losing.

“We are unfortunately closer to defeats than we are to victories today,” Weiler said. “That is a fact that we have to accept, and, of course, we try to change it. The

reasons? There are many reasons. We are making too many mistakes. ... We are not finding it, the right decisions. We are not efficient enough. That, we want to make better in the next game.”

Weiler has been focused on turning around United since he took over as coach in July 2025. Several offseason acquisitions have paid dividends this year: Striker Tai Baribo has scored a team-leading 12 goals, fellow forward Louis Munteanu has chipped in six and right back Silvan Hefti is tied for the team lead with four assists.

Always quick to address United’s need for more high-quality players, Weiler said Thursday that he’s both pleased with the

progress and keenly aware of how far his team still has to go.

The summer transfer window remains open, though Weiler allowed that it’s unlikely United will complete any further moves before it closes Wednesday.

“At the same time, it is our job, my job, to make the players daily better,” Weiler said. “I think when the best players are on the field, when we are in full strength, then it’s really complicated to play against us and we are really close to win games.

“At the end, quality always decides. We have to bring it into the team with transfers, and I have to try to get out more of all our potential we have into the team today.”



MINAS PANAGIOTAKIS/GETTY IMAGES

Tai Baribo, right, and D.C. United are on the cusp of a playoff berth with 13 games left but have found wins hard to come by this season.

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL preseason

WEEK 1

SATURDAY, AUG. 15

at Baltimore 24, Philadelphia 7
Minnesota 34, at N.Y. Giants 10
at Buffalo 29, Carolina 14
at Chicago 34, Cleveland 10
Jacksonville 24, at New Orleans 20
L.A. Rams 20, at Kansas City 12
Dallas 17, at Seattle 7

WEEK 2

THURSDAY, AUG. 20

Las Vegas 22, at Houston 20
San Francisco 41, at L.A. Chargers 17

FRIDAY, AUG. 21

N.Y. Jets 17, at Pittsburgh 0
Carolina 34, at Jacksonville 17
Green Bay at Denver, late

SATURDAY'S RESULTS

at Detroit 17, Washington 13
Baltimore 13, at Minnesota 3
Buffalo 31, at Cleveland 7
Atlanta 34, at Indianapolis 6
N.Y. Giants 26, at Miami 3
at L.A. Rams 34, New Orleans 0
at Cincinnati 27, Chicago 9
at New England 24, Philadelphia 21
at Tampa Bay 16, Kansas City 15
Dallas 34, at Arizona 13

SUNDAY'S RESULT

at Tennessee 19, Seattle 16

WEEK 3

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

Pittsburgh at Buffalo, 7
New England at Cleveland, 8
San Francisco at Las Vegas, 8
L.A. Rams at L.A. Chargers, 10

FRIDAY'S RESULTS

at Baltimore 41, Washington 3
Atlanta 17, at Miami 12
at Carolina 16, Houston 13
at Jacksonville 19, Tampa Bay 0
N.Y. Giants 23, at N.Y. Jets 6
Cincinnati at Philadelphia, late
Seattle at Kansas City, late
New Orleans at Dallas, late
Arizona at Green Bay, late
Minnesota at Denver, late

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Detroit at Indianapolis, 1
Chicago at Tennessee, 6

Ravens 41, Commanders 3

WASHINGTON 0 0 3 0 -3
BALTIMORE 14 10 7 -41

FIRST QUARTER

Baltimore: C.Moore 25 pass from Huntley (Loop kick), 10:13. Drive: 9 plays, 69 yards, 4:44. Key Plays: Ward kick return to Baltimore 31.
Baltimore: Fagnano 1 run (Loop kick), 5:56. Drive: 7 plays, 30 yards, 4:06. Key Plays: Ali 4 run on 3rd-and-1

SECOND QUARTER

Baltimore: FG Randall 51, 10:36. Drive: 9 plays, 15 yards, 5:02. Key Plays: Loopall 3 run on 3rd-and-6
Baltimore: Wester 10 pass from Fagnano (Loop kick), 3:46. Drive: 9 plays, 91 yards, 4:42. Key Plays: Randall 11 run

THIRD QUARTER

Baltimore: Ward 2 run (Loop kick), 9:41. Drive: 7 plays, 56 yards, 3:10. Key Plays: Ward 10 run
Washington: FG Stevens 39, 5:59. Drive: 4 plays, 3 yards, 00:58. Key Play: O.Johnson 23 interception return to Baltimore 24. Baltimore 31, Washington 3.
Baltimore: FG Loop 24, 3:20. Drive: 7 plays, 59 yards, 2:39. Key Plays: Ward 24 run

FOURTH QUARTER

Baltimore: C.Johnson 20 pass from Reed (Loop kick), 12:55. Drive: 3 plays, 82 yards, 1:55. Key Play: McMillan 63 run. Baltimore 41, Washington 3.

WAS BAL
First Downs 7 26
Rushing 4 9
Passing 2 14
Penalty 1 3
Third Down Eff 1-12 4-12
Fourth Down Eff 2-1 1-1
Total Net Yards 177 456
Total Plays 52 69
Avg Gain 3.4 6.6
Net Yards Rushing 72 195
Rushes 22 30
Avg Per Rush 3.409 6.5
Net Yards Passing 102 261
Sacked-Yds Lost 3-7 0-0
Gross-Yds Passing 109 286
Completed-Att 16-27 26-39
Had Intercepted 0 1
Yards-Pass Play 3.4 6.692
Kickoffs-Endzone TD 2-1 0-2
Punts-Avg 74-6.571 34-6.0
Punts Blocked 0 0
Fgs-Pats Blocked 0-0 0-0
Total Return Yards 0 2-24
Punt Returns 0-0 2-24
Kickoff Returns 6-134 1-30
Interceptions 1-23 0-0
Penalties-Yds 9-43 6-45
Fumbles-Lost 2-1 2-0
Time Of Possession 26:15 33:45

PASSING
Washington: Hartman 9-14 0-64, Kallikmanis 7-13 0-45.
Baltimore: Fagnano 19-27 0-162, Huntley 4-4 0-61, Reed 3-8 1-35.

RUSHING

Washington: Reynolds 9-38, Henry 10-33, Allen 3-4.
Baltimore: McMillan 3-70, Ward 7-53, Ali 9-28, Randall 5-25, Huntley 2-14, Tau-Tolliver 2-4, Fagnano 1-1, Reed 1-0.

RECEIVING

Washington: Cager 6-34, Jones 3-12, Bradley 2-18, Jefferson 1-17, Mc Caffrey 1-17, Yankoff 1-6, Reynolds 1-4, Henry 1-1.
Baltimore: Pezza 5-47, C.Moore 3-54, Randall 3-45, Walker 3-22, Ali 3-18, Wester 2-21, Cuevas 2-15, Hibner 2-11, C.Johnson 1-20, Scott 1-7, Sarrait 1-1.

PUNT RETURNS

Washington: None. Baltimore, Wester 1-19, Wade 1-5.

KICKOFF RETURNS

Washington: Bradley 3-77, Reynolds 2-48, Allen 1-9. Baltimore: Ward 1-30.

TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS

Washington: Vigers 5-1-0, Rush 4-0-0, Kaho 3-3-0, Barnes 3-2-0, Owens 2-0-0, Covart 2-2-0, Knight 2-2-0, Medrano 1-4-0, Barber 1-3-0, O.Johnson 1-3-0, Basham 1-2-0, Jacobs 1-2-0, Hurst 1-1-0, O.Johnson 1-1-0, Tuttle 1-1-0, Butler 1-0-0, Davis 1-0-0, Maguvaranya 1-0-0, Mfba 0-3-0, Hamilton 0-2-0, Josephs 0-1-0.

Baltimore: DeLuca 3-3-0, Rucker 4-1-1, Longenecker 3-1-0, Benny 3-0-0, M.Robinson 2-0-0, Walters 3-0-0, Isaac 1-4-1, Wilson 1-2-0, Olajiga 1-1-0, Rivers 1-1-0, Barrett 1-0-0, Graves 1-0-0, Higgins 1-0-0, Jackson 1-0-0, Martin 1-0-0, Wallace 1-0-0, Burke 0-1-0, Okoye 0-1-0, Oruwaro 0-1-0.

INTERCEPTIONS

Washington: Q.Johnson 1-23. Baltimore: None.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Washington: Stevens 62. Baltimore: Loop 58, Loop 51.

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

AP PRESEASON TOP 25

The Top 25 teams in The Associated Press poll, with first-place votes in parentheses, total points based on 25 points for a first-place vote through one point for a 25th-place vote, and previous ranking.

	RECORD	PTS	PVS
1. Ohio State (40)	0-0	1672	1
2. Oregon (14)	0-0	1597	2
3. Georgia	0-0	1513	3
4. Notre Dame (6)	0-0	1510	4
5. Texas	0-0	1483	5
6. Indiana (8)	0-0	1440	6
7. Miami (1)	0-0	1379	7
8. Texas A&M	0-0	1131	8
9. Mississippi	0-0	1102	9
10. Oklahoma	0-0	1047	10
11. LSU	0-0	988	11
12. Texas Tech	0-0	983	12
13. Alabama	0-0	904	13
14. BYU	0-0	839	14
15. USC	0-0	839	14
16. Michigan	0-0	718	16
17. Washington	0-0	501	17
18. Penn State	0-0	482	18
19. SMU	0-0	434	19
20. Tennessee	0-0	394	20
21. Utah	0-0	304	21
22. Iowa	0-0	260	22
23. Houston	0-0	252	23
24. Louisville	0-0	198	24
25. Missouri	0-0	117	25

Others receiving votes: Clemson 112, Florida 51, Boise State 43, Arizona 32, TCU 11, Navy 10, South Carolina 10, Illinois 9, Oklahoma State 8, Vanderbilt 8, Pittsburgh 7, Virginia Tech 6, Minnesota 5, UNLV 4, New Mexico 4, Georgia Tech 4, James Madison 3, Auburn 3, Memphis 2, California 2, Liberty 1, Western Michigan 1, Tulane 1, Virginia 1.

NCAA

WEEK 6

SATURDAY'S GAMES

North Carolina State at Virginia, 3:30
North Carolina vs. TCU in Dublin, noon
San Jose State at USC, 3
Jacksonville State at North Dakota State, 5:30
Sacramento State at Eastern Michigan, 6:30
Hawaii at Stanford, 7
New Mexico State at Eastern Michigan, 7
Memphis at UNLV, 10

PRO BASKETBALL

WNBA

EAST	W	L	Pct	GB
Minnesota	25	14	.441	4
y-Indiana	26	14	.650	—
xy-Washington	24	15	.615	1½
y-New York	26	16	.590	2½
Chicago	15	24	.385	10½
x-Toronto	11	27	.289	14
Connecticut	10	29	.256	15½

WEST	W	L	Pct	GB
y-Minnesota	31	8	.795	—
y-Golden State	28	11	.718	3
xy-Las Vegas	26	13	.667	5
y-Dallas	23	16	.590	8
Portland	16	23	.410	13
x-Los Angeles	13	25	.342	17½
Phoenix	13	26	.333	18
Seattle	8	31	.205	23

x-Late game; y-Clinched playoff spot

WEDNESDAY'S RESULTS

Golden State 89, at Connecticut 64
at Seattle 90, Toronto 76

THURSDAY'S RESULTS

Washington 80, at Phoenix 73
Golden State 79, at New York 60

FRIDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Los Angeles, late
at Indiana 101, Connecticut 91
Portland 101, at Atlanta 83
Toronto at Las Vegas, late

SATURDAY'S GAMES

Chicago at New York, 1
Toronto at Phoenix, 10

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Minnesota at Atlanta, 3
Los Angeles at Seattle, 5
Golden State at Portland, 7
Connecticut at Dallas, 8:30

MONDAY'S RESULTS

No games scheduled.

MYSTICS' NEXT THREE

vs. Chicago Sky

Sept. 17 8 Monumental

at Indiana Fever

Sept. 20 4 Monumental

vs. Connecticut Sun

Sept. 22 7:30 Monumental

Radio: WTEM (980 AM)

Fire 101, Dream 83

Portland 28 24 22 27 - 101
Atlanta 18 20 23 22 - 83

PORTLAND MIN FG FT O-T A PF PTS
Engstler 30:05 11-14 0-0 0-6 1 4 25
Dileo 25:02 2-4 0-0 0-2 3 7
Carleton 32:59 1-6 2-2 0-6 3 2 4
Lette 29:00 9-13 4-4 1-3 6 5 26
Fumbles-Lost 13-18 1-2 1-0
Winterburn 13:03 4-7 0-0 2-2 0 11
Harrison 11:00 2-3 3-4 0-1 4 7
Okonkwo 9:55 2-4 0-0 1-1 0 3 5
Samuelson 8:56 0-2 0-0 0-2 0 1 0
TOTALS 20 38-65 12-14 6-30 16 24 101

Percentages: FG .585, FT .857, 3-Point Goals: 12-33, 43.3 (Lette 4-4, Engstler 3-5, Winterburn 3-6, Dileo 2-6, Okonkwo 1-2, Harrison 0-1, Samuelson 0-1, Puch 0-2, Carleton 0-3). Team Rebounds: 5. Team Turnovers: None. Blocked Shots: 7 (Engstler 4, Williams 2, Winterburn, 1). Fumbles: 11 (Lette 5, Dileo, Engstler, Harrison, Puch, Williams, Winterburn). Steals: 1 (Engstler 4, Carleton 2, Lette 2, Harrison, Puch, Winterburn). Technical Fouls: Engstler, 7; 33rd third.

ATLANTA MIN FG FT O-T A PF PTS
Hillmon 34:09 3-10 2-2 5-9 2 1 10
Howard 38:26 8-21 4-4 1-6 1 2 26
Angloana 27:26 5-14 2-6 0-3 2 19
Canada 31:36 3-5 4-6 0-1 5 11
Gray 34:45 3-13 3-4 0-0 3 4 11
Papapo 10:00 2-3 0-0 1-1 2 2 4
Angloana 6:43 1-2 0-0 0-2 0 2 1
Borlase 3:38 1-2 0-0 0-0 0 0 3
Kone 1:25 0-1 0-0 0-0 0 0 0
Walker-Kimbrough 1:35 0-0 0-0 0-0 0 0 0
TOTALS 20 26-71 19-24 16-34 20 16 83

Percentages: FG .366, FT .792, 3-Point Goals: 12-33, 36.4 (Howard 6-13, Hillmon 2-7, Gray 2-8, Borlase 1-2, Carleton 0-3). Team Rebounds: 10. Team Turnovers: 11 (Lette 5, Dileo, Engstler, Harrison, Puch, Williams, Winterburn). Steals: 1 (Engstler 4, Carleton 2, Lette 2, Harrison, Puch, Winterburn). Technical Fouls: Engstler, 7; 33rd third.

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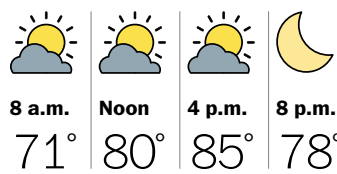
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Borlase 3:38 1-2 0-0 0-0 0 0 3
Kone 1:25 0-1 0-0 0-0 0 0 0
Walker-Kimbrough 1:35 0-0 0-0 0-0 0 0 0
TOTALS 20 26-71 19-24 16-34 20 16 83

Percentages: FG .585, FT .857, 3-Point Goals: 12-33, 43.3 (Lette 4-4, Engstler 3-5, Winterburn 3-6, Dileo 2-6, Okonkwo 1-2, Harrison 0-1, Samuelson 0-1, Puch 0-2, Carleton 0-3). Team Rebounds: 5. Team Turnovers: None. Blocked Shots: 7 (Engstler 4, Williams 2, Winterburn, 1). Fumbles: 11 (Lette 5, Dileo, Engstler, Harrison, Puch, Williams, Winterburn). Steals: 1 (Engstler 4, Carleton 2, Lette 2, Harrison, Puch, Winterburn). Technical Fouls: Engstler, 7; 33rd third.

ATLANTA MIN FG FT O-T A PF PTS
Hillmon 34:09 3-10 2-2 5-9 2 1 10
Howard 38:26 8-21 4-4 1-6 1 2 26



TODAY'S WEATHER
High today at approx. 4 p.m.: **85°**
Precip: **0%** Wind: **ENE 6-12 mph**
For weather news, go to **B18**

VIRGINIA
Budget cuts could impact support services for mental health issues. **B15**



OBITUARIES
Norway's Harald V, 89, fled the Nazis and then modernized monarchy. **B16**



MIKE KROPP/RICHMOND TIMES-DISPATCH/GETTY IMAGES

Statues of Gen. Stonewall Jackson, Gov. William "Extra Billy" Smith and physician Hunter Holmes McGuire are loaded onto a truck after being removed from Richmond's Capitol Square on Friday.

Remaining Confederate statues removed from Virginia's Capitol

Movement that peaked in 2020 with toppling of Jefferson Davis memorial is complete; strong opinions abound on both sides

BY BEN CONARCK

More than six years after protesters in Richmond toppled an iconic statue of Jefferson Davis amid national civil rights demonstrations, work crews quietly removed three remaining Confederate monuments from their pedestals across town.

The removals of the past Confederate heroes — Gen. Thomas J. "Stonewall Jackson," Gov. William "Extra Billy" Smith and physician Hunter Holmes McGuire — represented the culmination of efforts by Democratic lawmakers who sought to rid the Capitol grounds of what they saw as an embarrass-

ing tribute to a painful past.

Though Friday's effort was tame compared with Davis's toppling in 2020, the symbolism was strong enough to attract camera crews from local television stations, which broadcast the images live.

Watching the scene unfold on his TV was one of the men responsible, former Virginia senator Adam Ebbin (D), who left office earlier this year.

In January, Ebbin introduced a bill to remove the statues. The measure was folded into an amendment to Virginia's budget, which passed in June, after he left office.

Though the Confederate monuments date back to the late 19th and early 20th centuries, Ebbin pointed out that, in the past few decades, there have been several upgrades to the Capitol grounds.

The building itself underwent a historic restoration and underground expansion in the 2000s, and in subsequent years, monuments were added to honor the civil rights movement, fallen police officers and women.

"There's a saying that you leave the campground better than you found it," Ebbin said. "I think this leaves room for a conversation about what other Virginians we

SEE STATUES ON B14

Ohio woman is indicted over World War II Memorial vandalism incident

BY LIAM SCOTT

A federal grand jury has indicted a woman who filmed herself dumping soap into a fountain at the World War II Memorial in Washington and spray-painting its granite this month.

Melissa Farris, 41, is charged with destruction of a veterans' memorial and destruction of government property, both felonies, in connection with the Aug. 13 incident on the National Mall.

Farris live-streamed herself on social media as bubbles filled the fountain beneath the Atlantic Arch. Photos from the scene showed the message "Clean hands dirty \$" spelled out in red beneath the arch, as well as red and green paint splattered on the surrounding stonework.

Farris was arrested the next day, and a judge last week ordered her to return to Ohio, where she lives. Her next court hearing is set for next Thursday before U.S. District Judge Trevor N. McFadden, an appointee of President Donald Trump. The grand jury indicted Farris on Thursday.

In a Friday statement, the U.S. attorney for D.C., Jeanine Pirro,

said the memorial is a tribute to the millions of Americans who served, including the hundreds of thousands who died, during World War II.

"Defacing it is an affront to their service and sacrifice," she said. "We will use every tool available under federal law to ensure this conduct is met with justice."

Farris and a public defender representing her did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Both of the felony charges carry a maximum prison sentence of 10 years. Court records say the damage at the memorial exceeded \$1,000. The incident prompted condemnation from Trump, the Interior Department and various lawmakers.

"THERE CAN BE NO GREATER INSULT TO THOSE AMERICAN HEROES WHO DIED IN WORLD WAR II," Trump wrote in a Truth Social post the day after the vandalism occurred. "First the Reflecting Pool, now this. We are on their trail! Where do these animals come from???"

The incident at the memorial came after the White House blamed vandals for damaging the

nearby Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool. Pirro ultimately dropped charges against four people, and the Justice Department said information showed that "the damage was the result of a botched installation and not vandalism as initially represented."

In an exclusive interview with The Washington Post, Farris acknowledged vandalizing the memorial and said she was trying to draw attention to what she believes was the withholding of health care funds by her former employer in Kentucky. (The employer and two union branches have not responded to requests for comment.)

"I decided I was going to scream loudly enough that a nation will hear me," she said.

Farris said that despite the criticism and death threats she has received over the vandalism, she sees herself as a patriot.

"Blue collar built America," she said. "We maintain America. We pay for the maintaining of America, and we don't get to touch any of it. We're stuck in tiny perimeters pulling up our bootstraps every day, and no matter how hard we pull, it's never enough."

Hains Point has become felled point

Trump's public golf course renewal plan is uncertain, but trees are falling



RICK MAESE/THE WASHINGTON POST

Crews have taken down trees at East Potomac Golf Links even though there's no reconstruction plan.

BY RICK MAESE

Across East Potomac Golf Links, amid golfers squeezing in late-summer rounds and wondering what will become of the beloved D.C. course, newly cut stumps and bare patches of dirt mark the places where dozens of trees recently stood.

The Trump administration's

promised overhaul of the course has not officially begun. The trees, however, have been coming down for weeks.

President Donald Trump said June 28 that work on the historical public golf facility would begin Sept. 1, but days before that date, his administration has released no final design, construction schedule or estimated cost.

Officials have not said whether the course will close next week, what work might begin, or what golfers and other visitors to the national parkland should expect.

An informal count Thursday found that more than 60 trees appeared to have been removed in recent weeks. Many were around the perimeter and park-

SEE TREES ON B14

Three remaining statues of Confederate figures are taken down in Richmond



STATUES FROM B13

may want to include.”

In a statement, a spokesperson for Virginia’s Department of General Services said crews removed the monuments in accordance with the budget item passed this year. The Jackson statue was unveiled in 1875, the Smith statue in 1906 and the McGuire statue in 1904, according to the statement.

The statues were gifted by the commonwealth to the Shenandoah Valley Battlefields Foundation, which will determine their relocation and future public display, the department said.

In a statement, the foundation said it would collaborate with state and local partners to “ensure the long-term preservation of these significant outdoor works of art.”

The foundation’s CEO, Keven Walker, said the foundation’s mission is driven by its belief that “our shared history can unite the people of our nation; that there is strength and inspiration for our own times to be found in the struggles of the past.”

“Preservation is more about the future than the past, and ensuring the preservation of the Capitol

Square monuments is a part of that clear vision,” Walker said.

Richmond has drawn international attention for its efforts to confront its legacy of slavery and the Civil War.

About a month after the toppling of Davis’s statue, workers wielding power tools and large rolls of bubble wrap extricated a life-size statue of Robert E. Lee and busts of seven of his Confederate colleagues out of the Virginia Capitol.

Some icons have been reinterpreted in museums. Others have been hidden away in storage.

But for years after that initial flurry of activity, the three statues on the Capitol Grounds remained, a symbol of how deeply Confederate heritage was woven into Richmond’s landscape.

The issue flared up again in 2022, when then-Gov. Glenn Youngkin (R) appointed a historian who had defended the statues to Virginia’s Board of Historic Resources, raising questions about whether he intended to reignite the fight over their place in Richmond.

That fight never materialized.

After 22 years in the legislature, as he was preparing to join the administration of Gov. Abigail



PHOTOS BY MIKE KROPP/RICHMOND TIMES-DISPATCH/GETTY IMAGES

LEFT: Stonewall Jackson was among the remaining lightning rods; ABOVE: A statue of ex-Gov. William Smith is removed from its plinth.

Spanberger (D), Ebbin introduced his bill to remove the three holdouts.

The statues are of:

Jackson, a former instructor at the Virginia Military Institute who became Lee’s top general but died after a friendly-fire accident during the war. While lionized for his military skills, Jackson was a lifelong defender of slavery.

Smith, who served as governor both in the 1840s and again at the end of the Civil War. He was also a Confederate general who owned enslaved people.

McGuire was a Confederate soldier and physician for the South-

ern army who amputated Jackson’s arm after that friendly-fire incident. McGuire, who died at the turn of the 20th century, supported slavery all his life.

On Friday, Ebbin responded to critics of his efforts who say that removing the statues amounts to “erasing history.”

“We’re not erasing history,” he said. “It’s just about who we choose to put on the front page.”

State Sen. Lamont Bagby (D-Henrico), head of the Virginia Legislative Black Caucus, said the group had identified the statues on the Capitol grounds well before the 2020 protests sparked by

the murder of George Floyd. He said that shifts in political power, namely the election of Youngkin and Republican control of the House, delayed the efforts for several years.

Bagby reflected on the Black Virginians who helped build the Capitol and many other buildings on the grounds and who had to walk past the statues.

“It’s a reminder of the hatred,” Bagby said. “I’m not saying that those statues don’t have a place, but that place is certainly not in such a prestigious place as the Virginia Capitol Square.”

Bagby said he and other Black

state lawmakers continue to study ways to correct the racism of the past, such as instances when Black families were made to sell their homes to universities, and when some health care institutions displaced Black communities. He said they are also looking into funding for historically Black colleges and universities.

“It’s not all about tearing down monuments,” Bagby said. “It’s also about building up infrastructure to level the playing field.”

Gregory S. Schneider contributed to this report.

Trump’s makeover of public links course hasn’t started yet, but it actually has

TREES FROM B13

ing lot, but others had been removed from playing corridors on the Blue, Red and White courses.

Among the most conspicuous was a cherry tree near the 14th green of the Blue Course, one of East Potomac’s most picturesque holes, framed by cherry trees near the southern end of Hains Point. Nearby, two large sycamores had been removed around the fourth hole.

Tree removal is common in major golf course renovations, often to widen playing corridors, improve sight lines, and allow more sunlight and air to reach the turf. But the Interior Department characterized the activity as routine maintenance and did not connect it to the proposed redesign, nor did it answer questions about whether notice of the work had been provided to the federal court overseeing a legal challenge to the administration’s plans.

“Arborists are doing routine maintenance at East Potomac Park with selective removal of hazard trees, non-native invasive trees, and declining and dying trees that cannot be brought back to good health through any degree of intervention,” a department spokesperson said in a statement. “Trees throughout the park are regularly monitored for potential safety impacts to visitors, and when a tree is determined to be dying, declining, or

hazardous our arborists may make the decision to remove it.”

During a May hearing in the lawsuit, brought by preservationists seeking to block the course overhaul, U.S. District Judge Ana C. Reyes declined to stop the government from performing necessary maintenance but warned administration lawyers against presenting the court with a fait accompli. She said she wanted advance notice before the government removed more than 10 trees or brought equipment larger than a sedan onto the property.

That direction was delivered orally and was not included in a formal written order. A person familiar with the legal proceedings, who spoke on the condition of anonymity out of fear of retribution, said the government has not notified the plaintiffs or the court about the recent tree work.

A joint court filing posted Friday added to the uncertainty surrounding Trump’s proposed Sept. 1 start date.

The Justice Department, which previously has asked the court to dismiss the lawsuit, wrote that “no final agency action has occurred” and that “multiple public-facing steps” would precede a course redesign.

The plaintiffs, however, highlighted the tension between that position and the administration’s stated timetable. They quoted a government attorney telling the court during a July hearing that



RICK MAESE/THE WASHINGTON POST

Several trees have recently been taken down from East Potomac Park ahead of the official construction.

Interior and the Park Service were “trying to meet” a September construction date.

At the same time, the plaintiffs noted that the government has represented that before breaking ground, the Park Service will complete environmental and historical-preservation reviews, determine that the work would not impair park resources and obtain

approval from the National Capital Planning Commission.

They cited an Aug. 6 email in which a Justice Department attorney said the Park Service “must secure final approval from NCPC before construction of a proposed redesign can begin.”

A National Park Service spokesperson did not respond to a request for comment.

Some of the required steps remain unfinished. An initial meeting in the historical-preservation review has twice been postponed and has not been rescheduled. And the golf course is not currently on the agenda for the National Capital Planning Commission’s next meeting, scheduled for this coming Thursday.

The administration also has not disclosed the project’s expected cost, the source or amount of private funding, or details of possible related work, including improvements to the seawall surrounding Hains Point.

Nor has it said how construction would affect public access to East Potomac’s three courses, driving range and miniature-golf course, or to the popular recreational path used by runners, cyclists and pedestrians. National Links Trust, which continues to operate the golf facility on an interim basis, declined to comment.

Across East Potomac, the conditions of the recently removed trees varied. Many of the remaining stumps were visibly hollow or showed signs of decay. In other areas, the stumps had already been ground down, leaving only circles of dirt.

RTEC Treecare crews were cutting trees Thursday. On the 13th hole of the Blue Course, a crew took down a large tree that showed clear signs of decay. A Park Service employee nearby was marking other trees but declined to answer questions.

White dots had been painted on some trunks elsewhere on the property, while yellow ribbons had been tied around numerous others. It was unclear what the markings signified or whether those trees were also slated for removal.

MARYLAND

As state shifts costs to local governments, municipalities struggle to fund EMTs

BY TINASHE CHINGARANDE
Baltimore Sun

Maryland counties are being forced to squeeze funding for paramedics and EMTs as rising costs and reduced state support put pressure on local budgets.

The pressure intensified July 1, when Gov. Wes Moore’s fiscal 2027 budget took effect and shifted more costs to local governments, including reducing the state’s contribution to teachers’ pensions and education programs. The changes mean counties must absorb more of those costs while also facing rising expenses to staff emergency services, local leaders told The Baltimore Sun on Wednesday.

Harford County added \$10 million to its education costs in fiscal 2027, county Treasurer Robert Sandlass said, putting additional pressure on the county’s ability to fund emergency personnel as it struggles to re-

cruit and retain paramedics and EMTs.

“The county has had to hire all of those paramedics and EMTs and outfit them, and that’s certainly one of those places where (costs) are just going to get more and more expensive,” said Harford County Treasurer Robert Sandlass. “It’s a very tight labor market for those individuals. They’re highly skilled. They’re in demand. You have to pay a market rate.”

Counties also face higher emergency services costs as volunteer fire departments struggle to recruit and retain volunteers because of a nationwide decline in volunteer firefighters, increasing reliance on paid emergency personnel, Sandlass said.

Prince George’s County is also facing pressure on its social-service and health programs, a county council member said. County council member Jolene Ivey said the county’s health and

social services departments are already underfunded, and added financial pressures make it harder to hire enough personnel.

“They’re always short-staffed. They’re always needing more resources,” Ivey told The Sun. “So the thought of fewer resources is alarming.”

The pressure comes as Maryland is projected to face additional budget shortfalls over the next five years. To close a \$1.4 billion budget shortfall for fiscal 2027, Moore made nearly a billion dollars in cuts to state programs and fund transfers. Most notable was a \$150 million cut to the local income tax reserve account, which officials argued was necessary because the state had overpaid local jurisdictions their share of income taxes the comptroller collects.

Kevin Kinnally, legislative director at the Maryland Association of Counties, said counties are seriously considering raising

property and income taxes, particularly as the federal government’s dismantling of the Federal Emergency Management Agency has compounded pressure from the state.

“Counties are shifting all over the place, kind of in real time, dealing with all these pressures at the federal and state level,” Kinnally said. “So when you have things like, ‘Hey, if there’s a tornado tomorrow, and the feds don’t show up, what are we going to do? The state doesn’t have a big reserve fund.’ Things like that are top of mind.”

The governor’s budget also adjusted the state’s share of retirement costs for teachers, community college staff and librarians to save \$39 million, shifting more of it to local governments. There was also a \$27 million cut to disparity grant funding, which helps low-income jurisdictions support essential services, affecting Baltimore City and counties

including Prince George’s and several on the Eastern Shore and in Western Maryland.

The governor’s office declined to respond to questions Wednesday about county leaders’ concerns, whether the state plans to provide additional relief to local governments and how the administration plans to address potential impacts on cities and counties because of projected budget shortfalls in future years.

Maryland economists cautioned that taxpayers could lose essential programs if the state continues pushing costs to the local level.

Daraius Irani, vice president of business and public engagement at Towson University, said counties have limited ability to make up higher costs through income taxes because state law caps their local income-tax rates at half the state’s rate. That limits how much additional revenue counties can raise to cover high-

er costs, Irani said.

JP Krahel, an accounting professor at Loyola University Maryland, said shifting more costs to counties could widen differences in public services between wealthier and poorer jurisdictions because communities with larger tax bases have more revenue to draw from.

“Municipalities that have wealthier people living in more expensive homes with higher property taxes can afford better equipment for teachers (and) better public services, and that further increases property value. And it kind of creates this tiered system where those homes in lower value neighborhoods are suffering,” Krahel said.

As state and local budgets remain under pressure, county officials say the challenge will be keeping emergency services staffed without asking taxpayers to pay more.

VIRGINIA

A mystery in the commonwealth: What has happened to the piping plover?

BY DAVE RESS
Richmond Times-Dispatch

There's a mystery on the wide Atlantic beaches of the Virginia Eastern Shore's unique barrier islands: What's happening to the little piping plovers that nest there?

It's why when state wildlife biologist Ruth Boettcher makes her weekly rounds on the islands, checking on the shallow nests the plovers scoop out, she's afraid of what she'll find.

"I'll see a missing egg, with only two, or one egg left or sometimes an entirely empty nest," she said. "We didn't used to see that."

Now, as the plovers begin flying south to their winter homes in the Bahamas, she's seen just one chick from 14 breeding pairs on Cedar Island, down from over 50 pairs a decade ago. Last year, there were 5 chicks.

On Metompkin Island, just three chicks fledged, down from 12 in 2025. Breeding pair numbers are down, too.

Not that 2025 was a great year. Overall, along the 75-mile-

long string of Eastern Shore barrier islands, Boettcher's Department of Wildlife Resources team, along with partners from the Nature Conservancy and the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, counted just 115 breeding pairs, down from a peak of 291 in 2016. The number hasn't been that low since 2003.

That was the year the scouring winds and huge waves from Hurricane Isabel created new stretches of the wide, flat beaches on which piping plovers nest.

The storm cleared vegetation from the mudflats behind the islands where plovers search for the bugs and worms they feast on.

In Isabel's wake, more and more plovers started coming to Virginia to breed — climbing steadily up from 114 pairs the spring before Isabel hit.

But after 2016, the numbers have dropped steadily.

While the final numbers aren't in yet, what Boettcher has seen on Cedar and Metompkin isn't encouraging.

And it's not obvious why.



CRAIG E. WALKER/BOSTON GLOBE/GETTY IMAGES

A piping plover walks along a beach, but their kind are dwindling.

Virginia's barrier islands are basically a natural preserve. Except for the National Seashore at Assateague and NASA's Wallops Island, they're only reachable by boat.

The Eastern Shore "is one of

the few areas where piping plovers have been reliably seen during Spring migration and summer," said Roberta Kellam, of Birding Eastern Shore.

But "the piping plovers are found exclusively on the Barrier

Islands, which are fairly inaccessible," she said. People who make the trip to a barrier island are asked to stay below the high tide line between April and August — it's too easy to step on a shallow plover's nest before you see it.

"They are not only a special sight because they are rare, but also because they are quite adorable. Small, plump, smartly-plumaged, the perfect sand-color accentuated with smart black markings," Kellam said.

Nobody's hunting piping plovers these days, as they did decades ago, when the birds were driven nearly to extinction to feed a millinery-driven fashion trend.

But there aren't any other obvious signs of trouble. The coastal development that encroaches on wildlife habitat in other states isn't a factor on the barrier islands.

It wasn't really all that hot this spring, as the birds arrived and the males started the rapid, stiff-legged goose-stepping that kicks off their courtship dance.

There was enough rain to keep

the mudflats from drying out, which can make it hard for the plovers to poke in to find their meals.

There weren't the kind of storms that push waves high enough on the beach to drown plovers' nests.

On the other hand, there weren't storms to clear encroaching vegetation from the mudflats — over the years, the acreage of flats where the plovers can feed has shrunk.

Boettcher and her team had cleared pathways across Cedar Island's dunes to make it easier for the plovers to reach the flats, but she hasn't seen any signs they're using it.

Sometimes, she'll spot eggshells by a ghost crab burrow. Sometimes, there's no clue about where the eggs have gone.

And why fewer plovers do their stiff-legged courting, scoop out their shallow nests or do their broken wing displays to discourage predators than they used to, no one knows.

"Truly, it's a real mystery," Boettcher said.

MARYLAND

Teenage boy describes fighting off a rabid beaver that bit his chest and hands

BY CALEB OGILVIE
Frederick News-Post

Dominick Cebula can't feel anything in one of his fingers, two of his knuckles and part of his chest since a rabid beaver attacked him on July 26.

And he wants people to know that the beaver attacked him, not the other way around.

"I did not mess with it," said Dominick, who lives in Walkersville and turned 14 on Aug. 12. "I was just swimming, and it just came out of nowhere."

The attack left Dominick's hands and chest severely injured, he and his father, Jeffrey Cebula, said in interviews with the Frederick News-Post.

After treatments, surgeries and follow-up doctor appointments, Dominick has been fully treated for rabies and his stitches are out, they said. But he still can't feel anything in some parts of his body and will have another surgery to reattach a damaged nerve.

In response to the incident, the Maryland Department of Natural Resources closed swimming access to Hunting Creek Lake in Cunningham Falls State Park, where the attack occurred, according to an Aug. 5 press release.

Employees started watching for beavers in the area.

Another rabid beaver bit a 19-year-old 10 days later about 250 yards from where Dominick was bitten, a DNR spokesperson previously said. The department then closed additional areas around the lake, according to the Aug. 5 press release.

Another beaver bit a 10-year-old in Montgomery County's Seneca Creek State Park eight days later. A dead beaver in the park

tested positive for rabies on Wednesday, but health and DNR officials don't know if that's the same beaver, according to a DNR press release updated Wednesday.

After Dominick was bitten, he spent the rest of his day in the hospital while DNR closed the beach and started its search. Doctors treated him for rabies and closed his wounds. There have been follow-up doctor appointments and he will undergo another surgery to fix nerve damage in his hand.

The following account is based on interviews with Dominick and Jeffrey Cebula, who was not at the lake when Dominick was bitten but said he's familiar with the events.

The bite started with fish.

Dominick was swimming near the north shore of Hunting Creek Lake, the water up to his chest. Dominick saw fish and submerged underwater to look at them.

Alishia Cebula, Dominick's mother, saw something coming toward her son but didn't know what it was.

She yelled for Dominick, but he was diving underwater and didn't hear her.

It turned out a beaver was swimming toward Dominick.

"He did not see it coming," Jeffrey Cebula said.

The beaver latched on to Dominick's chest. Dominick grabbed it by the neck and leg to try to throw it off.

The beaver didn't come off initially.

"It kind of started shaking its head, kind of making the bite worse, almost like a dog," Jeffrey Cebula said.

The beaver eventually let go. Dominick started backing away,

but the beaver jumped on him again and bit Dominick's left hand, then let go.

Then Dominick put his right hand up, and the beaver bit it.

When Alishia Cebula got to the beaver, she splashed the water and the beaver turned around and swam away.

Dominick saw his wounds immediately.

"I knew what it looked like because I saw it as soon as it happened," he said. "I remember looking down at my chest and my hands, so I knew what it looked like."

Dominick's right hand was especially "messed up," he said.

"I thought they were going to have to amputate my finger because the bite was down to the bone," he said.

Dominick ran out of the water and onto the shore. His mother gave him a towel to hold over his chest and ran to a nearby restroom to ask people to call 911.

One person went to Dominick's younger brother to pack up the family's belongings.

Alishia Cebula sat down with Dominick and tried to calm him until first responders arrived.

"They're way out at the lake, so it's not nearby the city, so the ambulance took a little while to get there," Jeffrey Cebula said.

When first responders arrived, they worried the beaver could have punctured a lung, so they needed to get Dominick to a hospital.

An ambulance took Dominick to a helicopter, which took him to Johns Hopkins Hospital.

While Dominick was flown to the hospital, his family drove. Alishia Cebula used a first responder's phone to contact her husband because her phone had

bad reception in the area.

Dominick said he remembers doctors asking him how he felt and where he felt pain after he got off the helicopter. Doctors treated him in an emergency room near the helipad.

"After like 30 minutes, I got put into my own room and that's where I stayed for, like, the rest of the time until I went into surgery," he said.

If someone has been exposed to rabies and hasn't been vaccinated for the disease or treated before their exposure, they receive human rabies immune globulin, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's web page. They also receive four vaccine injections over the next two weeks.

Dominick said he already had an IV, so doctors told him he wouldn't have to get a separate injection for his first rabies treatment.

The doctors sedated him during the treatment.

The process for treating rabies is predetermined, Jeffrey Cebula said, so doctors didn't talk that much about treating Dominick for rabies.

Instead, they talked about another task: reattaching and closing up Dominick's skin.

"Not to get too graphic, but there was a lot that was missing," Jeffrey Cebula said, referring to the chest bite. "There was a large gap."

A plastic surgeon was able to close up Dominick's chest.

"They were able to pull it together, and today it's healing really well," his father said.

The beaver didn't puncture the lung, either, alleviating an initial concern.

Dominick said he doesn't remember the treatment.

"The only thing I remember is waking up and everything looking and feeling really weird," he said.

A doctor tested Dominick's hands for nerve damage and determined them to be okay.

But Dominick still doesn't feel anything in parts of his hands and in a small part of his chest.

"I can't feel temperature [or] my pain," he said, referring to the numb parts. "I can't feel, like, anything."

Jeffrey Cebula said Dominick will need another surgery to fix a severed nerve in his right hand.

Feelings in the left hand and chest will come back without surgery, he said.

After Dominick left the hospital and got home, he watched movies and took medicine. It didn't help as much as the treatment at the hospital.

"It was actually more pain at home than at the hospital because I couldn't really take any medicine other than ibuprofen and Tylenol," he said.

He was in pain, he said, but couldn't see the source. Bandages covered it up.

"It's been like an unnoticeable, slow recovery," he said.

During the Tuesday interview, 23 days after the attack, Dominick said he wasn't in pain.

The beaver bit Dominick days before a planned Cebula family vacation to Chincoteague.

Jeffrey Cebula said the family planned the vacation to start on July 29. Dominick was bitten on July 26.

But Jeffrey and Alishia Cebula still wanted their son to get out.

"We wanted him to kind of get distracted," Jeffrey Cebula said.

So, they went to Ocean City.

Dominick's arms were bandaged from fingertip to elbow,

though, his father said, so he couldn't get in the water or go on the boardwalk rides.

That also meant strangers started asking questions. When the strangers learned he was attacked by a beaver, they realized they already knew about Dominick and the attack.

"I mean, people from everywhere heard about it and knew about it and were really nice and did a lot of kind things," Jeffrey Cebula said.

After talking to strangers about the attack, the family warmed up to talking about it with the public — with Dominick's permission.

"All the interactions we had out in public with strangers and even with family and friends who wanted to talk about it — he was very open about it and OK with it," Jeffrey Cebula said.

Dominick said he doesn't mind people asking him about the attack.

"It was just really, like, shocking to know that people from Ocean City, even, knew about it," he said.

The family had previously debated whether to talk about the incident, Jeffrey Cebula said.

"We don't do a lot of big social gatherings," he said. "We don't hang out in big crowds. Most of the time, if we're hanging out, we're hanging out with family. We have a very small circle."

Dominick's aunt encouraged the family to share Dominick's story and started a GoFundMe to raise \$1,000 to help with medical costs.

Dominick has another surgery ahead of him. Jeffrey Cebula said he hopes his son will be healed by October so he can practice wrestling for Walkersville High School.

VIRGINIA

Budget cuts could strain behavioral health crisis response times in state

BY KATE SELTZER
Virginian-Pilot

The budget that recently took effect in Virginia includes provisions that mean Medicaid will no longer reimburse providers for certain behavioral health services.

Subject to federal approval, the Department of Medical Assistance Services, which administers Medicaid at the state level, will no longer pay for a service called community stabilization. And the agency will shorten the availability of mobile crisis response from eight hours per incident to four.

When someone is experiencing a behavioral or mental health crisis, they can call 988 and get connected to a call center that provides 24-hour crisis counseling over the phone. If there's an immediate threat to health and safety, that might require response for EMS or police.

But mobile crisis response is an alternative, where professionals come to the person in crisis and offer on-scene evaluation, treatment and intervention.

One step down from mobile crisis response is community stabilization — that's what happens in the aftermath of a behavioral or mental health crisis. It's not an emergency response, but the goal is to avoid hospitalization by providing in-home or community-based crisis services and counseling.

The changes to access to crisis

services for Medicaid patients could mean more hospitalizations, and they will impact how providers are able to be reimbursed for that care. If fewer private entities are willing or able to treat Medicaid patients, community service boards could face a rising demand to step in and help.

"Typically community service boards function in the capacity to provide indigent care or unreimbursed care, because private entities don't typically do that work," said Brandon Rodgers, executive director of the Western Tidewater Community Services Board, which serves as a regional hub for crisis services across the region.

"By not having that as a covered service for Medicaid recipients, we're likely to see more service referrals to the CSBs to support care that isn't being paid for (with Medicaid)."

In fiscal 2026, which ended in June, DMAS paid out about \$223 million for mobile crisis response for Medicaid members. About 22,000 Medicaid users received the service, which cost an average of roughly \$10,000. Of that group, 52 percent of patients were Black and 44 percent were white. About half of the patients had depressive disorders as their primary diagnosis; 21 percent had bipolar and related disorders, 18 percent had schizophrenia and other disorders, and 16% had trauma and stressor-related disorders.

Likewise, DMAS paid out about \$95 million for Medicaid members for community stabilization services. About 12,000 people received those services, averaging about \$7,700 per member. Most of the Medicaid patients who received the services were Black, and the majority of the primary diagnoses prompting a response were depressive disorders, followed by bipolar and related disorders and schizophrenia and other psychotic disorders.

In total, the changes in the state budget would save about \$300 million in spending.

State Sen. Creigh Deeds, D-Charlottesville, campaigned for years for better access to behavioral health services after his son, in the midst of a mental health crisis, stabbed him before taking his own life. Deeds was unable to secure a bed for his son the day before the tragedy.

Deeds said cuts at the federal level, including to Medicaid, had lawmakers concerned.

"We'll get through it, but it's going to be tough," he said. "It's going to make everything tight."

And, the legislature was concerned about significant instances of fraud. Between 2022 and 2026, a the operator of a mental health agency based in Richmond is alleged to have fraudulently billed Medicaid for more than \$49.6 million for community stabilization and mobile crisis re-

sponse services.

"I don't think the clientele is to be blamed for what's going on, but there are some things that we've been concerned about that has caused us to reexamine some of those programs," Deeds said.

He said reducing access points to behavioral health care is a concern but that lawmakers have to be smart about how they spend that money.

"That means that when we smell money that's going out the door — not to provide services to people that need help, but that is perhaps being spent in other ways — we've got to examine it," he said. "We've got to tighten up, and we've got to make sure we're spending in the right places. I'm worried, but I think that we have to make sure that we have spending under control, too."

The budget changes shouldn't interfere with the quality of care, Rodgers with the Western Tidewater Community Services Board said. That is, mobile crisis responders shouldn't bail on someone in crisis at the four-hour mark just because that person is a Medicaid recipient.

But it will be harder for responders to get reimbursed for that work. And if there are fewer routes for care in the wake of a mental health crisis, that could strain an already overloaded hospital system.

The Department of Behavioral

Health and Developmental Services maintains a dashboard of the current occupancy rate at department state hospitals for children and adults. As of Monday, those hospitals were 99.3% full statewide for adults, and 100% full for children.

Private psychiatric units can provide additional capacity, but state hospitals are required to admit people if another bed can't be located after eight hours in cases where a temporary detention order is recommended, Rodgers said.

"When the state hospital census reaches such critical levels, safely admitting individuals in need of treatment can be delayed, making community-based services like community stabilization

and mobile crisis response all the more necessary to provide proactive alternatives to inpatient care," he said.

Rodgers said it feels like a step backward in terms of the work the state has done in the past several years to expand community supports and reduce hospitalizations.

"There's going to be an ambulance that comes to your door if you're having a heart attack," Rodgers said. "If you're suicidal, and in need of urgent behavioral health intervention, we're right now made up of a mix of private and public resources to come and respond to your door. There's not that same level of parity in behavioral health, but there is a similar level of risk to life and safety."

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OBITUARIES

KING HARALD V OF NORWAY, 89



FRANCISCO SECO/AP

King Harald V of Norway, shown in 2019, was the country's first native-born prince since 1370.

Norway's king, who fled the Nazis as a child, modernized its monarchy

BY VICTORIA CRAW

Norway's King Harald V, who fled Adolf Hitler's invasion with his family to take refuge in the White House as a boy, and who later helped modernize the country's monarchy during his popular 35-year reign, died Friday at a hospital in Oslo. He was 89.

His death was announced by Norway's royal family, which did not cite a cause.

Norway's Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Store said the "whole nation is in mourning" in a statement Friday, adding that King Harald had "helped us to see the best in ourselves — and in one another."

"King Harald had a profound love for Norway. And Norway had a profound love for King Harald," he said. Other ruling families from across Europe including the United Kingdom, Denmark, Sweden and the Netherlands shared tributes, alongside political leaders.

The Norwegian ruler was spirited to safety as a child while war gripped Europe. He spent his formative years in the United States before returning home at age 8, furnished with an American accent and a memory of standing behind President Franklin D. Roosevelt at his inauguration.

As an adult, King Harald defied tradition by marrying commoner Sonja Haraldsen in 1968. Their marriage shocked the establishment and sparked warnings of the monarchy's downfall but proved to be one of several ways he charted his own course as ruler. The couple were married more than five decades.

The avid sportsman and nature lover represented his country in sailing at three Olympic Games — Tokyo in 1964, Mexico City in 1968 and in Munich 1972 — before finally declaring an end to his competitive days in 2022, at age 85. He led the Norwegian chapter of the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) for 20 years and is the first king to have a portion of the Arctic named after him.

As leader of Norway's constitutional monarchy, King Harald had a largely ceremonial role. But he endeared himself to the country of 5.6 million with his emotional openness and support of diversity and religious tolerance. He sought to modernize and make the monarchy more transparent, engaging in media interviews and publishing annual financial reports.

In 1997, King Harald publicly apologized to the Arctic Sami people for government efforts to eradicate their culture over more than two centuries. In the aftermath of the 2011 massacre in which far-right extremist Anders Behring Breivik killed 77 people in a bombing and shooting rampage, he drew praise for a speech in which he struggled to contain his emotions while trying to console the nation. During the speech, he reiterated his belief in a strong, multicultural society.

In 2016, he went viral for his passionate speech at a royal palace garden party in support of diversity, religious tolerance and LGBTQ rights.

"Norwegians are enthusiastic young people — and wise old people. Norwegians are single, divorced, families with children



AMANDA PEDERSEN GISKE/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

King Harald talks with members of the Norwegian national soccer team, including goalkeeper Orjan Nyland, center, in July.

and old married couples. Norwegians are girls who love girls, boys who love boys, and girls and boys who love each other. Norwegians believe in God, Allah, the Universe and nothing," he said at the time.

"In other words," he added, "Norway is *you*."

King Harald V was born Feb. 21, 1937, at Skaugum, outside Oslo, the first Norwegian-born prince in 567 years, after the country's earlier union with Denmark and Sweden. His grandfather, King Haakon VII, became Norway's sovereign in 1905, establishing a new independent monarchy. The family are relatives of Britain's royals, and King Harald and Queen Elizabeth II were second cousins.

He was the third child of Crown Prince Olav and Crown Princess Märtha, who already had two daughters. But at the time, only male heirs could inherit the throne, ensuring his place in the line of succession. (This was amended in 1990 so that the eldest child takes precedence, regardless of gender.)

His peaceful early childhood was shattered when German troops invaded the country in April 1940. As members of the government and royal family sought to escape the capital by train, Princess Märtha fled to Sweden with her three children and sailed on to the United States at Roosevelt's invitation.

In the U.S., they stayed at the White House and at Roosevelt's home in Hyde Park, New York, while King Harald's father and grandfather escaped to London to set up a government in exile. Princess Märtha and the children eventually settled in a Tudor-style mansion north of Bethesda.

King Harald would speak of his time in the U.S. fondly, saying in a 1999 speech to President Bill Clinton that he clearly remembered "standing right behind President Roosevelt when he was sworn in." Images show the Norwegian royal children standing on the White House steps at the time.

In 2015, King Harald said in a speech in Seattle that he was "deeply grateful for the generosity and hospitality we felt throughout those five years in the United States."

"Your country has had a special place in my heart ever since," he added.

Upon returning home in 1945, King Harald attended school in Oslo before training at a military academy and studying at the University of Oxford in Britain.

When Haakon died in September 1957, he became Crown Prince, working alongside his father, King Olav V, before ascending to the throne after his father's death in 1991.

Survivors include Queen Sonja; two children, Princess Märtha Louise and Crown Prince Haakon, who will succeed him as king; an elder sister, Princess Astrid; and two grandchildren.

While initially controversial, King Harald and Sonja's love story endeared them to the Norwegian public. In 2016, the couple shared unseen photos of their courtship with Norway's national broadcaster, NRK, describing how they met in 1959, when Crown Prince Harald was 22, and quickly fell in love.

Though filled with guilt over expectations he would marry a member of European nobility, King Harald said attempts to end their romance amid disapproval from the establishment and Norwegian press were not "entirely successful." He ended up delivering his father an ultimatum: If he could not marry Sonja, he would remain unmarried. Olav relented, and the couple married at Oslo Cathedral.

Crown Prince Haakon's decision to marry a former waitress and single mother in 2001 would also draw controversy. King Harald supported their relationship, and the fairy-tale wedding drew thousands of flag-waving well-wishers.

The royal family has faced controversy this year, with Crown Princess Mette-Marit under scrutiny for her friendship with the late sex offender Jeffrey Epstein. Files released as part of a U.S. Justice Department investigation revealed more than 100 messages between Mette-Marit and the disgraced financier. Mette-Marit also came under the spotlight this summer after her eldest son, Marius, was convicted of rape and sentenced to four years in prison. King Harald said he had sympathy for "all those affected" by the trial, and declined to comment on his daughter-in-law's ties to Epstein.

Being a sovereign, he once said, was a "lifelong learning period." But he said he believed the monarchy is in good hands with his son. In 2024, he announced a permanent reduction in duties, citing health issues, but ruled out abdicating as monarch, saying the oath he swore "lasts for life."

"It's that simple for me. We're going to keep going until the bitter end."

IN MEMORIAM

WALKER



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DEATH NOTICE

DINAN



PATRICIA BRAINARD DINAN "Pat"
Patricia "Pat" Brainard Dinan of Arlington, Virginia passed away peacefully on July 22, 2026, after a short illness. Born in New Haven, Connecticut on September 6, 1930, she was the daughter of the late Howard and Theresa Brainard. Pat attended Beaver College for Women in Jenkintown, Pennsylvania and graduated from Traphagen School of Design in New York City.

She was preceded in death by Daniel James Dinan, her beloved husband of 59 years. She is survived by her sons Kevin Dinan and James Dinan; her daughters-in-law Christen Dinan and Monica Dinan; her grandchildren, Matthew Dinan, Kaitlin Dinan Kimball, Stephanie Dinan, Casey Dinan, and Tyler Dinan; and her great grandchildren Teddy Dinan, Emely Kimball, Jesse Kimball, and Annie Dinan. Along with her family, Pat's greatest joys were reading and spending time at her second home in Vermont.

There will be a memorial visitation on Saturday, October 24, 2026 from 4 to 6 pm at Murphy's Funeral Home, 4510 Wilson Boulevard, Arlington, Virginia 22203. Interment will be private. In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made to St. Jude Children's Research Hospital. An online guidebook is available at www.murphyfuneralhomes.com.



RENARD



DONNA MACKENZIE RENARD (Age 91)
Donna Mackenzie Renard, of Charlottesville, Virginia, passed away on August 7, 2026, following a remarkable life defined by family, love, laughter, resilience, and a lifelong connection to the United States Navy.

Born July 20, 1935, in San Diego, California, Donna was the daughter of George Kenneth Mackenzie and Josephine Moore Mackenzie. Her father, a 1931 United States Naval Academy graduate and submarine officer, was killed in action during World War II as Commander of the USS Triton (SS-201). Her mother died of illness soon after.

Donna's greatest legacy lives in her family, treasured friendships, stories, and the generations who will continue telling them.

Donna graduated from Connecticut College of Women in 1957 and that year married Navy Lieutenant John "Jack" W. Renard, USNA Class of 1955. Their marriage lasted more than 67 years as they raised their family through 42 years of Navy life.

At age 9, Donna sponsored the USS George K. Mackenzie (DD-836), christened in 1945 in honor of her father. She returned for its decommissioning in 1976, completing a remarkable connection to her father and the Navy.

Predeceased by Jack, Donna is survived by her children, Kathryn "Kitt" Renard Murphy, LtCol John Mackenzie Renard, USAF Retired (Kathy); and Josephine "Josie" Renard Barondess (David); seven grandchildren; and nine great-grandchildren.

Donna will be inurned with Jack at the United States Naval Academy Columbarium in Annapolis, Maryland, following a private family service.

ROLANDI



MARY DODGE MCREYNOLDS ROLANDI "Molly"
Mary "Molly" Dodge McReynolds Rolandi, a proud native Washingtonian, passed away peacefully on August 22, 2026, at the age of 74, with her husband, daughter, and cherished dog by her side.

Born on August 11, 1952, to Doris Hamilton Gil, Molly spent her life deeply connected to the D.C. area. She graduated from the National Cathedral School in 1970, briefly attended Hollins College, and earned her degree from Georgetown University in 1974. In 1978, Molly married Frederick "Rick" Sereno Rolandi, beginning 48 devoted years of marriage. They were wed at the Church of the Epiphany - a meaningful continuation of family history, as her great-grandparents married in the very same sanctuary in 1860. A dynamic businesswoman, philanthropist, and arts advocate, Molly was deeply committed to enriching Washington's cultural and civic life. Her passion for the arts was exemplified by her extensive leadership at the Corcoran Museum of Art, where she served on the Board of Trustees and held numerous leadership roles on the Corcoran Women's Committee after joining in 2005. Together, Molly and Rick were steadfast champions of D.C.'s artistic institutions and emerging local talent, supporting Hillwood, the National Gallery of Art, Choral Arts, and The Phillips Collection. She was also a valued member of The Sulgrave Club since 2011.

Beyond her civic contributions, Molly was defined by her long-standing friendships, her natural charisma, and a unique ability to bring people together. A true sun-lover, nothing brought her more peace than a warm summer afternoon - soaking up the sun, drifting off to sleep with a good book while her family was nearby. Her home and heart were always anchored by her fierce love for her four-legged companions, and she cherished each one dearly over the years: Whiskers, Bogart, Archie, and her faithful Freddie Mac.

She is survived by her husband, Rick; her daughter, Lee; compassionate caregiver, Am-sale Seyoum; and her devoted chosen family, Alma (Kathleen) Nivet.

A memorial service will be held at 11 am on Tuesday, September 1, 2026, in the sanctuary of All Saints Church, 3 Chevy Chase Circle, Chevy Chase, Maryland, 20815. A reception and lunch will immediately follow at the Chevy Chase Club.

In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made in Molly's memory to the Montgomery County Humane Society.



SHEEHAN



MICHAEL SHEEHAN
Michael Sheehan passed away on Monday, August 24, 2026. Sharing his life with his wife Elaine, he was fiercely proud of his family, quiet in his love and generous in his kindness. Deflecting the spotlight, he always made sure the light shone on others. Mike was the moral compass of the family, sage advisor, red pen editor, Captain of the English language, marathon runner, coach and Washington football fan.

Michael was husband to the late Elaine (Downs) Sheehan and the son of Charline (Springguth) Sheehan and Edwin A. Sheehan, brother to the late Brian "Puddy" Sheehan and survived by sister Patricia Heister. He leaves a legacy through his daughters and sons-in-law: Diane Winchester (Keith), Julie Rock (Dean) and Kerry Fries (Ted), grandchildren Michael, Allie, Erin, Meagan, Finn.

The Funeral Mass will be celebrated at 11:30 am on Saturday, August 29, 2026, at Shrine of the Most Blessed Sacrament, 3630 Quesada St. NW, Washington DC. Interment Private.

In lieu of flowers, gifts in memory of Michael Sheehan may be directed to support Dr. Govind Warrier's melanoma and skin cancer research at Johns Hopkins Kimmel Cancer Center, 750 East Pratt Street, Suite 1700, Baltimore, MD 21202. Please make checks payable to Johns Hopkins University with a memo indicating that this gift is "in memory of Michael Sheehan, to Dr. Warrier's research". Online gifts: <https://secure.jhu.edu/form/Warrier>

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SULLIVAN



WILLIAM F. SULLIVAN "Bill"
William F. Sullivan, 87, passed away on July 25, 2026, at Goodwin House Alexandria in Virginia.

Bill was born to Helene O'Neill Sullivan and Joseph David Sullivan and raised in Norwalk, Connecticut, where he graduated from the Fairfield College Preparatory School. His college years were spent at Duquesne University, where he earned a bachelor's degree in English, History and Education.

After serving in the U.S. Army for two years, Bill settled in Arlington, Virginia, where he began his 38 year career with the Arlington Public School system. His first job was as a Job Placement Coordinator at The George Mason Center where he implemented programs for students with disabilities. During that time he placed hundreds of students in supportive job placements, many of whom became permanently employed by and eventually retired from the Federal government.

In 1975 Bill was hired as a Program Coordinator for Students with Special Needs at the Arlington Career Center where he eventually retired as the Center's Director in 2004. During his time there he continued his education, earning a Master's degree in Special Education and a Doctorate in Counseling and Human Development, both from The George Washington University.

Bill was a Licensed Professional Counselor and served as a consultant for the United States Government's Senior Executive Service members on effective leadership practices and also as a Research Associate at Children's National Medical Center where he trained several medical residents in developing skills to effectively communicate with parents of children with Acute Lymphocytic Leukemia.

At different times between 1983 and 1988, Bill taught as an Adjunct Professor at Trinity College, The George Washington University and George Mason University. Bill never tired or wavered in his love of education and of helping students find their passion. Given the opportunity he would talk to anyone interested in furthering their education or assist them in making it happen.

At a "singles" dance at the Washington Hotel in the 60's, Bill met his future wife, Bea. His kindness, integrity and beautiful singing voice, not to mention his Irish good looks, won Bea over and they married in 1968. They were blessed with two children, a daughter and a son.

In 2018 Bill was diagnosed with Alzheimer's disease. To no one's surprise, he rose above the disease, living his final years with courage, kindness, dignity and song - "Danny Boy" being his longtime favorite and a song he would sing to anyone willing to listen. Bill was a wonderful husband, father, adoring "Pa" to his grandchildren, brother and friend, respected by all and loved by so many. He will be deeply missed.

Bill was preceded in death by his parents, Joseph and Helene Sullivan. In addition to his wife, Bea, of 58 years, Bill is survived by his children, daughter Erin (Chris) son, Matthew (Elana); grandchildren Nicholas and Patrick Lee and Jonah, Rowan and Ryan Sullivan; brother Dave (Anneliese); niece, Barbara Sullivan; nephew Stefan Sullivan (Marina) and their sons, Bruno and Lucas.

A Memorial Mass will be held on Friday, September 18, 2026, at 4:00 pm at Blessed Sacrament Catholic Church, Alexandria, VA, with a reception immediately following at Goodwin House, Alexandria, VA.

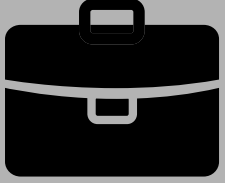
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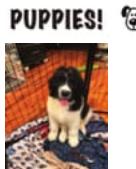
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POODLES - Toy, AKC, Parents, Home raised, UTD shots, dewormers, folder kit that includes 30 free days of AKC health insurance. There are 2 males left they are Black/Tri color!
Puppies are 12 weeks old and ready to go to their new homes (8/20/26)
Price is \$1300 per puppy.
Please text or call me at 703-498-7755.
Thank you!

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THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

Plan to be outside

It will be sunny, with a high near 86 degrees and northeast winds between 5 and 7 mph during the day. In the evening, the skies will turn partly cloudy, with a low around 68. Southeast winds around 5 mph will become calmer as the night proceeds.

AccuWeather FORECAST

Today
Partly sunny



85° **70°**

REALFEEL®: **88°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **0%**
WIND: **ENE 6-12 mph**
HUMIDITY: **Low**

Sunday
A stray t-shower



91° **74°**

REALFEEL®: **96°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **55%**
WIND: **S 6-12 mph**
HUMIDITY: **High**

Monday
Mostly sunny



90° **76°**

REALFEEL®: **98°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **25%**
WIND: **NE 4-8 mph**
HUMIDITY: **High**

Tuesday
A t-storm around



94° **75°**

REALFEEL®: **97°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **55%**
WIND: **SSW 4-8 mph**
HUMIDITY: **Very High**

Wednesday
Partly sunny and hot



93° **77°**

REALFEEL®: **100°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **10%**
WIND: **SSW 6-12 mph**
HUMIDITY: **Very High**

Thursday
A p.m. t-storm or two

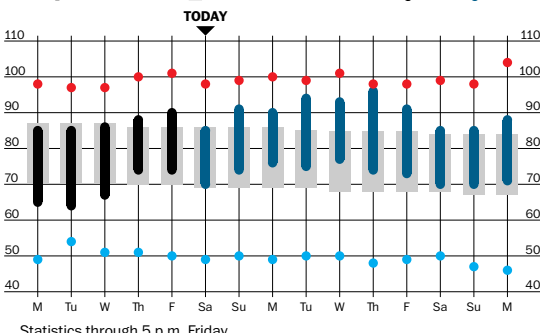


96° **74°**

REALFEEL®: **100°**
CHANCE PRECIP: **65%**
WIND: **W 6-12 mph**
HUMIDITY: **Very High**

OFFICIAL RECORD

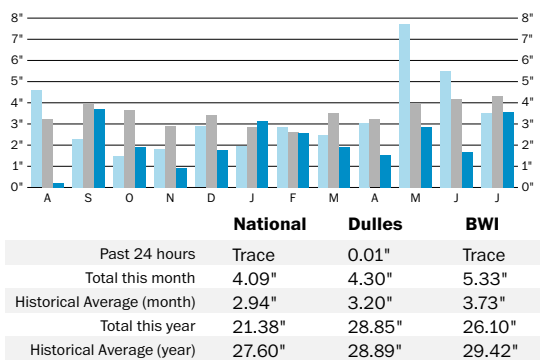
Temperatures



Statistics through 5 p.m. Friday			
National			
High	90° 4:00 p.m.	88° 3:27 p.m.	86° 3:08 p.m.
Low	74° 7:00 a.m.	69° 5:25 a.m.	70° 2:00 a.m.
Historical Average 86°/70°			
Record high 101° 2024			
Record low 50° 1874			

Difference from 30-yr. avg. (National): this month: **+0.6°** yr. to date: **+0.3°**

Precipitation



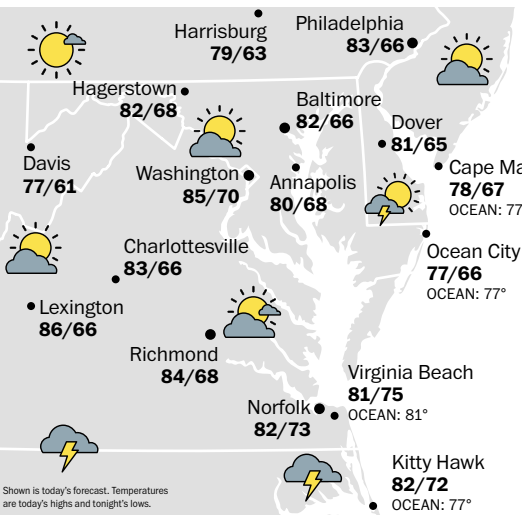
Moon Phases

Phase	Day
Last Quarter	Sep 4
New	Sep 10
First Quarter	Sep 18
Full	Sep 26

Solar system

Planet	Rise	Set
Sun	6:34 a.m.	7:43 p.m.
Moon	8:21 p.m.	7:59 a.m.
Venus	10:24 a.m.	9:16 p.m.
Mars	2:03 a.m.	4:54 p.m.
Jupiter	4:38 a.m.	6:42 p.m.
Saturn	9:20 p.m.	9:45 a.m.

REGION TODAY



Pollen: Moderate
Grass: Moderate
Trees: Low
Weeds: Moderate
Mold: Moderate

Air Quality: Good
Main pollutant: Particulates

UV: High
6 out of 11+

Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, partly sunny. High 80. Winds east 4-8 mph. Tonight, mainly clear, fog will reduce visibilities late. Low 63. • **Great Smoky Mtns. National Park:** Today, mostly sunny, less humid. High 73. Winds south 4-8 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 61. Winds south 4-8 mph.

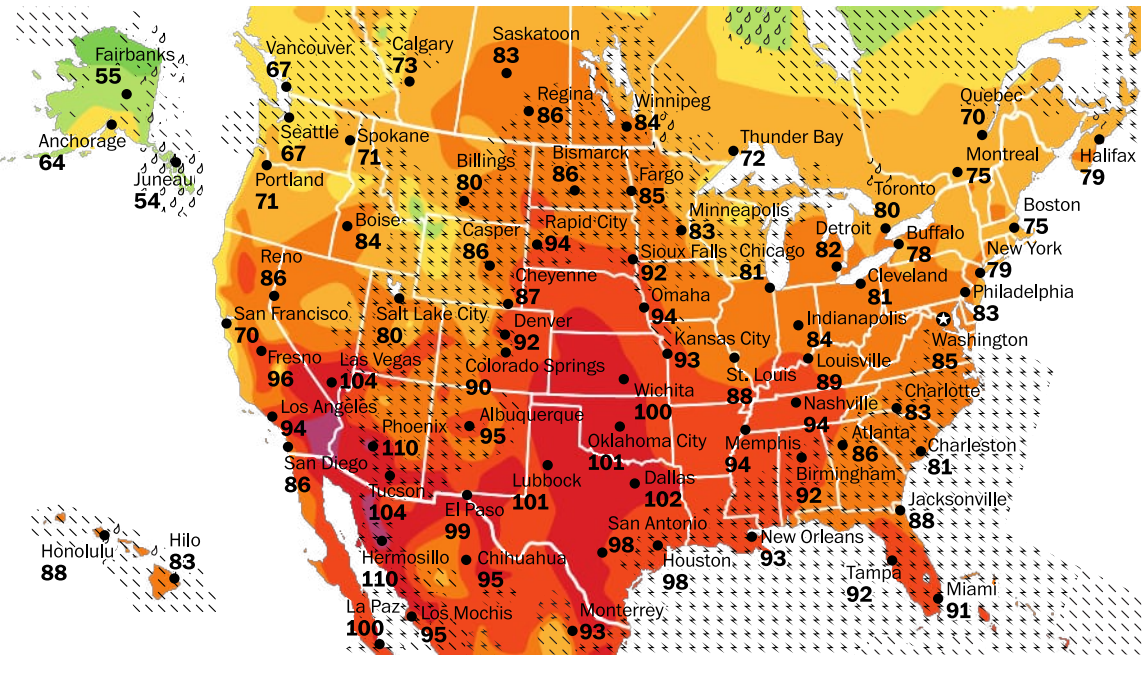
Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, mostly cloudy, less humid. High 77. Winds northeast 7-14 mph. Tonight, partly cloudy. Low 66. Winds east-southeast 4-8 mph. • **Virginia Beach:** Today, a thick cloud cover, humid, a thunderstorm on the prowl this afternoon. High 81. Winds northeast 7-14 mph. Tonight, partly cloudy.

Waterways: Upper Potomac River: Today, mostly cloudy, a thunderstorm around in the afternoon. Wind northeast 4-8 knots. Waves 0-1 foot. • **Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay:** Today, cloudy, a thunderstorm in the afternoon. Wind north 6-12 knots. Waves 1-2 feet on the Lower Potomac; 1-3 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • **River Stages:** The stage at Little Falls will be around 3.10 feet today, rising to 3.20 Sunday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides

Location	High	Low
Washington	4:05 a.m.	9:27 a.m.
Annapolis	12:18 a.m.	6:34 a.m.
Ocean City	2:51 a.m.	8:55 a.m.
Norfolk	4:43 a.m.	10:57 a.m.
Point Lookout	2:33 a.m.	9:11 a.m.

NATION TODAY



Weather	Temperature
Shows	88°
T-storms	94°
Rain	90°
Flurries	76°
Snow	76°
Ice	76°

Yesterday's National High: El Centro, CA **113°** Low: Leadville, CO **37°** For the 48 contiguous states

Yesterday's World High: Basrah, Iraq **122°** Low: Shogolotsky, Russia **23°** Excludes Antarctica

National	Today	Tomorrow
Albany, NY	78/58/s	80/63/p
Albuquerque	95/68/t	92/67/c
Anchorage	64/47/p	59/48/p
Atlanta	86/73/t	87/72/t
Austin	100/74/s	100/75/s
Baltimore	82/66/p	89/72/p
Billings, MT	80/58/p	73/51/p
Birmingham	92/73/s	91/74/s
Bismarck, ND	86/64/t	81/54/t
Boise	84/51/s	77/53/s
Boston	75/64/s	85/69/p
Buffalo	78/63/p	77/65/c
Burlington, VT	79/61/s	79/62/p
Charleston, SC	81/74/t	88/74/t
Charlotte, WV	87/67/p	89/67/s
Charlotte	83/71/t	88/72/t
Cheyenne, WY	87/59/p	80/56/t
Chicago	81/70/p	88/72/p
Cincinnati	85/64/p	89/68/s
Cleveland	81/64/p	84/69/p
Dallas	102/80/s	99/79/s
Denver	92/64/t	87/61/t
Des Moines	88/74/c	93/75/t
Detroit	82/67/p	84/68/c
El Paso	99/75/s	100/75/s
Fairbanks, AK	55/41/c	53/43/r
Fargo, ND	85/65/t	85/65/t
Hartford, CT	79/54/s	82/64/c
Honolulu	88/77/r	89/78/sh
Houston	98/77/t	97/76/t
Indianapolis	84/65/p	90/70/s
Jackson, MS	96/71/t	94/72/s
Jacksonville, FL	88/74/t	87/74/t
Kansas City, MO	93/75/p	97/77/t
Las Vegas	104/84/s	100/79/s
Little Rock	93/67/s	96/72/s
Los Angeles	94/73/s	97/68/s
Los Angeles	93/67/s	93/72/s
Louisville	98/68/s	93/72/s
Memphis	94/74/s	96/77/s
Miami	91/81/t	92/80/t
Milwaukee	78/69/t	85/72/c
Minneapolis	83/69/t	87/74/t
Nashville	94/73/s	94/73/s
New Orleans	93/79/t	90/77/t
New York City	79/65/s	83/69/p
Norfolk	82/73/t	86/73/c
Oklahoma City	101/73/s	102/73/s
Omaha	94/76/c	98/76/t
Orlando	92/76/t	88/76/t
Philadelphia	83/66/p	87/73/p
Phoenix	110/85/t	103/82/t
Pittsburgh	81/63/s	85/64/p
Portland, ME	76/57/s	82/64/p
Portland, OR	71/54/sh	74/55/p
Providence, RI	78/59/p	82/67/p
Raleigh, NC	82/70/t	88/71/t
Reno, NV	86/52/s	86/55/s
Richmond	84/68/t	89/70/p
Sacramento	86/52/s	86/55/s
St. Louis	88/72/p	94/76/t
St. Thomas, VI	93/83/t	88/81/r
Salt Lake City	80/63/t	79/60/t
San Diego	86/72/s	80/71/s
San Francisco	70/58/p	70/57/p
San Juan, PR	92/81/r	88/78/r
Seattle	67/53/p	67/55/p
Spokane, WA	71/46/s	69/47/p
Syracuse	79/62/p	81/65/c
Tampa	92/77/t	91/77/t
Wichita	100/74/p	105/76/s

WEATHER

As world inches toward catastrophic climate events, more shocks are in store

BY PETER PRENGAMAN
Associated Press

NEW YORK — In the opening scene of American writer Kim Stanley Robinson's "The Ministry for the Future," a heat wave combined with a breakdown of the electrical grid in India kills 20 million people. The devastation causes the world's nations to unite to combat climate change.

Scientists have long warned that the world will experience more intense extreme weather events like heat waves, storms, floods and droughts. But what once seemed like the realm of fiction is now discussed as a possibility, even an inevitability.

Warning about an "extreme of extremes" or the "Other Big One," a play off the California reference of a big future earthquake, can be fraught. After all, nobody can say for sure when a weather catastrophe may happen. But in the last few years, the planetary ingredients needed for a massive disturbance have been building. And alarm is growing. "The risk is that people just think you are exaggerating," said Daniel Swain, a climate scientist with the California Institute for Water Resources. "It's the 'Boy Who Cried Wolf' problem. Sometimes wolves are real. If it's outside the door, wouldn't you want to know?"

In the 1850s, while living in Seneca Falls, New York, amateur scientist Eunice Newton Foote did a series of experiments that put different substances, including carbon dioxide and moist air, inside glass cylinders and left them in the sun. What she found was extraordinary: cylinders with carbon dioxide, a greenhouse gas that is released when coal, gas or oil is burned, heated up faster and took longer to cool after the sun went down.

Fast-forward: Today, Earth is being heated by massive amounts of greenhouse gases being pumped into the atmosphere, leading to a gradual rise in average global temperature. That in-

crease, 1.44 degrees Celsius (2.59 degrees Fahrenheit) warmer in 2025 compared to the early 1800s, leads to more frequent, and more intense, extreme weather events.

The country that has released the most greenhouse gas, and thus contributed most to climate change, is the United States. But don't expect recognition of that, much less major government-led efforts to combat it, as the country marks its 250th birthday. President Donald Trump has called climate change "the greatest con job ever," referred to climate policies as a "Green New Scam" and said U.N. climate predictions were made by "stupid people."

At any given time there are numerous extreme weather events happening around the globe. Indeed, some have already been so big that we have arguably entered an age of extremes.

Consider Australia's "Black Summer" of wildfires in 2019 and 2020, when 19 million hectares (over 46 million acres) were scorched. Or Pakistan in 2022, when flooding left a third of the country underwater. Or Hurricanes Milton and Helene in 2024, which ravaged parts of the southern United States. That is to say nothing of periodic smaller disasters, such as last year's Texas floods that engulfed young campers; the Los Angeles wildfires that chewed through entire neighborhoods; and Typhoon Kalmegi, which walloped Vietnam and the Philippines.

Sarah Perkins-Kirkpatrick, a climate scientist at Australian National University, says she had a "come to Jesus moment" when she realized that constant extreme weather events wouldn't stop even if the world could immediately reach net zero, the point when as much greenhouse gas is taken out of the atmosphere as released into it. Many countries and major companies have net-zero targets for 2050 or beyond.

Because carbon dioxide can re-

main in the atmosphere for hundreds of years, and so much has already built up, the damage could take centuries to reverse. And we keep adding more.

"It's the issue of the frog in the boiling water," said Perkins-Kirkpatrick. "If we get used to bracing ourselves, are we going to notice?"

What's clear is that no country is truly prepared for a major climate disaster, and the risks are changing.

Robinson, whose book was published in 2020, says if he were writing today he would include a chapter on wildfires, which have become larger and more destructive. And while the potential heat disaster he writes about in India would arguably be less likely today, thanks to less reliance on the grid and use of solar power, Robinson believes the risks of catastrophe have increased. The book, he says, "still has a purpose."

It's basic psychology to avoid talking about uncomfortable things. Climate change, depressing and overwhelming, falls into that category.

Instead of taking action by radically reducing greenhouse gas emissions, or updating our infrastructure to live in a world altered by extreme weather events, a common response, from governments to individuals has largely been to ignore it. Part of the challenge is the care scientists must take when discussing extreme events.

It's impossible to say, for example, that a disaster will happen in a certain year or even decade. But modeling improves every year, and the amount of time between extreme events is shrinking.

Sonia Seneviratne is a Swiss climatologist who vice chairs a working group of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, the top U.N. body of climate scientists. Seneviratne likens the risk to smoking and lung cancer. People who smoke won't necessarily get lung cancer, but the chances are higher and doctors should say

that. Similarly, the risk of massive extreme events rises with every tenth of a degree.

"If such an event happened, I could already see the criticism of people saying, 'Climate scientists didn't tell us,'" Seneviratne said. "But we did."

While earthquakes are not connected to climate change, the way many cities in earthquake-prone California have prepared for a potential Big One is as an example of what's possible. Central to that effort has been Lucy Jones, a seismologist and author of "The Big Ones: How Natural Disasters Have Shaped Us (and What We Can Do About Them)."

In 2014, Jones, then with the U.S. Geological Survey, worked with Los Angeles Mayor Eric Garcetti's administration in developing an initiative that produced widespread retrofitting and earthquake preparedness in LA, and then later in other California cities. Two years later, she formed a non-profit that advises on preparing for earthquakes and other disasters.

Jones says people will make changes if they believe risks are real and solutions are possible. Without that belief, the response will likely be to ignore the issue.

"Climate denial is one way of coping," said Jones. She said people rationalize by thinking, "I won't believe it's true, so I'll feel safer."

Over the last quarter century, many movies have focused on extreme weather events, which provide action and danger to any plot. The cinematic portrayals usually have one of two endings: everything will be okay or we are doomed.

Consider two popular climate movies that came out 15 years apart. In the 2004 "The Day After Tomorrow," Jack Hall, played by Dennis Quaid, is a climate scientist who, speaking at a U.N. climate conference in Delhi, urges a major reduction in greenhouse gas emissions, warning that a failure to do so will lead to major

extreme weather events. "The climate is fragile," Hall says.

"The economy is fragile," responds the U.S. vice president.

Shortly after, the disaster that Hall warns about happens. Melting polar ice halts the North Atlantic Current, which moves warm ocean currents northeast across the Atlantic. There are giant cyclones, massive hailstones, heavy flooding and tornadoes before a big freeze takes over — so cold that anybody outside dies.

Eventually the vice president, who has become president, apologizes to the nation for exploiting nature. "We were wrong," he says.

In the 2021 satire "Don't Look Up," two astronomers played by Leonardo DiCaprio and Jennifer Lawrence discover a giant comet heading toward Earth. They try to spur action to avoid annihilation. The U.S. president, played by Meryl Streep, isn't interested.

"At this exact moment, I think we sit tight and assess," Streep says after learning the comet is heading straight toward Earth.

"How big is this thing? Can it destroy my ex-wife's house?" jokes a television news host.

At the end, almost everybody dies, a scenario that even the worst predictions of climate impacts don't envision.

As powerful as extreme weather events have already gotten, much worse is likely to come. It's basic physics.

More than half all greenhouse gases produced by humans throughout history have been released into the atmosphere over 50 years. Those gases create heat, which scrambles weather patterns and ecosystems.

The when of a major climate event, or more likely several in different parts of the world, can't be known with certainty. A catastrophic event in any given area could be in 50 years, or 10 years, or sooner.

People who deny climate change is real will point out that scientists

get projections wrong, and it's true that not every climate model has been correct. But over the last decades, if anything, climate scientists have been too conservative. Climate impacts are happening much faster than predicted.

One of many examples: In January 2022, the U.K. Climate Risk Assessment said there was a 0.02% chance of 40C (104F) or above heat before 2040. That summer, parts of the U.K. topped 40C.

We have also reached a moment when "tipping points" — when deterioration of a given planetary system has crossed a threshold from which it can't recover — are no longer positioned as theoretical or futuristic.

The most commonly cited is corals. According to the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration, between 2023 and 2025, 84% of the world's corals suffered the expelling of microscopic algae in response to heat stress, which often leads to dying. Even if temperatures were to sharply drop, the recovery of most corals is doubtful.

The Amazon rainforest, which stores massive amounts of carbon dioxide and helps regulate the climate, is also at risk of a tipping point. Persistent drought, large wildfires and deforestation to make way for cattle have degraded swaths of forest in recent decades. The debate today is when, not if, the Amazon will release more carbon dioxide than it holds.

This year's El Niño, a natural and periodic warming cycle, is expected to be the strongest ever recorded, which could push temperatures even higher, breaking records and leaving damage along the way.

Overall, the Earth is on a dangerous path.

"We need to be talking about some of the worst things that can happen," said Tim Lenton, climate science professor at the University of Exeter. "It's natural to think that some bigger shocks are on the way."

The Guide to Offers

The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to Ke Huy Quan Never Say Die Book Talk September 16

From his breakout roles as Short Round in *Indiana Jones and the Temple of Doom* and Data in *The Goonies*, Ke Huy Quan became a beloved child star before stepping away from acting for nearly two decades. He later returned to the screen in *Finding 'Ohana* and delivered an acclaimed, Oscar-winning performance in *Everything Everywhere All at Once*. His journey stands as a powerful story of talent, perseverance, and an extraordinary comeback.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)